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Virginia Board of Education, Business Meeting, Thursday, February 2, 2023

Date	Thursday, February 2, 2023
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	9h 9m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aVBxE2edPAY
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:06:38] Yeah, teach your voice now. Good morning. Good morning. All right. Thank you all for being with us today. I'd like to call to order the meeting of the Virginia Board of Education, as I like to refer to us, the hardest working non-paid board in the Commonwealth. We will begin with a moment of silence, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance.

[00:06:56] The United States of America, to the republic for which it stands, one nation, under God, indivisible, with liberty and justice for all.

[00:07:29] okay we have a full agenda today and uh we're going to try to move as expeditiously as possible through it uh first item is the approval of the minutes from the november 16 and 17 uh 2022 meetings of the board i know that there were some proposed changes made and circulated uh are there any comments on the minutes or is there a motion to approve as i think the cert the amended version um and i understand the amended version is what's up on the website

[00:08:05] okay there a motion to approve i move to approve the minutes as amended thank you uh miss holton is there a second second okay thank you dr man all in favor signify by saying aye okay any opposed good all right uh this is you know perhaps my favorite meeting of the year because we get to recognize the teachers of the year you know so often you know you hear us bog

[00:08:41] down in the minutiae and the day-to-day of the mechanics of you know what the state does and it's not often enough that we get to you know meet and see and you know talk with those people who actually make all this happen so we are delighted that all of you have taken the time on a snowy day to make the trip to richmond and be with us we are honored by your presence i'll ask dr siebert if you don't mind to present the resolution. Good morning, President Gecker, colleagues, Superintendent Baylow. Really, it is indeed, as President Gecker noted, a very special occasion. Today, we have the

[00:09:19] pleasure as the board to recognize eight very special people, Virginia's Teachers of the Year and our Regional Teachers of the Year for 2023. In recognizing each of these individuals today, we are confirming and affirming that excellence in education is celebrated for them, for their peers the co-workers they see on the daily basis and we also recognize that they they serve as ambassadors for our profession their commitment and passion for what they teach is a shining example of the impact that teachers can have we certainly while we enjoy this opportunity we want to acknowledge and thank dr meg homer and dr joan johnson and the whole teacher education team for

[00:09:58] their whole work hard work and just making this possible and organizing a really complex process and then making it elegant and meaningful for for the honorees um honorees as i introduce you i'd like for you to come on up here and we'll i'll present you with your resolution but you need to hold on to it because it won't be official until the vote at the end but we will hopefully uh we we hope that that that action will pass so we we look forward to that part so beginning with region one if uh if kiara thompson would come join me at the voting please hold on to that and welcome so from region one we have miss kiera thompson the region one teacher of the year an eighth grade

[00:10:37] earth science teacher i was an earth science teacher i'm starting my career so i was really happy to see we're starting off with with that fine content area she has enjoyed her full five year career in education at thomas c bushall middle school where she's taught various science classes ms thompson earned a bachelor of science degree in biology from odu and then a master's of public administration ms thompson like many of us in the profession didn't didn't immediately answer the call but felt it through a different way she always planned to become a teacher she always envisioned a career in hospital administration however and in a life of service as a graduate student and assistantship and health educator her volunteer work with local after-school programs

[00:11:16] sparked her passion and led her to her calling i know that countless individuals are grateful that she made that career change to public education mrs thompson has remained highly active both in membership and leadership roles and her involvement in many professional organizations the national science teaching association virginia association of science teachers and has served as operations coordinator for feed the streets rva ms thompson has served as coordinator of assessment and remediation science learning collaborative coach project waterworks instructor amazon future engineer coordinator vcu richmond teacher residency coach and in other roles remaining a constant in

[00:11:51] her students lives ms thompson works to remove barriers to student success encouraging meaningful learning that extends beyond the walls of a classroom ms thompson works tirelessly to reveal career opportunities and various avenues that prepare students for the future region one ms kira thompson we will have you back all right from region two if i could have mr jason bartholomew join me please yes i should make sure there we go region two teacher of the year jason daniel

[00:12:29] bartholomew is a high school business teacher and personal finance teacher in suffolk schools he's also a veteran while serving the military mr bartholomew competed a bachelor of science degree in human resources management from the new school university and later earned his master's of business administration degree at old dominion university using his 21-year navy navy career as a foundation of lifelong service and following his successful completion of odu's career switcher program mr bartholomew made the shift to teaching business and personal finance classes in the public high school mr bartholomew has demonstrated consistent leadership and has earned many accolades his

[00:13:08] accomplishments include revitalizing an accounting program at his school and spearheading a city-wide offering of the advanced accounting elective in suffolk although he's been recognized in several meaningful ways including being named the 2014-2015 district career and technical education outstanding teacher of the year he feels his success is best reflected in a team of his students having been crown state champions of the governor's challenge sponsored by the virginia council on economic education mr bartholomew humbly jests that he lacks pedigree of a formerly trained teacher and that there are still days when he feels like a retired navy guy with a business degree

[00:13:44] doing his best impersonation of a real teacher however it is clear that he has earned the respects of his community his board his students and the greater profession as an exceptional teacher from region four mr jordan markwood mr markwood represents loudon county as region four teacher of the year having earned a bachelor of science bachelor music degree from houghton college and earned a master's of music and voice performance and pedagogy a degree from westminster choir

[00:14:24] college of rider university mr markwood's journey was also greatly influenced by many inspirational music teachers ranging from his elementary gifted and talented music teacher mrs laura lofton who encouraged his gifts and passion for music to miss marsha barley his middle school choir teacher who exemplified what it means to love in each student as a whole person and not just a musician mr markwood's student teaching experience began with rhonda wider who made him feel welcomed supported and equipped to become a successful teacher indeed his success as an educator is not only reflected in his accolades including being named washington post teacher of the year in 2022

[00:15:02] but in his ability to use music to build community and human connection mr markwood has developed a unique ability to take even the most painful moments in his community and the process the grief through music and reflection and he is clearly a credit to the teaching profession

[00:15:18] mr jordan markwood region five miss laurie peltonen laurie peltonen library media specialist is representing staunton high school and staunton city public schools as the region five teacher of the year at fairham college miss pelton earned a bachelor's of science degree in education with concentrations of both english and psychology and then completed a master's

[00:15:58] of science degree in library science at longwood university having built strong teaching foundation marked by teaching various subjects including visual arts language arts civics and science miss pelton did a great sought out a new challenge she was drawn to the dynamic nature of the library in the media specialist position as the potential to positively impact every person in her school building she has taken on leadership roles including serving as team leader and professional leadership committee for the standing committee of standards for librarians and has demonstrated advocacy for securing education resources by securing numerous grants as a respected figure

[00:16:34] in her school community she also provides the leadership in creating a more welcoming accepting and diverse environment by designate designing a collaborative cross-curricular initiative called humans of staunton high school she has further put her creativity and dedication to to use in in leading efforts to repurpose a van for educational outreach and in developing the mystery-based literature unit that has challenged students to explore various unsolved mysteries she's considered by colleagues to be a highly dedicated educator mentor leader

[00:17:06] in stanton and beyond congratulations lori region six my neck of the woods we'd like to welcome angela dawn myers you come forward please region six teacher of the year as myers represents bottetok county public schools miss myers earned a bachelor of science degree in elementary education from bluefield state college and a master's of education degree in curriculum and instruction from the university of virginia as myers currently applies for 25 years of experience

[00:17:45] in education serving as a teacher librarian for grades six through eight at reed mountain middle school she demonstrates leadership in various ways including presenting at events for the the virginia association of school librarians and the virginia association of supervision and curriculum development excuse me sharing her passion for education she has embraced the role of cooperating teacher for multiple student teachers and has served as teacher leader and coach for efforts focused on helping secondary schools develop and sustain comprehensive integrated literacy programs ms meyers seemed to always have known that she was meant for a career in teaching tracing her interest in education to early childhood indeed we are grateful that she

[00:18:23] pursued that dream as she continues to see her library at the heart of her school in her own words quote a place where students feel valued and loved miss angela myers region seven miss dawn poe region seven teacher of the year dawn prider poe is representing fairview elementary school and grayson county public schools miss poe earned a bachelor's of science degree in

[00:19:00] elementary education at lee university miss poe has teaching endorsements in early childhood education middle education specific learning disabilities and intellectual disabilities Of her 26 years in education, she has dedicated 15 to students at the kindergarten level.

[00:19:17] Throughout her career, she demonstrated commitment and service and leadership. Seeking to support vulnerable groups, she has volunteered with an anti-violence basketball and tutoring initiative, an outreach program that provides new shoes, school supplies, and clothing for school-age children, and several meal collection and distribution drives.

[00:19:34] Ms. Poe has served as lead mentor and new teacher trainer and supervisor of student teachers at high school and high school interns at multiple schools. As a result of her dedication, she has been recognized with several awards, including the Martinsville City Schools Above and Beyond Award, the 2017 Most Influential Teacher and Excellent Education Awards, and Martinsville City Schools.

[00:19:56] Ms. Poe believes, quote, a child's kindergarten experience should precipitate a lifelong love of learning, and she subscribes to Alfred Mercier's sentiments about education. What we learn with pleasure, we never forget. Dawn Poe. Our Region 8 representative was unavailable to be with us, but we want to celebrate Ms. Megan Graves, so I have the honor to share a few few words about her as well. Representing Appomattox County Public Schools, Megan Gail Graves is the Region 8 Teacher of the Year.

[00:20:32] Ms. Graves graduated from Sweetbriar College with a Bachelor of Arts degree in biology and earned a Master's of Science in Special Education from Longwood University. The most recent two years of Ms. Graves' eight-year career have been spent in both Appomattox County High School and Appamax County Alternative Education Center, where she is currently serving as the English, Mathematics, Science, and Social Studies teacher for grades 8 through 12. In addition to serving as special ed lead teacher for the school, she is also the founder and lead teacher of Region 8 Transition Council, an organization that coordinates transition services to students with exceptional needs. Like some of our other teachers here today, Ms. Graves had not always

[00:21:10] dreamed of a career as a teacher, but this changed when she was volunteering and found a new direction for her life. Ms. Graves had originally planned to apply to a veterinary school, which prompted an interest in equine riding program for students with disabilities. However, when she had the opportunity to work with two siblings with cerebral palsy, she found herself transformed in witnessing how they grew in strength, confidence, and improved skills. This experience was so rewarding that it ultimately fueled her decision to become a special educator. Indeed, the highest notes of Ms. Graves' career lie in the instances where she is able to recognize former students living out their world world real world independent victories a round of applause for

[00:21:48] miss megan graves bear with me just a moment as i got all my notes completely out of order okay now region three representing region three and the commonwealth of virginia virginia's teacher of

[00:22:19] the year please welcome miss fabiana parker it is now my distinct pleasure to introduce our virginia teacher of the year first recognized as the region three teacher of the year miss fabiana parker was named virginia teacher of the year at a celebratory event hosted by governor yunkin and first lady suzanne yunkin miss parker is an english teacher english as second language teacher at thornburg middle school and spotsylvania high school where she teaches students in grades 6 through 12. growing up as an english learner herself miss parker traces the beginnings

[00:22:55] of her career to her child experience of teaching her grandmother to read she earned a bachelor's of arts degree in modern foreign language and education at king's college london and earned a master's of arts degree in education curriculum instruction at Boise State University in 2003.

[00:23:12] Furthermore, Ms. Parker has completed coursework at the University of Virginia, University of Phoenix, University of Grenada, and Oxford and Cambridge universities. Ms. Parker is both a leader in her school and her community, having served as teacher mentor and volunteer for the English speakers of other languages, parent evening coordinator, chairperson of the diversity and equity committee.

[00:23:33] She's also been recognized for her service outside of the classroom, received a congressional record for having served as an adult literacy needs in Northern Virginia community as well as the Virginia Department of Health Certificate of Appreciation for her outstanding commitment and translation services to the Virginia Department of Health during the COVID-19 pandemic response efforts. Seeing her students achieve their educational goals and become productive members of society, the driving force behind Ms. Parker's commitment to education.

[00:24:01] Using her personal professional experiences to promote cultural diversity while building bridges of trust respect and understanding across all cultures will always be counted among her greatest accomplishments but miss parker today is her husband jason i think you have some children with you as well for pictures okay only my husband watching from home and we welcome uh so in addition to

celebrating with parker we would like to give her the opportunity to share some remarks with with the board congratulations hi good morning everyone good morning members of the

[00:24:40] board of education my family my fellow educators my beautiful students hopefully watching at school right now and everyone in the audience who has a deep passion for public education it's an absolute honor to be here today i'm very proud and humbled to be the 2023 virginia teacher of the year okay as an english as a second language teacher in both middle and high school I have the privilege to see the immense impact that quality public education and outstanding

[00:25:18] teaching have on our students. The dedicated educators here today with me are just a few shining examples of the transformative power of our profession. As I reflect back on my journey from humble beginnings in Brazil to Teacher of the Year in Virginia, I cannot help but to consider that often our greatest struggles can be our most valuable blessings. I too was once an ESOL

[00:25:52] student. I struggled to understand and communicate effectively in English. I felt isolated, confused, and I had trouble adapting to my new culture. My poor mother can attest that many times I cried on my way to school looking for the home I once knew. But things change. And today, and for the past 12 years i have used these very personal and often very difficult experiences to motivate not only my students to learn english but also to be able to put myself in their shoes and provide them with

[00:26:31] the guidance and the positive role model they need to succeed our esl teachers are truly multifaceted they wear many hats daily in addition to teaching language skills they often serve as surrogate mothers and fathers, cultural ambassadors, interpreters, a source of solace for many ESOL students who arrive at their schools every year, helping students succeed academically and integrate

[00:27:02] smoothly into the wider community. A few months ago, just as an example, a seventh grader from Afghanistan arrived in my classroom. She has never had the opportunity to attend school in her home country. However, her eagerness to learn and her big dreams have made a lasting impact on myself and my colleagues. She has learned to count to 100. She can now identify all of her English letters and English sounds. But most importantly, every morning, she comes to my room for a hug

[00:27:38] and assurance that everything is going to be just fine. I could honestly go on and on and on speaking about my students and their journeys. I'm so proud of Katya, who became an owner of her own beauty salon. Laura, who is now soaring as a flight attendant. Celio, who's thriving as a business owner of his own electronics repair shop. Catherine, who's now on the brink of becoming an

[00:28:13] elementary school teacher. Freddie, who owns his own three service business. Chekna, who is now studying business administration i honestly could go on and on my students are amazing and this is what public education is all about and excellence in teaching makes a huge difference in the lives of so many students empowers young people to dream and inspires them to change the world around them my incredible students now fill their communities with hope and transform some of their most

[00:28:51] difficult times into blessings for themselves and everyone around them. Public education serves a strong tool to counteract social inequality, fosters diverse learning environments where different students from different backgrounds come together to form a community that reflects the broader world. By promoting academic excellence, addressing social economic disparities, education

[00:29:28] offers an opportunity for all and as such quality esl english as a second language education is essential so we can provide equitable opportunities for all students so as i stand here today in front of all

of you proud to be the virginia 2022 teacher of the year and i share my experiences with you i would like to say that we should continue to work together through leadership advocacy and innovation to build a brighter future for all of our students and all our communities

[00:30:06] to fulfill the promise of equal education especially for students like myself who are still in the process of turning their most difficult struggles into their biggest blessings once again thank you for this opportunity it's as we say in portuguese bensons pies e amor para todos blessings to all thank you

[00:30:42] at this point i'd like to invite all the teachers of the year to please come make a little line up here as we fully understand that they are extraordinary in their profession well deserved the recognition but they are ambassadors for the thousands upon thousands of teachers out there changing lives every single day so mr president fellow colleagues on the board i move adoption of these resolutions celebrating these extraordinary teachers for a second thank you all in favor hi this vote we're going to take today guys enjoy that one come forward

[00:31:17] for a picture please the board thank you we have a significant number of people signed up to speak

[00:34:06] uh speakers will be recognized in the order in which their request was received speakers are asked to limit their remarks to three minutes and today we're going to enforce that a little bit more strictly given the volume of comments we have but also request that to the extent others have made the same comments you're going to make uh that there'd be some discretion exercise as to how long you speak i say that advisedly because honestly you know the board welcomes uh and appreciates all comments from the public but there is also the practical side of this for us too so to the extent you know you can be concise and not repetitive that would be greatly appreciated by me

[00:34:46] and the board as a whole. You can email a copy of your remarks if you want to Jim Chapman, who is, I guess, acting now as director of board relations after you finish speaking. If you have any comments that are already written, I guess Mr. Chapman or somebody will pass them up to the board. So we'll begin with Candace Lucas, followed by Melissa Siddiqui. Someone left their notes up

[00:35:24] here. Did you want your notes there? Good morning, board members. Good morning, Dr. Balow. Once again, my name is Candace Lucas. I'm a licensed educator and administrator. I'm also a doctoral student completing my studies regarding how black mothers navigate special education in Virginia and the horrors that they experience through the lived experiences. I wanted to come before you again to address the issue that special education within Virginia is not being complied with.

[00:35:57] As we know, the IDEA is a civil rights law, and we understand that civil rights laws are meant to protect individuals, protect the classes. In Virginia, as Dr. Bailo has received probably a thousand emails since she's been in the position, we expected that the governor would enforce parents' rights as he committed to us when we advocated for him. He has failed us miserably the school divisions have not received the memo that parents matter parents are still being violated regarding their equal standing as iep team members in addition documents are being

[00:36:34] falsified parents are being prevented from bringing individuals that they trust and care for to iep meetings students are being denied services that they're entitled to parents are being coerced into signing documents and if they do not disclose their hiv status if they do not disclose their financial status their students are not receiving special education services basically what we have in virginia right now is a

massive resistance movement similar to what we have regarding brown v board of education we have a massive resistance movement by the videoe by the leas

[00:37:12] not implementing and refusing to honor idea and the rights of our families i gave you this book as members on page 13 of the book it tells you those regulations tells you that the state department of education is to ensure that all children with disabilities age 2 to 21 inclusive residing in virginia have a right to a free and appropriate education and we have to get out our out of our mind the mentality that public education applies to all children every child does not attend a public school but they still deserve to be educated and so we have to get out

[00:37:49] of that mentality the public education system has not been revisited since 1806 with horace mann the father of public education who created public education to create workers not thinkers okay so we have to get out of that mentality public education is cannot be funded children can be funded public education cannot be funded okay so we have to get out of that mentality in addition on page 13 that i gave you of this manual the videoe dr baloe has violated every single one

[00:38:20] of their responsibilities under 34 cfr 300 101 34 cfr 300 1 1 2 34 cfr 300 and 34 34 300 cfr 301 49 when will the board of education stop being deadbeat parents and start advocating for our kids and enforcing the idea to protect the civil rights of our children specifically our black and brown

[00:38:48] children with disabilities thank you melissa siddiqui followed by kathy halverson good morning before i start i want to say again that 2023 will mark the fourth year that my children have been blocked from enrollment into public school not even a private program that would support their

[00:39:26] multiple disabilities so chesterfield county is in violation of federal law this board knows that these last few years have been such a struggle for our family our school board members are more interested in political gain than our crumbling education system i've come to these same feelings

[00:40:03] about our board of education i came to this board desperate for intervention as samantha hollands has signed off on weaponizing our school social workers who have been pressing criminal charges on parents who are following medical advice given by private providers all in an effort to deny thousands of students with disabilities ieps needed to thrive when children lack the necessary supports their mental health declines her actions are resulting in thousands of children being

[00:40:37] medicated for depression and let's be real that's not fixing their problems it's masking the symptoms of their problems the fact is you know this i've stood here bare spewing my frustrations out to you publicly all of you refuse to respond to my emails of desperation this is keegan my 10-year-old son with autism and extreme anxiety keegan has always worked twice as hard to accomplish tasks that require fine motor skills he has been closed off for much of his life and chesterfield county

[00:41:16] is to blame reed smith was to blame sans anderson is to blame samantha hollands is to blame and you are to blame this is parker ideation parker has always struggled in school meeting after meeting with tears and frustration from years of school staff covering up his disability his sobs at the kitchen table were heartbreaking doing homework that took hours as his struggles grew so did the fraud perpetuated by the school division i warned you of his worsening depression

[00:41:53] you all stayed silent my emails went unacknowledged and unanswered i came to you while my son was hospitalized for wanting to hurt him still himself still you stayed silent all of this led to this moment three years ago i notified this board of the egregious acts of samantha and her little gang of

bullies i only have four more sentences i'm gonna finish things are happening behind closed doors and investigations have already been opened in regards of your pipe uh practice um policies i don't water things down when i talk to my kids about the world they're growing up in they know

[00:42:29] monsters are among us you are the monsters they want to know who's to blame for ruining their childhood for robbing them of security and safety in their educational setting it's you accountability requires mindfulness acceptance honesty and courage you are sheep 99 of all failures come from people who make excuses your excuses are lies wrapped up in reasons that's all i have to say

[00:42:56] Thank you. Kathy Halverson, followed by Peter Welles. Peter Welleson, thank you.

[00:43:17] Good morning. Appreciate you all being here and taking your comments. A couple of things to show you. I'm Peter Welles, and I'm here to request that you consider adding three things to the standards of learning, specifically for civics and social studies. Those are founding principles and american rule of law and the fact that judicial activism is unconstitutional my familiarity with

[00:43:54] the standards of learning goes back to 2005 2008 i did a career switch course in the middle of a basically 40 50 year legal career and through regent school law and taught american government street law economics ancient history modern history uh norfolk public schools norview high school under principal marjorie staley and uh like tell everybody that's everything from the

[00:44:32] dawn of time to present but that was a fabulous experience very humbling to be here in front of the teachers who were here uh i know uh how hard it is to teach in any event i've got two requests this morning one is that you had the founding principles american rule of law and uh fact that cons that judicial activism is unconstitutional to the curriculum k through 12. um i've also reviewed the drafts there's three the 400 page one 53 page one and the 2023 one and they're not in

[00:45:08] there and they weren't in the standards before and to the extent they're touched on there's mistakes it's incorrect and not legally. So that's why I'm here today. So what are those things? Judicial activism is depicted in a number of media literature. One of the best ones is to kill a mockingbird. We all know that that's about racism. But during the trial, at the end, the jury set aside the law and the facts, the evidence, in order to convict an innocent man.

[00:45:45] That's what judicial activism is. Another example of it is the Nuremberg trials, where the German judges were prosecuted for genocide because they set the law aside to convict innocent Jews before they were sent to the gas chamber. There's an example of American rule of law in a couple of cases. The two that I would call to mind are Captain Preston and his British regulars were

[00:46:19] prosecuted for murder for the Boston Massacre and John Adams, second president. Mr. Wales, could you wrap up your comments, please? I can. I can. I can. Just simply say that I would request in addition to you adding those things that you read my comments that I've written out. I'll send this to you but there's also these are my comments that I submitted to the for

[00:46:49] inclusion we thank you for your comments were well past your time thank you two pages of my ten-page summary certainly thank you

[00:47:08] appreciate y'all uh tammy c followed by sarah finley either here yes ma'am yes i know okay thank you i'm sarah finley and i'm not speaking today on behalf of any organization just as a

[00:47:42] concerned um citizen but in previous capacities i was involved with the last three revisions of the history and social studies standards of learning in the proposed 2022 history and social studies standards that were presented to you last August, one goal was to equip students with knowledge and skills to understand and honor our collective history and be able to make informed decisions and take informed action. I believe the August draft accomplished this goal and more and also promoted Governor Youngkin's vision that we need to teach our children the value of freedom of

[00:48:22] thought and diversity of ideas and that students need to understand both the good and the bad of our history. As you know, it's not easy to develop standards and a curriculum framework that can live up to these ideals, but it is so very important. And to get there, process matters. The draft standards presented in August were the product of more extensive and varied input than I believe has ever happened for any standards. There was extensive input from parents, educators at every

[00:48:56] level, subject matter experts, as well as students and some from the business community. Also for the first time, the curriculum framework was developed in conjunction with the standards. It makes far more sense to develop them as a package and have the total picture of what's being proposed for teachers to use in the classroom. The curriculum framework proposed in August is a vast improvement over earlier versions. It builds on the skills that were adopted in the 2015 standards that we all want students to learn, and it appears there was a significant effort to ensure our

[00:49:34] history is presented in a more complete, unbiased, and engaging manner, helping students understand and think critically about events in our history. For your reference, I attached the preface from the august draft outlining the process and the people involved it also explains the restructuring the curriculum frame of the curriculum framework to promote a deeper understanding and critical thinking i think it's the best guidance teachers have ever seen and i strongly urge you to adopt

[00:50:06] them as the draft that you move forward for public comment in stark contrast the draft standards you're asked to adopt today do not include a curriculum framework. Following past practice, it'll take at least another year to develop and adopt. What will it look like and who will be involved? And equally important, or perhaps even more so, the process sets a bad precedent with various perspectives and expertise. And I will close. They were hastily developed by some

[00:50:40] organizations with no professional standing among historians and no k-12 expertise there's no amount of time or energy that can be expended to fix the perception real or perceived that the process has become politicized by over reliance on those with a particular ideology thank you thank you miss Ms. Finley, good to see you again. Holly Hazard, followed by Gertrude Sanchi.

[00:51:11] Thank you, Mr. Chair, members of the board. I'm Holly Hazard with For Public Education. Like others, we are distressed at the disruption in the process to develop and to implement the new standards of learning. We are now over eight months behind. In compromise, For Public Education supports the collaborative compromise draft, but we're concerned that it doesn't have the substance of the curriculum, and this will once again be left to out-of-state interests with a political agenda. We're hopeful that this board will adopt the detailed guidance for the curriculum framework from the August proposal. We are as concerned with the growing lack of trust, lack of

[00:51:48] faith, and lack of confidence in this institution. Parents, teachers, and other stakeholders have had their confidence shaken from the fiasco with the botched standards to tip lines to witch hunts over PSAT recognition. And I realize that some of these are beyond the control of this group.

[00:52:06] Virginians have a perception that this agency is in disarray and that the education of our kids is being politicized. Please don't discount the corrosive effect that this lack of faith will have in the years to come. And please take seriously the need to begin to rebuild the compact that this agency has with Virginians. Children, families, businesses, and communities, our future is dependent on your work to regain our trust.

[00:52:33] Thank you. Thank you. Gerfried Sandhue, followed by Katharina Genove. I'm sure I'm getting these names incorrectly pronounced, and I apologize. Please correct me as you come up.

[00:52:55] Good morning. My name is Katharina Genove, and I have been the principal at the Montessori Public School of Arlington since 2019 when we moved into our own standalone building.

[00:53:14] Our district has been successfully serving children and families and supporting Montessori education for over 50 years, and our long wait list each year demonstrate the ongoing community demand for our program our students thrive in classrooms that are designed to meet their developmental needs while fostering the solid academic foundation that they need for success but to continue to serve our students well we need to be able to recruit and retain montessori credentialed teachers without a pathway to teacher licensure recruiting montessori teachers is extremely difficult every spring i struggle to recruit the best candidates to fill vacancies

[00:53:52] in our school that currently enrolls 512 students as the only public montessori school in virginia the majority of our applicants work in one of the many private montessori schools in our area where they are not required to hold a state license we have interviewed hundreds of applicants with years of excellent classroom experiences outstanding references and often a master's in montessori education who often decline offers because of the additional obtaining of a virginia license or simply are not even eligible to be considered for employment the only alternative is for us to hire state licensed teachers and then send them to get their montessori credential

[00:54:32] which means while teaching they are completely completing the equivalent of at least 42 credit hours of coursework to teach at the elementary level in addition to the strain on the teachers Placing a non-Montessori credential teacher in a Montessori classroom can limit students' ability to access all that the classroom has to offer.

[00:54:49] When hiring non-Montessori teachers, MPSA must also dedicate financial resources to have teachers receive Montessori preparation and expend limited administrative resources to support teachers who are in a classroom environment that are not yet equipped to teach.

[00:55:05] Both of these resources could be better allocated to serve students if Montessori credential teachers were able to obtain a state teaching license. I am grateful for the time that the Department of Education and this board have already taken to consider this proposed pathway.

[00:55:20] However, I am concerned that the additional coursework requirements for a renewable license will still negatively impact my ability to hire and retain experienced qualified individuals to lead our schools. Therefore, I'm asking the board to consider amending the proposal to remove the additional requirements for a renewable license and to restrict the licenses issued this pathway to teaching in a Montessori school.

[00:55:44] In my experience, the Montessori credential teachers we hire are well-equipped to lead our classrooms and support our students so they can thrive. Thank you. Thank you. Corrie Marie Borgman,

followed by Jonathan Huey. Good morning.

[00:56:00] Good morning. Dr. Borgman had a medical unexpected appointment, so may I read her testimony on her behalf? I was told it would be okay. Awesome. Okay. Hello, everybody. Good morning. I'm reading this on behalf of Dr. Corey Borgman, who says, "I speak today in my role as UVA's Montessori Science Program lead and as president of the Virginia Montessori Association.

[00:56:26] I'm here today to encourage the board to take steps that will make Montessori a more feasible educational option for Virginia families thank you for your time today and for your consideration of the application before you an application that delivers on several educational goals that I know are shared between the board the Virginia Department of Education and the advocates here today but most importantly with children and families served in APS a growing body of research supports the idea that Montessori is an effective strategy for a wide array of such of such goals including those related to accessible high quality early childhood programming the Montessori curriculum curriculum

[00:57:04] is thoroughly aligned with Virginia's ELDS in fact thanks to the collaboration and advocacy of many of those present here today that curriculum has been vetted and approved by DOE for use in publicly funded programs across the state importantly our research shows that Montessori pre-k students place significantly higher on a broad range of measures related to academic school readiness as well as non-cognitive measures of executive function school liking mastery orientation and social understanding skill improve literacy though uh through the passage of the virginia literacy

[00:57:40] act our state has committed significant resources to protect the right to read by ensuring that every child receives evidence-based instruction a recent book entitled powerful literacy in the montessori classroom and published by teachers college press demonstrates how montessori has adhered to what we now call the science of reading for the 130 plus years of its existence likely for that reason their early reading proficiency and strong literacy literacy skills of montessori students has been a consistent finding from our research elevated standardized

[00:58:14] test scores a study examining test score data from 119 public montessori schools located across 10 states found that Montessori students consistently outperformed the traditional schools and their home districts. Findings were particularly compelling for ELA, where Montessori students excelled at both test points and across all subgroups, and for Black students who outperformed their peers in both ELA and math at both test points. Equity of Opportunity. A landmark study of ours found that the public Montessori schools in large urban high-poverty districts were able to

[00:58:50] effectively close socioeconomic school readiness gaps by the kindergarten year. We are now undertaking a $3 million federally funded replication of that study on a national scale. Students social emotional health. A recently published study of ours found that just two years of Montessori education predicted significantly higher levels of adult well-being.

[00:59:12] Furthermore, the more years you spend in Montessori, the higher adults scored on well-being measures stewardship of investments. There are several reasons why Montessori is a wise investment for schools and districts. Am I out of time? I think you are, yes. Oh, okay. Well, all we want to say is we hope that you will look at this application. You'll see me back, and I'll be on time for the next one. Thanks, you guys. Thank you. Jonathan Huey, followed by Wendy Shank-Evans. Good morning.

[00:59:45] Good morning. Hello, my name is Jonathan Hoyt, father of Eliza and Harrison, age 97. There are students at the monastery public school of Arlington. Of all the places we could have chosen to reside in Virginia, we specifically chose Arlington. Why? It's because Arlington offers something no one else else offered within the commonwealth of Virginia. It offers a public monastery program. Not everyone learns in the same manner, and there are educational philosophies that can bring out the very best of our children and allow them to be the very best version of themselves. My favorite aspect of the monastery program is a multi-age setting, which allows my children to learn from their slightly older classmates when they were younger and allow

[01:00:21] them to step into the role of a leader to their younger classmates when they got older. They know when to follow and listen as well as when and how to lead. This type of behavior manifests itself daily for my children as they interact with the world at large. Because of the setting that the classroom allows them to be in, I worry less about my children being bullied at school or will bully others, a concern many parents and educators face today. The creative environment offered in the classroom did not hinder my children's performance as my daughter has done exceptionally well in the Virginia SLLs. This is due in part because they have three levels of students in the same class which means longer educational experiences with their classmates and having the

[01:01:00] same teacher for multiple years. This works only because Montessori classroom is different at its very core and the cornerstone of making all this possible is having a teacher that is Montessori trained. Eliza and Harrison are both thriving in this environment because they have been fortunate to have Montessori trained teachers throughout their tenure at the Montessori Public School of Arlington. My wife Kay and I chose to place our children on this monastery path, but it is by luck that they're in the program, as the waiting list for this public monastery program is extremely long. The long wait list is indicative of the fact that many, many parents in Arlington want this for their children. It's their preferred choice, yet a lot of them come up empty. We few,

[01:01:39] the happy few, recognize our good fortune, but why does it have to be based on a lottery? When there is a huge demand, a demand for what is best for our best for our children no less, shouldn't the great state of Virginia answer this call from parents and children there is no silver bullet but what would help increase the supplies amidst this demand is to offer Virginia monastery teaching teacher licensure remember the cornerstone of a successful monastery classroom requires having a monastery trained teacher don't just listen to me listen to others who are speaking here today create a public monastery teacher license we have the demand we have the room but

[01:02:14] we need Montessori trained teachers that can lead the classroom that are already pre-filled with eager children on the wait list. We don't want to be the few, the happy few. I want other parents to share the same joy we have as we see our children excel. A lot of parents have chosen the path. The question is, can you help them punch the ticket? Thank you. Thank you. Wendy Shank-Evans followed by Maliko Grady. Thank you. As the executive director of the Montessori

[01:02:49] Public Policy Initiative. I've been involved in the development of pathways to teacher licensure for Montessori teachers in several states. To strengthen their public Montessori schools, 10 states have already recognized the rigor of Montessori teacher preparation by creating such a pathway. The background information in today's agenda for this proposal states that the purpose of this alternate route to licensure is to ensure local school divisions have an opportunity to meet their unique needs in

recruiting and retaining educators for their school communities the unique need faced by the arlington school district is to hire the teachers most qualified

[01:03:28] to teach in their montessori classrooms which are individuals with a montessori credential montessori teachers graduate from their teacher education programs thoroughly prepared regarding methods of instruction pertaining to all subject areas requiring these individuals to take an an additional 12 credit hours of redundant coursework on methods of instruction in other classroom environments will hamper efforts to recruit and retain Montessori teachers and therefore not resolve the issue that this application for an alternative pathway was intended to address.

[01:04:04] We'd ask the board to consider an amended version of what is before you. The Virginia code that establishes this option to apply for alternative routes states that the petitioner may proffer or the board may impose conditions in conjunction with the approval of such a petition.

[01:04:22] So I'm proffering that the board amend the proposal to remove the four additional courses currently listed for individuals to obtain their renewable license and instead restrict the license to teaching in a Montessori classroom. Most of the states who have already approved pathways to teaching licenses for Montessori credentialed teachers have placed such a restriction on those licenses.

[01:04:45] It's our understanding that those four courses were recommended in order to prepare teachers to be equipped to teach in any Virginia public school classroom. And we think the proposal as it stands can be an appropriate and useful pathway as a bridge for those leaving Montessori classrooms to teach in other Virginia public schools and would support it in that form for that purpose.

[01:05:11] Approval of this application with the amendments proposed ensure that children in virginia's public montessori schools have the teachers most qualified to teach in those classrooms while this application is coming from aps i'd also encourage the board to consider establishing this as a statewide pathway to licensure for montessori credentialed teachers as other states have done so that in the future montessori might be an option for families in other districts the process to this pathway is lengthy and burdensome and it does not make sense to ask other districts the department of education or this board to spend additional time on parallel applications in the future thank you for your time and for your

[01:05:50] consideration of this proposal and the amendments thank you monico grady followed by martin brown hi guys i'm back okay um my name is monico grady and i'm returning to testify regarding the arlington public school application for a way to more easily hire trained and qualified montessori teachers to work in APS Montessori classrooms. The Arlington School Board unanimously approved the application more than a year ago when I was still a member on the Arlington School Board.

[01:06:23] You may recall that APS is the only public Montessori program in the whole Commonwealth, and we have more than 50 years of data showing strong outcomes for our economically and racially diverse students. Montessori takes advantage of century-old educational pedagogy created by Italy's first female pediatrician. Maximizing movement, concentration, choice, individualization, intrinsic motivation, peer teaching, experiential learning, a good adult-child relationship, and simplicity. It adds in engaging materials in multi-age classrooms to produce limitless

[01:06:58] learning with successful outcomes. It takes a specially trained Montessori teacher to do all that and we must not let a required traditional teaching credential get in the way of hiring them especially when recent education department data show more than half of all public schools in the country were

understaffed at the start of the school year. Montessori is the widest practice pedagogy across the world and the largest alternative pedagogy in the U.S. with more than 560 public Montessori schools across the nation. The data tell us that Montessori education is

[01:07:34] successful not just in Arlington where Montessori pre-k students outperform VPI students but some of the most compelling public Montessori research is being done right at our own UVA and includes findings that show promising return on state and district investments. Our recent APS graduates who were in public Montessori middle school programs agree. Here's what they say. A UVA freshman told as Montessori helped him become or helped her become independent and develop time management skills. A Yale freshman says Montessori helped him discover a lot of different subjects and find his own niche. In Los Angeles, a Loyola Marymount University freshman said the discipline students

[01:08:14] developed in Montessori to get things done on their own really paid off during virtual learning. A JMU freshman said the ability to self-direct in Montessori helped him make better academic decisions through high school and Ohio University freshmen said Montessori helped her be successful in her AP classes by teaching her to be an independent student and ask questions when she needed help. We need your help to get Montessori to more APS students. Approving this application with just one tweak will do just that. We ask that you'll consider removing those four course requirements that would allow Montessori teachers to move into traditional public classrooms. We

[01:08:52] want and need those Montessori teachers to stay in those Montessori classrooms. We don't want them to leave and if you get rid of that barrier it'll help us hire the teachers. They won't have to spend more money for those extra classes. Please think about it today. Thanks you guys and thank you to Dr. Johnson and also Ms. Clemons for doing all the work to get us here. Thanks you guys. Good luck. Thank you. Martin Brown followed by Brendan Gillis. Good morning members of the board Mr. Chair.

[01:09:24] name is martin brown i serve as the chief diversity officer for commonwealth and here to speak in support of the new standards of learning the history standards first i want to start i guess by introducing myself obviously as the chief diversity officer i serve all the members of not just cabinet governor but people of virginia but also come from a history of people who've gone before me. My grandfather's grandfather was RGL Page. He was born in 1847. He was born a slave.

[01:10:01] From that, he escaped on Underground Railroad to Philadelphia, Boston. I was educated in Boston, moved back to Norfolk, became the first attorney, African-American attorney in Norfolk. From there, he actually served in our Commonwealth House of Delegates during Reconstruction. And he, in his efforts to affect history he spoke against lynching during that time he actually submitted legislation in that regard and he also mentioned that we should start a school

[01:10:39] in petersburg that now exists and uh needless to say he fought for all of us then i share a story because i believe that his story reflects and is actually told in our standards of learning and i I believe that the good, the bad, and the ugly have actually been communicated in these standards.

[01:11:03] These standards tell a story. They're more robust. They have more expanded content. The transformational impact, for example, of Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. is told as early as kindergarten with the teaching of ML King Day, identifying him as a changemaker and a champion in second grade, and the thorough coverage of his actions in the 11th grade, from his letter to the Birmingham Jail to his leadership in the Southern Christian Leadership Conference to his Ava Dream speech.

[01:11:37] Discussion of the causes and effects of not just the impact of racism, but even on our Native American Indian brothers are also communicated in these standards. The Trail of Tears, the Seminole Wars, the Indian removal policies are all communicated in these standards.

[01:12:01] development and implementation and the impact of the American Indian movement and the Indian Self-Determination and Education Assistance Act. These standards honor all recommendations of the African American History Education Commission as adopted by the 2020 Board of Education and the current draft curriculum frameworks. Incorporate feedback from diverse voices. I met with Secretary Gadara and Superintendent Bailo, with members of the the African-American Advisory Committee, African-American History Education Commission,

[01:12:38] and Hampton Roads Black Caucus. We encourage everyone to read these draft standards to inform the public engagement process, and we're grateful for the voices that have been shared here today. Mr. Brown, if you could wrap up your comments. Thank you.

[01:12:55] I just want to, I guess in summary, just want to communicate support for it. I want to encourage the board to adopt them and just communicate that the standards not only tell all of Virginia's history, they'd tell my family's history as well. Thank you. Thank you. Let me repeat again because we have so many people here for public comment. We are strictly enforcing as much as I can the three-minute limit. You know, I was brought up to be more polite than interrupting people when they're speaking, and it's painful every time I have to do it. So to the extent you could, you know, lessen my pain and end at about three minutes, I'd really appreciate it.

[01:13:35] Brendan Gillis followed by Marianne Burke. Good morning, Superintendent Bailo and board members. Thanks for having us here today. My name is Brendan Gillis. I'm the manager of teaching and learning at the American Historical Association. I have a PhD in history and more than a decade of teaching experience. I'm also a Virginia resident and a parent. This morning, you're going to hear from a lot of outraged Virginians. They may not tell you this, but I suspect that many of us many of the people who will be angry about aspects of these standards drafts

[01:14:15] actually share my gratitude for your willingness to listen and consider other points of view i was here in november when dozens of constituents gathered to criticize the frankly embarrassing draft standards proposed for first review i applaud your decision to table the radical november overhaul that said i urge you to move forward with the collaborative combined standards developed by the AHA, VASCD, and VASSLC and shared with you in December. The American Historical Association is a professional organization, not a politically oriented one like the Civics Alliance,

[01:14:52] Hillsdale College, and other out-of-state institutions with which this board has chosen to collaborate exclusively on this important project. Our 11,000 members share no overarching ideological project beyond a commitment to developing and communicating a richer understanding of the past. Our organization's clear preference for the December collaborative standards ought not to be taken lightly. The AHA's interest in this issue has and always will prioritize the education of our children over any other consideration. In that spirit, the AHA joined

[01:15:31] with five other organizations to offer a thorough response to the draft that is on the agenda for today, and I've handed out copies for you to review and for the record. There's plenty here to criticize, and much that I, as an educator, find utterly baffling. Who deleted all references to fascism from sections covering World War II? And why? How do you expect 11th graders to comprehend the full global military

and political significance of the Vietnam War if it is taught, as you suggest, as a domestic social movement? Why do these 11th grade standards start in 1492, as if North America did not have a history before European explorers showed up.

[01:16:11] Superintendent Bailo, you apologize for referring to Native Americans as first immigrants. Was the only alternative to ignore this history entirely? Our joint statement notes only the most obvious concerns. Conversely, the AHA and our collaborators would like to hear an intelligent critique of our version, our proposed standards.

[01:16:34] And just in closing, I'd like to reiterate our offer to advise and support you in this very very important process thank you thank you marianne burke followed by darcy kayaba hi i'm marianne burke uh i have three children who've gone through the public education system in um

[01:17:02] virginia k-12 and uh colleges and one almost phd um and good morning when the chiefs beat the bengals last sunday night i realized that for the first time in history both teams going to Super Bowl have started starting quarterbacks who are black. That jogged a memory for me. Back in the 1980s, when Randall Cunningham was picked by the Eagles, my dad said, Cunningham should not be quarterback because he was not smart enough because he's black.

[01:17:41] I wondered where I got that information, and I think I found it. Samuel Morton, who in the early 1800s studied the shape and size of human skulls and surmised that the characteristics of the human skull indicated level of intelligence. He concluded, based on his biased studies that have since been debunked, that human races were created separately and unequally. Those who believe in racial hierarchy and chattel slavery celebrated and amplified Morton's unfounded conclusions. The studies that debunked Morton's claims have not been amplified or become part of

[01:18:21] our revised understanding. For generations, false information has contributed to systematic racism in our society, so it is imperative that students be provided all the true information available to formulate their opinions. This is not indoctrination, and personal or political advantage are not more important than giving our children what they need to be productive and reasonable members of society. I read all four versions of the revised standards,

[01:18:54] The August version was comprehensive, factual, unbiased, and also provided the curriculum framework in one package. I think it will be hard to beat that version, but that is not where we are. We all know Governor Youngkin rejected the November version, but my recollection is that the Board wanted the DOE to merge the August and November versions into a new version.

[01:19:18] In January, the DOE released another version. I have quite a few issues with that version and only have time to mention a few. There are errors and omissions, and it is political. I am happy to elaborate further if you would like me to.

[01:19:35] In December, a collaborative version was released, but not by DOA. That version did actually merge the August and November versions into an acceptable document, but there was not a curriculum framework and we need to review that part.

[01:19:50] So I maintain that the August version is what would be most useful to our students and that we need to see the curriculum framework, please. - Thank you. Darcy Calleba, followed by Linda Deans, too many people talking to me at once here, Darcy Calleba, which I'm sure is being mispronounced, and Dr. Linda Deans.

[01:20:21] Good morning.

[01:20:37] Good morning. I am Dr. Linda Deans. I'm a retired educator from the state of Virginia and retired from the state of North Carolina. So I have about 40 years of educational experience. participated with the group that came up with those collaborative social studies standards way back when and i believe that those standards are more comprehensive than those that you have now so i say no to the january standards and i say yes to those collaborative ones that had deans

[01:21:11] of education teachers parents pastors all involved and over an 18-month period of collaboration to come up with those standards so to just delete them there are more pressing things for the board of education to do such as those thoughts that were presented today related to the schools in Arlington. So I say to you that we need to look at things that are more thoroughly developed,

[01:21:47] not things that are thrown together for political purposes. The current standards require rote memory from the time that I was in school in the 60s. The old standards require our students to participate in critical thinking. So I'd like for you to compare and contrast before you vote. And the new standards are going to put a financial burden on local school districts the textbooks

[01:22:23] that first of all have to be rewritten and the textbooks that have to be repurchased for professional development for teacher education programming for assessments field tests have already taken place with the old standards why would you redo something that's already taken place so i ask you to consider from an old educator that you would consider doing what's best for the students and i believe it is best for my five-year-old and my 12-year-old granddaughter

[01:23:00] thank you so much okay pastor michelle thomas followed by uh machia little good morning i'm I'm Pastor Michelle Thomas.

[01:23:24] I'm the president of the Loudoun NAACP branch. I'm also the founder and president of the Loudoun Freedom Center. And in 2019, I was appointed to the governor's history, African-American History Education Commission.

[01:23:42] I'm happy to be here today, but sad that we have to fight this good fight of massive resistance all over again. This is the new massive resistance, the old massive resistance fought against African Americans being allowed in schools to be allowed to have an education alongside with everybody else.

[01:24:09] this new massive resistance fight against students learning about African-American history. That would put African-American history, indigenous people's history, all the other histories, AAPI history, on equal footing with European history. You could see it all throughout the curriculum.

[01:24:31] Unfortunately, in 2019, or actually beautifully in 2019, 39 of us, 39 educators, 39 folks that were museum curators, 39 people who have worked in the education field for many, many years got together and we developed the most collaborative SOLs and curriculum framework that this Virginia has ever seen.

[01:25:00] I was very proud of it. My son, unfortunately, died in 2020, in June. I continued my work. I buried my son and continued my work because the sons that would graduate from Loudon and the sons that would graduate from Virginia public schools needed me to show up, needed me to share my voice so that we wouldn't have to fight this fight again.

[01:25:28] However, let me show you what's happening because of some of the inappropriate content and some of the rote learning and some of the mistakes and omissions. Here's what you're giving us. This is

what you're forcing upon us. First of all, this S.O. Wells and the curriculum framework is not viable.

[01:25:47] It is impossible to impose 187 historical figures on people without any context. Sure, you talk about Benjamin Banneker, but you don't tell who he is. He's simply a footnote. In the fifth grade, I'm sorry, in the second grade, you teach inappropriately out of time.

[01:26:09] You teach the Revolutionary War, the War of 1812. Do you remember the War of 1812 in the second grade? Can you imagine that you have all of this? And I know I'm over time, but it's going to cost millions of dollars.

[01:26:27] because you want to teach U.S. history in fifth grade and you want to teach world geography in eighth grade. In order to do that, we're going to have to retest. We're going to have to have new SOLs. We're going to have to pay for millions of dollars of books. It is burdensome. It's unrealistic. We deserve better. I'm asking you in Black History Month to do the right thing,

[01:26:52] not just for black people but for all students good morning and thank you for your time and your service um i am akia little and in 2019 while helping my youngest child study for the virginia studies sol i asked her the question from her study guide what was the status of the early africans when she responded with the answer unknown without looking back at the paper i told her that wasn't right so she decided to expand on her answer by saying they were either slaves

[01:27:30] or servants?" As the graduate of an HBCU where African-American is a required first-year course, I was disappointed that she would give such an answer, being a smart little girl, until I looked back at the study guide and saw that was exactly the answer that was on the paper: unknown, period. They were either slaves or servants. Seeing that's what students in Virginia were learning all throughout the commonwealth i was triggered in a way that sent me on a course to engage with the northern administration with the help of the late congressman elijah cummings

[01:28:08] and because of that engagement i was appointed as the parent and hbcu advocate of the african american history education commission there seems to be erroneous messaging surrounding the inclusive set of standards and curriculum presented to you for approval last year that somehow the voices of parents and concern in certain groups were left out not only is that completely false when you bypassed the august 20 2022 set of standards and curriculum what you said

[01:28:42] to parents who look like me is that our voices don't count and that the educational experiences of our children aren't as important as those of other children that when you say you want to ensure parents have rights you're not talking about parents who look like me i understand that some of the topics taught and discussed may be uncomfortable for some children but if my child has to experience the discomfort of racism as early as elementary school both they and their peers can learn about it side by side so i stand before you today to add my voice to the course

[01:29:23] of hundreds of Virginians who actually contributed to the already collaborative August 2022 set of standards and curriculum by asking that you vote to move that version forward for citizen comments and add the information that this other group has has added in that process as it reflects the will of all Virginians versus a set of out-of-state consultants who do not have the best interests of our children and future citizens at heart.

[01:29:59] Robin Burke followed by Barbara Lewis. Good morning.

[01:30:24] Good morning. Good morning. I'm Barbara Laws, Policy Chair for the Virginia Coalition for Fine Arts Education. March is Youth Art Month and Dance, Music, and Theater in Our Schools Month. So I'd like briefly on behalf of the Coalition to talk about how the arts help students develop skills, understandings, and habits of mind which will support them as they move forward into our rapidly changing and ever more complex world.

[01:30:57] The late Elliot Eisner, former Stanford University professor who developed 10 lessons the arts teach, summarizes what high level regular instruction in the arts provides for students. He speaks to the power of learning and the arts to help students make good qualitative judgments, realize that many problems have more than one solution and questions more than one answer. Communicate in ways outside of the limits of language, and understand that complex problem solving and creativity require responding to off-changing context and circumstance.

[01:31:33] Envisioning solutions in the midst of ambiguity is at the heart of 21st century skills our students need. In addition to the inherent benefits gained through participation in art, dance, theater, and music, students involved in the arts develop and exercise perseverance and persistence, work collaboratively, and take responsibility for learning independently.

[01:31:55] Further, research strongly suggests that students who participate in quality fine arts programs are more engaged, attend school on a more regular basis, develop leadership capacity, and ultimately in high school, graduate at a higher rate. Virginia's Arts Education Associations work with the Coalition to kick off the month's celebrations with Arts Across Virginia Day on the first Friday of march this year the third the day is intended to raise awareness of the importance of the arts in the schools and of the many ways the arts impact our communities we invite all members of

[01:32:32] arts and arts education communities to provide a snapshot of the arts on one day by posting to hashtag artsacrossva2023 we also invite parents school administrators decision makers policy makers and others who support the arts to join us by posting their arts experiences or their support.

[01:32:52] Finally, we would like to thank you and the Department of Education for your support of arts education and we invite you to see and hear for yourself the evidence of the power of arts learning in the many celebratory school dance music and theater performances and art exhibitions held in March and throughout the rest of the year. Thank you. Thank you. Chris Jones, followed by Taylor Snow. Good morning President Gecker, Vice President Mann, members of the board, Superintendent Bailo. My name is Chris Jones and I'm the

[01:33:30] executive director for the Virginia affiliate of ASCD. I'm also the father of four glow sticks of love who attend Virginia's public schools in fourth, seventh, ninth, and eleventh grades. I certainly have a vested interest in their learning experiences. Thank you for allowing me to stand before you today.

[01:33:45] It is an honor to do so. I'm here to make clear why the January draft of history and social science standards proposed by Superintendent Bailo are are neither suitable nor viable to guide history and social science education in Virginia schools for the next seven years. I'm also here to speak on behalf of the collaborative standards that our organization, along with VSSLC and AHA, submitted to you on December 20th, and why those standards are the ones to accept for first review.

[01:34:10] To begin, the process led by Superintendent Bailo between August 17th until now has clearly not followed that which was previously approved by this board. The process that Superintendent Bailo

adopted to rewrite the standards was neither collaborative nor inclusive of the voices of Virginia educators, historians, parents, students, and museum curators.

[01:34:30] The January draft proposed by Superintendent Bailo seems to have followed a similar pattern. The draft proposed by VSSLC, VASCD, and AHA in December clearly delineates what was present in August and what was present in November, along with our group's enhancements and a connection to the 2015 standards of learning.

[01:34:48] Second, the standards clearly do not emphasize the five C's from the profile of a Virginia graduate and the durable skills students will need to be future, life, college, or career ready. The January standards not only maintain a focus on rote memorization, they are also so dense in nature that levels of engagement will plummet.

[01:35:07] Our response letter sent to you on January 17th details how many standards were included with absolutely no instructional time added. To illustrate, second grade has added 21 standards, and world geography has 35 more when compared with the December collaborative standards.

[01:35:23] With the January standards, there will be no deeper learning in our classrooms, and the quality of instruction our children deserve will decline. Simply by the nature of the number of standards teachers will be required to cover and the depth and complexity lacking in them. A simple analysis of the verbs will give you insight into what that will look like.

[01:35:41] To illustrate, in the 12th grade Virginia and United States government class, in a student's final year before graduation, the verbs understand and describe show up a total of 35 times, while verbs like design, connect, synthesize, critique, create, and prove show up collectively just four.

[01:36:00] The Commonwealth is struggling with trust right now. You can regain trust and restore confidence in this governing body and credibility in the process by accepting the December collaborative standards that we submitted on December 20th for first review to use as a quality set of standards for a baseline to move forward to review the for the review process. Thank you.

[01:36:20] Thank you. Taylor Snow followed by Andrea Relator. Good morning. My name is Dr. Taylor Snow. I'm the secondary social studies specialist for Enrico County Public Schools, but I'm here today.

[01:36:36] as an educator and someone who has grave concerns about what Superintendent Balo will propose as standards later today and what they would do to students like I was. I grew up in the 80s and 90s in Pulaski County, Virginia, and my family is from Lee County. My mom's a retired English teacher.

[01:36:52] My dad is a retired materials handling supervisor from Volvo Heavy Trucks. I grew up knowing that even if most politicians felt like Virginia stopped in Roanoke, there were people fighting for us. Rick Boucher, Bob Goodlap, Jackie Stump, those were people who had our back. So that's why I'm here today to speak for where I'm from. At an American Enterprise Institute forum, Secretary Gadara noted that the goal of the Yunkin administration was reorienting everything to how is education geared towards preparing people for the jobs of today and of tomorrow. Let's hear

[01:37:29] from some of those jobs. These lines are from actual job descriptions for jobs at Amazon's new Arlington headquarters. We are looking for someone who demonstrates sound judgment even in ambiguous situations. You identify when implementations are not highly available or have defects and you investigate systemic patterns. You will have the ability to think strategically, act tactically, write effectively,

and display strong analytical and critical thinking skills. If workplace readiness for all of our students is truly important to this administration, then our history standards should be designed to prepare people for those jobs. So the question

[01:38:08] I would ask you all to consider is how do the standards that will be presented later today do that? Nothing in any of the job postings I read say anything about hiring candidates who can memorize long lists of names devoid of context. There's nothing about being able to choose the right European monarch from a list of 10. I ask you, is there anything in the standards that will be shared that can ensure that students will be able to do any of these things better while memorizing a list of discreet and sometimes factually incorrect talking points do anything to help students think strategically, act actively, write effectively, and display strong analytical

[01:38:46] and critical thinking skills. As I said, I grew up in Pulaski, and we lost our furniture factories. We lost our textile mills, and we were lucky because we had Volvo. They invested in our community, they worked with the United Auto Workers, and were a consistent source of high-paying work.

[01:39:02] Why did they do that when they could have left? They could have done what the furniture factories and textile mills did and left our community broken. But they didn't because our schools had already invested in equipping students with the skills they would need to take those high-paying jobs. Our schools made sure that in all of our classes we were getting the soft skills that we would need for the workforce to think critically, work collaboratively, and use inquiry to solve problems. And how did they manage to find the time to do that? Our schools didn't have their hands tied by asking us to memorize history as a list of decontextualized facts. Even though I

[01:39:35] chose to follow my mother's path i'm so grateful for what that partnership did for me so in short by taking by taking the seat that you're in and i promise i will hurry from pennington gap to tanger island our students deserve the kind of social studies education that i receive instruction that will prepare them for the jobs of today and tomorrow when they when those jobs come to grundy and big stone gap and montrose and martinsville will you have done all that you can to make sure that students of those communities are prepared for those jobs thank you thank you i'm going to

[01:40:11] try not to mispronounce your name again so i hope you are who you're supposed to be thank you and followed by terrell fleming okay good morning um my name is andrea mendoza and i am a 19 year educator in social studies i am also expecting my first child so i'm excited to be a parent and i I want to speak to you about the collaborative standards and moving forward with those standards compared to the January standards brought forth by the VDOE. I have a degree in history and education and master's and curriculum instruction from George Mason, and I spent most of my time in

[01:40:50] the classroom as a government teacher for seniors. And when you teach seniors, you have a lot of anxiety about thinking they're going to go out in the world right after they're done with me, and you think about, am I getting them ready? And so we kind of, in teacher talk, talk about the end in mind and backwards planning. So I participated in an externship with companies in Loudoun and asked employers, what do you want in your employees? And they consistently said they need communicators and they need collaborators and they need people who understand perspectives.

[01:41:23] They can, employers can teach people content in their trade and they can teach them how to use different platforms, but they don't, they're looking for candidates and there's lots of open positions because they can't find the right candidates. So the curriculum, the standards, excuse me, that are the

collaborative standards are much better fit to prepare our students for the future of the workforce. And when we also think about the military, so we have some teachers who are veterans and they have created lessons that help students understand what is decision make important decision making in war and so thinking about those skills about decision making

[01:42:01] cause and effect all of that type of instruction can come out of the collaborative standards compared to the virginia uh the doe january standards where we don't need an encyclopedia britannica in our standards we need students to understand how are they going to find the information to answer the questions and solve the problems so some people think the end goal of social studies is the objective test if i'm going to say to a parent your child got 60 on the egypt test doesn't tell them anything they're going on to virginia studies the next year but if i can tell parents well we studied how geography impacts society and we're going to talk

[01:42:41] about it again next year and we're going to keep talking about it so here are some things you can do at home to practice cause and effect parents can understand that and employers they don't care if you got passed or passed advanced on history SOL. That is not the end goal for us in social studies. The value of social studies, which I think the authors of the January drafts don't understand, is that social studies education helps people understand how their decisions and actions impact people in societies. It's not, what am I going to get on this objective test? The people

[01:43:14] who care about that are the people making money off objective tests. So, okay, great. Thank you. Thank you. Darrell Fleming, followed by Chris Buden. Good afternoon or good morning. My name, and I would appreciate some of you, I can't see you.

[01:43:35] My name is Darrell Fleming. I'm a K-12 product of Virginia Public Schools. I grew up in Powhatan, Virginia, proud product of Powhatan Public Schools. And I can tell you from my experience, the power of public education. Neither of my parents are higher ed graduates. I have my undergraduate degree from Longwood University, a public institution, my master's degree in educational administration from Virginia Commonwealth University. And I'm coming to

[01:44:06] speak to you as a student who experienced the 1995 original SOL standards to an educator to now a parent of a kindergartner in Chesterfield County Public Schools. As I look back on my educational experience in Virginia, one of the things that is highlighted for me was the fact that we did teach social studies. But one of the facts that still remained in my mind today from when I was a high school student taking World History II was the lack of diversity and perspectives

[01:44:42] that were present in our standards. You might look at the January 6th standards as they are an improvement. They are an improvement from the horrible standards that were presented, and I repeat that, horrible standards that were presented in November. There's a lack of diversity. There's a lack of understanding of developmentally what is appropriate for students to learn, and there's a lack of representation from different groups of people to ensure that people who look like me,

[01:45:18] who look like other members of the board were accurately represented and so that students of the 21st century or students of today find themselves in the curriculum. If I can go back as a public school student and realize that I wasn't present, the students that I speak with today as a social studies educator, a social studies leader, and a parent can see the same thing and i advise you as you go forward and think about what your legacy and what you want it to be you have a chance today to make a decision that is going to impact the students of virginia for

[01:45:58] the next seven years and those students are my daughter those students are my nephews those students are my little cousins we are all going to be products and have products of virginia public schools and it is important for you to realize that whatever set of standards that are presented whether they're from the superintendent or not represent diverse perspectives so that all students can see themselves seen heard in the curriculum and do not feel that they are a footnote of history

[01:46:32] thank you have a great day all right uh chris bunin and then the board is going to take a five-minute break first off great job it looks like bunning but it sounds like being nice job all right um good morning and thanks for allowing me to speak to you i will tell you i appreciate the positive affirmation this week yeah right on so um my name is chris piena and i teach world history geography and geospatial technologies at albemarle high school i also teach geography

[01:47:09] for the virginia community college system and uva i'm a book and curriculum author and received multiple recognitions this includes being named the 2016 national social studies teacher of the year and a 2020 national geographic society explorer first thank you to the board for rejecting the the November history and social science standards. As a teacher and parent, it was clear these were hastily and poorly written and would improperly guide instruction. For the first time in my 23 years in the classroom, I found myself driving here to urge you to reject the January standards or any standards BDUA has put forward for social studies. These standards will negatively impact

[01:47:47] instruction. One, the number of additional facts my elementary age children will be required to learn are unrealistic. My wife's a second grade teacher. When I asked her her thoughts about teaching an additional 21 to 22 standards she said it'll be nearly impossible to teach that much content well and is certainly age inappropriate adding 70 facts demonstrates a lack of perspective and awareness of what's really going on in our elementary classrooms by adopting these standards you acknowledge you favor facts over lifelong learning two what's up with encouraging or discouraging teacher created materials you can look it up given the variety of a social emotional

[01:48:23] and academic needs of our students. I don't want my kid to learn from some teacher who's never met them. We deserve personalized instruction. Universal curriculum will lead teachers to depersonalize instruction. It's inauthentic and will leave many children behind. Three, where are the modern tools and approaches of geography? The world geography as well as are literally the seventh grade skills, the 10th grade skills. No effort to make it even feel like a kid is learning geography. Geography is a social studies discipline, not just history and civics. Again, geography is a social studies subject, not just history and civics. Navstar GPS came out in 2000,

[01:49:03] Google Earth came out in 2001, and there's no mention of giving our kids modern tools for the modern jobs this guy mentioned to you. Finally, why not the collaborative standards? They did your assignment best. The standards are realistic, accessible, consistent, and manageable. On the hand, the January review standards are not viable. Many standards are overwhelming and others are simply underwhelming and inaccurate. There are puzzling omissions and generalizations that will make teaching an unbiased and honest history impractical. I urge you, the board, to accept

[01:49:36] the alternative collaborative standards for first review. Thank you. Thank you. All right, we are going to recess for five. When we come back, it'll be Wesley Hitchpath and Cheryl Binkley.

[01:49:53] thank you all say in seven years first time i got to use the gavel i appreciate that opportunity

[02:00:38] and welcome back we will continue public comment wesley hedgpeth good morning superintendent good morning to the board i'm wesley hedgpeth i'm a local social studies teacher i am a past president of the virginia council for the social studies and the current president-elect of the national council for the social studies the development of education standards has often led to some political undertones, and for that reason, NCSS has consistently avoided commenting on specific social studies content and skills standards. Throughout our Century Plus history as an

[02:01:15] organization, our position has remained consistent that the standards should be grounded in content area scholarship, reflect best practices in social studies education, and be inclusive of all student backgrounds and ability levels. Our ultimate interest in social studies standards has always been that the standards use social studies curriculum and lesson development uh excuse me social studies curriculum and lesson development produce students who have strong content knowledge strong inquiry and analysis skills and who are ready to be active citizens and civic life although ncss has consistently avoided commenting on specific standards the current political climate

[02:01:52] is resulting in the development of standards that do not align with our rigorous expectations in addition some organizations state legislators school board members and community members have misrepresented or misunderstood the content and the purpose of ncss guiding documents as such in september of 2022 ncss issued a statement for the development and the adoption of social studies standards i will summarize the statement into eight points however the full statement and all other documents that i will reference can be found online at socialstudies.org as the largest organization devoted exclusively to the teaching and learning of social studies

[02:02:27] NCSS stands firm in the belief that that one, the process should be transparent and should align with best practices. Two, social studies standards should include both content and skills and should be rooted in the pedagogy that promotes inquiry and disciplinary literacy as defined by our C3 framework. Social studies standards developers should include themes and content that help students understand all social studies disciplines in a way that enables them to appreciate the past, understand the present and impact the future social studies standards should help students understand that not only history not only is history complicated but not all people have

[02:03:06] experienced history government geography and economics in the same way social studies standards should allow students to analyze the u.s and other nations and recognizing that they have systems that are often based on race or ethnicity that results in political economic and social success for some while resulting in the struggles for others six social studies standards should include the ideas values and experiences of both western history and the history of the non-western world seven social studies standards should not minimize topics such as enslavement and systemic racism and should not present them as simply deviations from american progress i'll finish in just a

[02:03:46] second i'm sorry and finally the social studies standards should promote civil discourse and the discussion of diverse perspectives biases and motivations students should engage in these diverse ideas in ways that do not glorify or defend those who have engaged in historic enslavement misogyny homophobia genocide or racism ncss is not alone in our concern we join the other organizations that support the collaborative draft the january draft is not viable and i urge you to

[02:04:13] support the collaborative draft thank you carol binkley followed by vicky hobson hello is it still morning. It is. My name is Cheryl Binkley. You will be grateful I'm not talking about the social studies

standards. However, that doesn't mean I'm not talking about problems. Each of you come to sit here this morning with a long history and set of experiences about education,

[02:04:49] and what I'm wanting to invite you to do is an exercise. We talk a lot about data, data, details analysis learning is micro based on micro data not on macro data it's that instance when in a classroom or in a field or wherever there's an interchange and an interaction that awakens the student to discover and to wake up to this amazing awe-inspiring kind of thing

[02:05:25] that is learning. And that only happens in the micro in a classroom with a facilitator who is helping that student discover. Occasionally we can do it by ourselves, but the point is that I would like to challenge the board to individually go to three public schools, general public schools, not magnets, not super schools, not special schools, but publics ordinary every day to an elementary, a middle, and a high, go into a classroom,

[02:06:03] observe it, and look deep into the eyes and faces of the students in that room and the way the teachers are interacting with them. You will then understand the micro data that you need to know to implement policies that will support them in that effort, because it is not, I talk about it as though it's magic, but it's also a master art that must be done well, and it needs lots of

[02:06:36] supports. So ask yourselves then, from after you do that, what am, what is the policy I'm considering likely to do to that micro interchange in this classroom with this child, with these kids, because that's where the action is. Okay, so that's your homework assignment from the teacher who teaches teachers, which was my last gig until we didn't have any more people wanting to be teachers. But at any rate, my other thing I want to bring to your attention today is my concern

[02:07:14] about your top appointees and i will supply that in writing particularly about the lab schools where our top appointees are going around the state telling people you don't have to do all those things for application just give us something and it'll be okay okay thank you thank you uh vicki hobson followed by ann evans good morning everyone thank you so much for having me today my name is dr vicki hobson and i'm a parent of elementary age public school children a former public elementary school educator and central office administrator and i'm currently an

[02:07:53] assistant professor of elementary education where i teach elementary social studies methods among other things i hold a master's of teaching in elementary ed and a doctorate in curriculum and instruction from the university of virginia for my credentials it should be clear that i'm deeply invested in and a staunch supporter of public education i'm here today because the standards put forth by superintendent balo on january 6th are riddled with the same issues that plague the draft that was presented on november 17th despite my name being listed by the vdoe as having participated in date in the review and revision of the 2015 standards i want to state for the public record i had nothing to do with the january draft and called for a transparent list of contributors

[02:08:30] to that draft to be shared the january draft standards are unrealistic and contain a vast quantity of facts people and events that require rote memorization and are age inappropriate for our youngest learners as a veteran elementary educator this causes me to truly wonder if the writers of the January 6 standards have any experience or understanding of the characteristics of high quality early childhood and elementary education. Developmentally appropriate social study standards are not learning about Yorktown Victory Day as stated in January SOL K.2b when five-year-olds have no context or understanding of the American Revolution and its significance.

[02:09:05] Developmentally appropriate social study standards are not January SOL 2.9b which requires second graders to learn about the war of 1812 an exceptionally complex conflict involving expansion international trade and maritime rights a topic that historians from the aha deemed too complex to warrant an inclusion in elementary school developmentally appropriate social study standards are not january sol 2.4b which has second graders learning about the state motto and the image on the virginia state flag in its meeting this is far too complex for students to understand in terms of needed context and background knowledge and it's further socially inappropriate to expose seven and eight-year-old children to depictions of nudity and political

[02:09:45] violence and assassination. Developmentally appropriate social study standards are not requiring elementary age students to memorize 85 different historical figures in grades K-5, 36 people in grade 2 alone. Our students deserve better. This is what the collaborative standards put forth by the VSSLC, VASCD, and AHA on December 20, 2023 provide to Virginia students.

[02:10:08] These standards were carefully drafted to ensure high-quality history and social science education for Virginia students. They're inclusive, they're historically accurate, they're rigorous, they're developmentally appropriate, and they have been vetted and recommended by numerous trusted educational and historical institutions and organizations from across the Commonwealth and country.

[02:10:28] The January standards are simply not viable, and I urge the board to accept the alternative collaborative standards for first review. Ann Evans, followed by Bo Dickinson.

[02:10:44] And I'll skip the salutations in the interest of time. Today we heard from dedicated educators, concerned parents, and allies across the Commonwealth expressing our collective concerns about the lack of transparency, ignoring the voices of those of us most closely engaged and qualified to revise the standards.

[02:11:01] In my 34th year teaching in Virginia, I support teachers and students engaging in uncovering the hidden stories of American history using geospatial technologies and digital humanities tools to visualize data, analyze maps, search archives, examine artifacts, and explore historical sites to see themselves in the story of America. The August draft provided opportunities for exploring history and geography via inquiry, developing habits of mind to become critical thinkers, community leaders, and good neighbors. Sadly, the board cast that draft aside. It was not in a traditional format and included unfamiliar names and stories that many of us did not learn

[02:11:39] grade school. They weren't written for us. They were written for today's students, harnessing the power of inquiry, encouraging students to ask questions and solve problems. They were written to ensure that every child sitting in a 5th, 7th, 11th grade history class saw themselves in the story of America. They are the most honest, complete telling of history we have ever aspired to teach in Virginia. They were designed to help students build historical empathy and respect for their nation while recognizing we still have much work to be done in the pursuit of liberty and justice for all. The department wasted time and money recruiting outside consultants whose

[02:12:15] viewpoints did not reflect the values and goals of most Virginia families, bypassing the transparent process established to revise our state standards. The January draft undermines the progress we've made moving away from road memorization and teaching to the test. Students need skills to understand how everything happening today is related to everything that happened in the past.

[02:12:35] your actions erode the public faith in your leadership. This brings us to here today. Before you are two sets of standards. One prepared, absent of the input of content experts or the voices of classroom teachers. It relies on antiquated notions of an America that never truly existed. Looking at the past through a Eurocentric lens, lacking age-appropriate content and setting our students up for failure and mistrust in their parents, their schools and their leaders. Ban all the books you want, pass a set of standards full of semi-truths, disjointed and confusing our students as they are confronted with the truth about history

[02:13:11] on multiple devices through movies and video games. Despite these efforts to suppress and distort the truth, history surrounds our students and much of it they encounter outside of the classroom, leaving them suspicious when what they are learning in class does not match the reality of their everyday lives. The second choice is embrace the collaborative standards representing the shared values and voices of Virginia. This draft holds space for students to question, observe, debate, discuss, analyze, and articulate solutions. Recognizing as a nation while we have much to celebrate, there is still work to be done to attain liberty and justice for all. Thank you.

[02:13:54] Bo Dickinson followed by Dr. Israel. Good morning and thank you for the opportunity to speak here today. My name is Bo Dickinson. I'm a nationally board-certified teacher with over a decade of classroom experience. The past 10 years, I've served as the history and social science supervisor for Rockingham County Public Schools, and I'm the past president and current treasurer of the Virginia Social Studies Leaders Consortium. I'm also proud to say that I was part of, as an educator and educator leader, the Governor's Commission on African American History Education.

[02:14:26] I'm here to speak in opposition to the January draft standards that were submitted by the state superintendent. Virginia Code has been talked about quite a bit, so I feel it appropriate to quote Virginia Code as it says, standards of learning in all subject areas shall be subject to regular review and revision to maintain rigor, which of course we all agree with, and to reflect a balance between content knowledge and the application of content knowledge. Given that January draft adds 132 additional standards without increasing instructional time, it is simply

[02:15:04] undeniable that these standards do not meet the very code that governs this review and revision process. This amount of content knowledge is unrealistic, unsustainable, and just poorly designed. This outdated approach of simply memorizing content knowledge that teaches students what to think and not how to think. As we all know, the clock and the calendar are of course constants. The class period is not going to get longer, and there are still only 180 school days

[02:15:37] in the school calendar. I sincerely ask this board, where is the instructional time coming from in order to actually teach an additional 132 standards? How are teachers going to do this with fidelity? Let's look at Virginia U.S. history in the 11th grade just as a brief example. The January draft has added almost 20 new standards to a curriculum that i have to say personally teaching myself for 10 years was already overburdened with required content we also need to keep in mind that most school divisions in the commonwealth are on a block schedule with 90-minute classes that meet

[02:16:15] every other day therefore out of 180 school days there are approximately 90 high school class periods in a given year the january draft contains 104 standards and substandards in virginia u.s history. So there are actually more standards than there are actual class periods. This is simply unsustainable and

unviable. I don't know how a teacher will do this, honestly. This does not even include snow days, assemblies, field trips, guest speakers, projects, or even days for tests

[02:16:50] and assessments. This is simply not viable. This curriculum cannot be taught in any given year, and I urge the board to accept the collaborative standards for first review. Thank you. Thank you. Greetings to distinguished board members. I'm Dr. Masayahu Israoul, the president of the Virginia Social Studies Leaders Consortium. Our organization is made up

[02:17:25] of teacher leaders, social studies coordinators, supervisors, museum educators, and college professors who teach, engage, and support social studies instruction in the commonwealth. We are one of the largest organizations for history and social studies leaders in the commonwealth. Our executive committee is led by five social studies educators with advanced degrees in education and three of the five have terminal doctoral degrees in education as president i've earned a specialist degree in curriculum and instruction and a doctoral degree in curriculum and instruction

[02:17:58] with an emphasis on k-12 social studies instruction though an academic doctor i'm not a medical doctor and it would be unwise for anyone to ask me to treat their child for a physical sickness or issue It would also be morally wrong for me to do so under the guise of being a doctor.

[02:18:17] We would not go to even the best dermatologist in order to have a kidney transplant or to receive consultation on brain surgery. We would not have a comic book artist, no matter how acclaimed or skilled, to draft engineering plans for the next state-of-the-art skyscraper.

[02:18:37] So why would the Virginia Department of Education's leadership not call upon the experts in Virginia with regard to the drafting of the January standards? VSSLC members have been a part of the standards development process for over a decade until the development of the state superintendent's November standards.

[02:18:58] We were not asked to partner, nor was our open letter to the VDOE leadership questioning the standards process and our absence in that process ever responded to. As of today, there are 10 organizations which have rejected the superintendent's January standards draft, and those same organizations have called for the acceptance of the collaborative standards drafted by the three leading organizations in history and education, the SSLC, VASCD, and the AHA.

[02:19:25] Some of these organizations are the NAACP Virginia State Conference, the National Council for History Education, Charlottesville Clergy Collective, the Virginia Geographic Alliance. The state superintendent stated publicly that the January draft, and I quote, incorporates input from more than 200 reviewers over the course of two years.

[02:19:50] Is this statement clear? We know that the November standards draft had nine organizations persons helping its creation. The next iteration of those standards was publicly released on January the 6th of this year. When did the two-year process begin? We asked the board to, number one, release the names of all of the actors in the January standards for public review.

[02:20:12] Not those in 2015, not those in November, but just January. And in the end, we ask that you accept the collaborative standards by the VSSLC, AHA, and VSCD. Thank you so much. John Hobson, followed by Scott Raybrand.

[02:20:39] Hello, my name is John Hobson, and I'm speaking to you both as an educator and as a parent of two elementary children in Virginia public schools. As past president of the Virginia Social Studies Leaders Consortium, I was involved in the original process to draft the standards that started in January 2020.

[02:21:01] and the collaborative draft produced by the VSSLC, VASCD, and the AHA. I'm proud to have been a part of both of these endeavors because these processes reflected the democratic deliberation and consensus building that are hallmarks of our discipline. The process that yielded the November and the January drafts reflects the opposite.

[02:21:21] I'm here to tell you that process matters. The process that was originally laid out by the VDOE in the January 2020 made sure to include the voices of teachers, social studies leaders, experts in the field, the museum and historical sites community, public interest groups, and parents. This process was intended to solicit a broad range of viewpoints and to build consensus. It is particularly important that educators feel invested in the process because ultimately they are going to be the ones that have to implement the standards in the associated frameworks. If teachers and social studies leaders do not buy into these standards,

[02:21:55] they are dead letter. The process to produce the new standards document was upended with the publication of the November draft and the subsequent January draft, which largely ignored the 20 months of work that was initiated in January 2020. Largely done in secret, this draft substituted the collective wisdom and expertise of the original draft with a set of standards that are produced by people and institutions that are distrustful of public education and educators.

[02:22:22] This is a dangerous precedent to set because it opens the door for any new administration to come in and ignore the process which was designed to build consensus. This will lead the way for the production of standards to be a political football subject to who's in power and will deny students and educators any sense of continuity and coherence with their social studies curricula. This process should be both above board and apolitical. Instead, the lack of transparency and the obvious partisan bias has undermined the credibility of what is produced by the state superintendent. I want to highlight one very telling part of the front matter in the

[02:22:57] January draft, which pertains to the implementation of the standards. It reads as follows. The curriculum selected by a local school board should provide a level of consistency and comprehension so that teacher-created curriculum is unnecessary. This statement reflects two biases of these authors. First, they view social studies as a curriculum that can be scripted. This is reflected in the standards that they produce, which largely ignores the complexity of our discipline in favor of simplistic narratives and discrete facts. This will be convenient for textbook companies, but bad for students secondly they are distrustful of teachers who want to hold them accountable to a

[02:23:35] script standards documents curriculum frameworks textbooks and other instructional resources are not and never will be fully realized curriculum a curriculum is built by teachers that know their students and their context using those standards frameworks and instructional resources the january january draft standards are simply not viable and i urge the board to accept the alternative collaborative standards for first review thank you thank you scott braebrand followed by allison brown good morning chairman gecker superintendent baylow members of the board of education hope all

[02:24:13] of you are well first of all i want to thank superintendent baylow for attending our vast winter conference we discussed workforce development initiatives we had the ceo of the virginia chamber there

the importance of apprenticeships and internships in our schools thank you very much second i want to reiterate the statement we sent you all last thursday through megan perez regarding the history and social studies standards the virginia association of school superintendents supports your request for the creation of a crosswalk that highlights the differences between all of these documents i understand that you all have that crosswalk

[02:24:50] we need to see a copy of the crosswalk between all the standards so we can have the public transparency necessary to engage in a review of these proposed standards. This would allow all stakeholders to have a clear picture of how the standards are changing. We recommend any revisions to the standards to be developed through the VDOE and the Virginia Board of Education established processes for the adoption of standards. We're committed to working with you collaboratively and all stakeholders to ensure the adoption of these standards follows a consistent,

[02:25:24] comprehensive and transparent process i also want to say one of the agenda topics you have today and we appreciate a return to a more standard process in your accreditation review as you're looking at decoupling accreditation accountability uh it looks like you are taking a phase thoughtful and deliberate approach and we really are pleased to see that and look forward to partnering with you in that process finally and most importantly today vast is very concerned about the impact of the error in the video calculation tool that over projected basic aid by over 58 million this year

[02:26:01] and over 143 million next year we urgently ask the state superintendent and this board of education to work with the governor and the general assembly to correct the error's impact on our students and schools by providing hold harmless funds given the historical state surplus and the fact that superintendents have had incorrect state financial information to guide them for almost two-thirds of the year and have already mostly planned and presented their budgets for next year. I also want to be clear, separate from a statement released by BDOE, that superintendents and finance directors

[02:26:37] are in no way responsible for this error. They don't even have the formula to be able to cross check the numbers. So it was not a correct statement that superintendents and finance directors had any responsibility for that error we do want to be proactive solution focused we want to move past human errors do occur but we cannot absorb this error's impact and we look forward to closely working with you to rectify the situation thank you all very much and have a very

[02:27:08] good day you also said my name correctly which never happens so thank you um hi my name is dr Allison Brown and I'm the coordinator for social studies from Charlotte school city schools thank you for having me on but it's a pleasure to speak on behalf of my district and my school board earlier this week you should have received an email from my school board I have hard copies if anyone would like them and in this letter you'll see that they both support the collaborative December standards as well as share their concerns about the august or sorry it's been a minute uh

[02:27:47] the January standards and you have heard a lot of their concerns they're bulleted for you below So I want to spend the remainder of my time talking to you as a district leader. You've had lots of examples of the effects that may happen. And so I think concrete examples are very good in helping to understand.

[02:28:05] And you really have the choice of how we move forward today. So if we take the example of the World Geography course, which you've already heard, has 35 more standards than the 2015 version. I'm, as a district leader, thinking that, okay, can my teachers even teach that amount of time?

[02:28:20] And then in Charlottesville, we teach it in ninth grade. So that would mean moving it to eighth grade as the January 6th recommends. And so I'm thinking, can my teachers teach that course? Do they have the expertise that they need? What professional learning is involved?

[02:28:36] What curricular materials are involved for even the teachers who have taught the course, but not to that age group and not with the 35 additional standards? And that's just one of the courses that will be negatively impacted by the January 6th draft. So as an educator who has been wearing lots of hats, I've been a history teacher, an ESL teacher, and case manager.

[02:28:56] I've been an SOL coach. I've been a doctoral and postdoctoral researcher. And my current role as a curriculum coordinator and as a professor both at two different public universities in the state of Virginia with strong education programs on my desk, it's my professional recommendation that you move forward with the collaborative draft brought to you by the Virginia Social Studies Leadership Consortium and other groups that you've heard from.

[02:29:18] and you reject the January 6th draft, it's just not viable. And I'm very concerned about the financial concerns that it will bring to my districts and districts like mine, as well as all the logistic concerns that you've heard and will continue to hear about. It's been a pleasure speaking with you, though I wish it was under better circumstances.

[02:29:35] Thank you. - Thank you. Johnny Finn followed by Jeff Koop.

[02:29:55] Good morning. - Good morning, everyone. My name is Dr. Johnny Finn, and I'm an associate professor of geography, I'm the chair of the Department of Sociology, Social Work, and Anthropology at Christopher Newport University. At CNU, I teach multiple courses that are required by my university's Master's of Teaching program, and students who have taken my courses have gone on to become elementary, middle, and high school teachers all over our state. I also have three kids of my own, two of whom are currently enrolled in Newport News Public Schools and a third who will enter

[02:30:29] kindergarten next school year. All that to say I am personally and professionally invested deeply invested in the history and social studies or excuse me social science standards of learning that this board will adopt. I'll focus my comments today on two of the problematic areas that I see in the January draft standards historical erasures and inaccuracies and the watering down of spatial and geographical concepts. How can we ask our students to contribute to building a fairer and more just society without honestly contending with our past without understanding how the

[02:31:05] historical forces of our past shape our present and our future what are we saying to our students when we begin u.s history with european exploration and erase indigenous peoples day from the curriculum what are we telling our students when we remove the history of labor organizing that has helped create some of the most important workforce protections that we enjoy today what should our students make of the removal of all african-american individuals from the standards on the revolutionary war or the removal of the word fascism from the standards on world war ii and the message in what message should our students take from a curriculum riddled with

[02:31:43] blatant inaccuracies the placement of the naac's peace formation during reconstruction rather than jim crow the placement of 9 11 in the cold war our students deserve and they respect an honest accounting of our history and they deserve an accurate portrayal of the diversity of individuals and communities who have shaped this state and this country the diversity that is increasingly reflected in

classrooms all over the commonwealth i'm also troubled by the removal of geography from the january draft standards decades of research clearly link spatial reasoning to higher

[02:32:20] scores and math in the STEM disciplines. Furthermore, in an increasingly globalized world, it's vitally important for students to understand how their communities are affected by conditions and events around the world. And the tools of geospatial technology are essential for the modern workforce. My department's courses in GIS and geovisualization are among the fastest growing courses that we offer. Students know how useful and how marketable the tools of geographical analysis will be after graduation and so i ask why are we removing geography from the standards when its importance is clearer than ever today let's give our students the curriculum that they

[02:33:00] deserve and that our state needs i urge this board to adopt the december collaborative draft history and social science standards thank you very much for your time in the space jeff coop followed by christine truck hi good morning and thank you for the opportunity to speak to the board about the history and social science standards that were released in january 2023 my name is jeff coop i reside in richmond i have a son and daughter who attended k-12 education

[02:33:37] in in virginia they're graduates of vcu and uva i worked in international education working overseas as director of education with a group aleph education based in abu dhabi that developed online e-learning content during the pandemic and serve the Harlem Children's Zone in New York.

[02:33:59] So I take an interest in curriculum design and instructional design and also as an educator in political science with background in history and economics. This is a field that's very, very important to me. I have three main critiques regarding this draft.

[02:34:22] well my main my main critiques revolve around the curriculum development process um the introduction to this uh to this graph which i i i really didn't uh i i didn't appreciate and the structure of the skills and standards i'm going to focus mainly on the curriculum development and the need for a framework and then talk a little bit about the problems that i see with the fact-based approach to skills and standards so the introduction neither offered a coherent curriculum framework nor an understanding of education for democracy or broader disciplinary transfer advancing the profile of virginia graduate there is nothing

[02:35:01] setting the strategic philosophical and pedagogical orientations for learning and standards development so what is a what is a virginia graduate what are the main social understandings knowledge dispositions skills and experiences required what is the specific contribution of the history social studies standards or science standards to the overall system goals what kind of citizens for what kind of democracy are we aiming for are there cross-disciplinary crosswalks to practices and skills associated with math science humanities arts when we get to say geographic mapping and displays of social data such as poverty statistics

[02:35:41] by state do the kids have the math and spatial tools how does knowledge of the past connect to the present and future as in the profile does each standard carry a theme topic or phenomenon with interrelated disciplinary inquiries within a topic and working vertically does the reconstruction era and our understanding of it, does it relate to our understanding of conflict resolution and post-conflict transition, transitional justice here towards peacekeeping?

[02:36:20] So if we had this reconstruction understanding, would it carry over to what we could understand about the conflict resolution post-wounded knee or post-World War II Marshall Plan or American policy in Afghanistan? Do students develop both historical understanding and communicative competence with which to apply both peacekeeping at school and in contemporary simulations?

[02:36:46] Dr. Koop, your time is up, sir. Good. Well, the introduction suggests no. And so without a framework, it's really hard to even evaluate the standards. There are laundry lists. They don't relate necessarily to the to the to the to the main standard um and it's very confusing i've submitted my written comments to you uh so uh so thank you for the opportunity to speak christine truck followed

[02:37:18] by dane kennedy good morning i was here in november to make comment about the egregious actions negating process that led to the november draft today i will focus my comments on the lack of skill development in the January 6th draft. I am here again as an educator, a parent, and grandparent. I have a granddaughter in Virginia public schools. As a 28-year veteran educator of public school, I have earned national board certification, a master's, and advanced graduate

[02:37:55] studies certification. I have been encouraged with the degree to which social studies education has been moving to a focus on the skills of history and social science in the last 15 years. Although not perfectly, we have been shifting away from an attention to isolated facts to an emphasis on skill development to make sense of thoughtful and appropriate content. As you know, memorizing a vast amount of information is no longer a necessary or valuable ability. We are

[02:38:31] able to access information quickly at the press of enter in a web search. The massive amount of information in the standards from this January 6 draft is a drastic reversal of that work and skill development. While I am disappointed with this draft, I am alternatively impressed with the response of the collaboration of the AHA, VASCD, and VSSLC, which I am a member, and now endorsed

[02:39:07] by a growing number of reputable education organizations. This collection of educators and true history and geography scholars recognized the need for compromise and took strengths from the BDOE August draft and even took components of the draft in November. It would be that collaborations document shared with you in December that I would urge you to examine for review.

[02:39:34] The one that is up for review today sets us back at least 30 years. It lacks commitment to the needs of our students in both appropriate content and skill. What I want for my granddaughter and all of the students of the Commonwealth is to be able to learn the skills of examining primary and secondary sources in order to detect fact, opinion, and bias using age-appropriate content. I want them to learn to analyze cause-effect relationships and costs and benefits to better prepare them to

[02:40:10] make informed decisions. These are just a few of the skills necessary to interact more deeply with content but without the time with the increased number of standards they won't be able to do that what i as a grandparent parent and as an educator do not want is what they would be getting from the document before you if you want a citizenry who will lack the experience and the opportunity to process and make sense of content the january's drafts you have before you is the one you will

[02:40:45] go with. If you want a citizenry that can think, act civilly, respectfully, and responsibly and reasonably, you will reject this January draft and consider the collaborative standards shared with you in December for first review. We must teach our citizens to be reflectful and responsible citizens rather than mindless memorizers. Thank you. Dan Kennedy followed by Alice Riley. I

[02:41:21] appreciate having an opportunity to speak to you my name is dane kennedy i've been a virginia resident for 23 years my daughter went to high school in virginia i'm a retired professor from george washington university and i taught world history for about 40 years um which is the topic i'm going to speak about in regard to the two standards um and my my basic point i think is simply that the January draft is distinctly weaker with regard to those requirements than

[02:41:57] the combined draft. And I want to get in the weeds and just give you a couple of examples here. So first, both standards identify essential skills, but the January standards are repetitious and confusing. If you look at item C, for example, it suggests questioning to construct arguments using evidence from multiple sources. Go on to D, investigating and analyzing evidence from multiple sources to construct arguments. As I read it, constructing arguments using evidence and analyzing evidence to construct arguments are the same thing, but they're identified as two

[02:42:36] separate skills. If you look at A and G, both of them highlight the importance of charts, graphs, and diagrams. I love charts, graphs, and diagrams, but I don't think they need to be reiterated twice in a list of 10 essential skills. Secondly, the January draft dispenses entirely with a feature of the combined draft that I consider especially valuable and, in fact, probably essential.

[02:43:09] And that's a feature that opens each section with a set of questions, right? And I could give you examples, but I don't have the time, but these sorts of, but they are framing questions, and they're important because they provide an analytical framework for thinking about the abundance of historical information that follows. Now, the January draft doesn't do this, right? And by failing to provide a similar set of contextualizing questions, it throws instructors and students

[02:43:48] directly into a sea of, as the January standards emphasizes repeatedly, names, dates, places, events, and ideas without giving any guidance into how all of that historical information might be synthesized and made meaningful. I'll send you the rest of my critiques. A lot of them have to do with the specifics that are in the standards uh which are simply erroneous thank you

[02:44:25] thank you alice riley followed by wes kite good morning my name is dr alice riley and i come today as a mother of two graduates of public education a grandmother who held nano school during the pandemic a middle school classroom teacher with 25 years experience a central office administrator responsible for the development and support for k-12 social studies and as an adjunct professor now working with pre-service teachers my experience with the standards of learning began with its

[02:45:01] inception in 1995 as a classroom teacher who was asked by my school division to become familiar with the new standards and help develop curriculum i have also served on past videoe test item review committees cut score committees and standard review committees i am here today to speak to the recently released january draft i could speak to the process which has not been part of the approved board of education timeline and has not been transparent for the past six months and instead disrespectful of the time and effort of the past two years work i could speak to the

[02:45:39] misalignment of sol 3.1 which asks students to explain the rights and responsibilities of U.S. citizenship by serving on a jury with no context of what a jury is or does in a third grade class that is supposed to focus on the world. I could speak to the age and appropriateness of content when students in second grade are asked to recognize the War of 1812. I could speak to the controversial content in Virginia U.S. history where students are asked to look at Supreme Court cases such as Roe v. Wade and the Dobbs decision. However, I would like to focus my remarks on a

[02:46:16] topic that has not been mentioned much, and that is the impact of trying to implement this. When I served on SOL review committees, I will remember a message from Dr. Patricia Wright, who was the superintendent of education under both Democratic and Republican governors. We were reminded there are 132 school divisions in the Commonwealth who all currently have curriculum and resources in place for the standards.

[02:46:43] Every change we might recommend would come with a cost for new resources, new curriculum development, and new professional development. And we were reminded that no additional funding would come with the release of this new version. So I ask you today to consider the impact of your decision on those 132 school divisions, on teachers in 1,528 elementary schools, 415 middle schools and 386 high schools.

[02:47:14] Where will school divisions such as Virginia Beach, Petersburg, Bristol, or North Hampton find the funds to implement the many changes? I urge you to seriously consider the collaborative development draft, which was submitted by members of educators on the ground.

[02:47:31] These educators work digitally to meet the directive of your November meeting and understand the capacity of our school divisions and teachers are. Thank you. Wes Kite followed by Zoe Aquino. Hi, good morning. Thank you for the opportunity to speak to you all today. I am a proud graduate of the Virginia Military Institute, as well as being educated in Rockingham County Schools here in Virginia. As a parent of four

[02:48:07] children, three of which attend Virginia Public Schools, I'm speaking in full support of the collaborative standards for far too long social studies has largely been mostly fact-based curriculum that has resulted in rut exercises that do not engage children in learning beyond basic memorization i have reviewed the proposed standards and i strongly believe that they represent an informed and balanced revision that will greatly enhance and improve instruction i certainly want my children to gain a depth of knowledge but also i want them to use and apply this knowledge in order to gain a deeper understanding think critically and develop

[02:48:43] essential skills. As someone who works in the private industry, I can tell you that business and university leaders have been quite vocal in advocating for learning environments that move beyond the mere regurgitation of factual knowledge. To be competitive and to grow in future careers, all children must have opportunities to collaborate, communicate, think critically, and create solutions to problems as informed citizens of our democracy. I strongly believe that the collaborative standards strike needed balance in a way that ensure content will be taught along with the skills in a more rigorous and academically challenging manner.

[02:49:18] The focus on inquiry as a method to combine knowledge and skills is a particularly refreshing addition to the standards that encourages students to think critically, ask questions, apply knowledge, make claims, use evidence, and explain their reasoning. As a parent, this balance of knowledge and skills is exactly what makes social studies authentic, relevant, and memorable for students. The January draft standards are simply not viable, AND I URGE THE BOARD TO ACCEPT THE ALTERNATIVE COLLABORATIVE STANDARDS FOR FIRST REVIEW. THANK YOU.

[02:49:56] ZOEA QUINO, FOLLOWED BY SAMANTHA FUTRILL. HI, SALUTATIONS. MY NAME IS ZOEA QUINO, HERE AGAIN TO SPEAK. THE MICROPHONE IS NOT WORKING. WE CAN'T HEAR BACK HERE. OKAY. I'LL DO MY -- NO WORRIES. I APPRECIATE THAT.

[02:50:12] SORRY ABOUT THAT. I'LL TRY TO PROJECT -- I'M NOT SURE IF THIS IS ANY BETTER, BUT BETTER? Okay, I'll do my best at least for the board, and then I'll let everyone else know how it goes. Salutations! My name is Zoe Aquino here again on behalf of Humke Center to talk about the January history SOL revisions.

[02:50:32] And what a time to be voting on this draft on the second day of Black History Month. In August of 2022, Humke Center first approached you to ensure Asian American and Pacific Islander communities are comprehensively included in the history SOL revisions. Echoing the sentiments of my colleagues, this January draft is not a viable foundation for the acknowledgement and understanding that AAPI communities and, frankly, any community in our state deserve.

[02:50:54] How can AAPI leaders' impacts and stories be incorporated into standards that don't even fundamentally acknowledge our communities as participants in American history? For example, mentions of the Chinese railroad workers, which are in the 2015 and 2008 SOLs, remain omitted.

[02:51:11] But the Chinese Exclusion Act remains without context. You know, at this moment, Humke Center and its community members are uncertain at best that the DOE can faithfully incorporate the feedback that we could give on AAPI content under the current circumstances, given the lack of transparency in the process.

[02:51:27] How can we trust that what we have to offer will be correctly incorporated when it's still unclear how the revisions were created and who has consulted to make them? This morning, the Virginia AAPI caucus had to take time to write and release a public statement in the middle of an extremely hectic session, legislative session, to clarify that they were not consulted on the January revisions because they were wrongfully named as a consulted group by the DOE in a public article. In contrast, the collaborative standards authored by the VSSLC, VASCD, and AHA do provide a viable foundation where our communities, including API Virginians, can be learned about and understood the way we deserve to be, with dimension and

[02:52:06] life, where students can understand the choices our community leaders made with the realities they were facing the collaborative standards authors were also able to outline their process name their contributors and do public outreach with their product consider consider the example that i just emailed to you and megan from the superintendent's revision and the collaborative standards between the two i myself know where i see myself as an asian american in virginia board members today you have another opportunity to be on the right side of history with your decision i will repeat what i said in november i love my state like really i love my state and And I'm so tired of being on the wrong side of history.

[02:52:42] And we have another choice in front of us today. Put Virginia on the right side of history and set an example for our state and our students. Our communities in Virginia deserve to be understood with complexity and humanity, not as footnotes or nice to nose. Bottom line, proceed with review and public hearing with the collaborative standards made by the VSSLC, VASCD and AHA, not the superintendent's January revisions.

[02:53:06] Thank you so much. Hope you can hear me. - Thank you. morning good morning is the microphone working no okay i'll kind of stand here i'll use my teacher voice okay so um i am a secondary social studies educator in richmond i'm sam cutrell and the president of the virginia council for the social studies any teacher knows that the way we begin class is important it sets the tone for the entire period

sometimes the entire day similarly the way a piece of writing begins sets a tone the draft of the standards released on january

[02:53:45] 6 begins with the following statement quote virginia's history and social sciences standards aim to restore excellence curiosity and excitement around teaching and learning history restore that word was chosen carefully that word was chosen so that this draft would begin with an indictment of history instruction in the commonwealth as if educators in virginia are not already fostering excellence curiosity and excitement around teaching and learning history as if we need

[02:54:19] to be reprimanded as if we have not taught cared for and learned with our students through a pandemic a phone tip line threats to our safety and questions about our character and what does this draft hope to restore i read it in its entirety embedded it alongside eight other organizations with virginia council for the social studies and i can tell you with confidence that this draft hopes to restore one thing in our students and our teachers compliance these standards train virginia students to be passive compliant actors in the theater of their

[02:54:57] educational reality and strips educators of their classroom autonomy as others have said there are 187 different historical figures featured by name in the January draft standards and not one single inquiry question. How can Virginia quote-unquote restore curiosity without any questions?

[02:55:20] History is not just the past, but the study of the past. It is exploration, interpretation, argumentation, and evaluation. All these standards asked for is regurgitation. But it's a good thing our organizations were not compliant.

[02:55:36] It's a good thing our organizations asked some questions. In the onslaught of the untenable information being poured into each grade level, we found numerous mistakes and omissions which undermine the credibility of this document as a set of professional standards of history education.

[02:55:52] The January draft standards are an insult to educators and are not viable for students, and I urge the board to accept the alternative collaborative standards for first review. Thank you. Gabriel Reich and Crystal Parker.

[02:56:23] Gabriel Reich and Crystal Parker. Well, the little green light's on, so let me talk to Kevin. Can we turn it up a little bit? Hello, hello, hello. I don't think. Hello, hello.

[02:56:40] Joe's green, not working. Joe's green, not working. Okay. I will also use my teacher voice. Good. I believe it's still morning. for a few more minutes. I would like to thank the members of the Virginia Board of Education for the opportunity to speak publicly about this issue of grave consequence. My name is Gabriel Rich, and I am the professor of secondary history and social studies education at VCU. For 15 years, I've had the privilege of preparing teachers to educate Virginia youth in our secondary schools.

[02:57:20] I will be speaking today in favor of the collaborative draft standards submitted by a number of organizations on December 20th, 2022, for first review. Today, I want to direct our attention to an idea that, while popular, makes no sense in educational practice.

[02:57:40] That idea is that more content is always better. Policymakers appear to believe that more content equals more rigor and more seriousness. They're not bothered that overemphasizing content will crowd out the time needed to process information through thinking, debate and exploration, as well as building academic skills such as close reading and expression of ideas.

[02:58:06] And this reminds me of a conversation I had with my own daughter when she was in third grade. This was 11 years ago when the ancient history curriculum had an end-of-year SOL exam. She was very excited. She came home from school.

[02:58:22] She was so excited. She told me, Dad, Socrates was a philosopher. I said, oh, great. What is a philosopher? I don't know. So what did my daughter learn from that curriculum?

[02:58:38] She learned that history is a set of unrelated facts to be memorized, trivia to repeat to adults in exchange for a prize. She did not learn what philosophy is or any context that might make the fact that Socrates was one at all meaningful.

[02:58:56] Unfortunately, the draft standards presented by the Board of Education this January are so packed with content that any teacher attempting to teach them with fidelity will be forced to race at breakneck speed through what will be an endless litany of factual material.

[02:59:14] 83 new standards in the secondary social studies courses. It would be one thing if those editions were an attempt to present a more diverse history to our young, but that is not the case. The state submission significantly erases the history of the majority of people that make up our communities, including women, indigenous people, working people, African-Americans, and others.

[02:59:38] Quantity is not quality as the January draft standards submitted by the board illustrate. And I'll end it there. I urge you to support the collaborative standards for first review. Thank you very much. All right.

[02:59:58] Let's see. We're going to do Crystal Parker, followed by another five-minute break for the board. Good afternoon. I'm Reverend Crystal Varner Parker. I'm a Presbyterian minister and mom to these two Henrico County students. have been a committed community member. I wrote to you and spoke to you last month about my concerns regarding the draft standards for history and social sciences. I had hoped there would be no need to be here today, yet here we are. The January draft standards are not simply viable

[03:00:33] and they should not be moved forward for first review. I implore you to accept the collaborative standards for first review. Virginia continues to be in the midst of a critical teacher shortage, and adopting these new standards would mean the implementation of over 100 new standards, which is an unreasonable expectation for already overstretched teachers. These collaborative standards that have been shared with you have resulted from the work of the Virginia Social

[03:01:10] studies leader consortium the virginia association for supervision and curriculum development the american historical association and other organizations that have included virginia educators and that included their input why wouldn't you want to listen to them and our local leaders and these experts in creating curriculum as i've stated before and will remind you i have long held the belief that public education is vital to the development of a well-rounded citizen.

[03:01:45] This is an environment in which they will be introduced to people of varying ethnicities as well as diverse backgrounds and perspectives. As a multiracial woman of Japanese and Native American ancestry and had friends of all races and faiths, I know that this is critical in public schools. So I'm asking you to please not move forward with these draft standards that contains several mistakes and admissions, which plenty have already pointed out and undermines the credibility. But may I just ask, why was Indigenous Peoples Day removed? This isn't a name of public

[03:02:25] opinion. It was by presidential proclamation. Why was James Armistead Lafayette removed from fourth grade social studies standards? Why is it only white men we learn about in the Revolutionary War? The January draft emits five themes of geography education. I guess we don't really need to learn the people, places, and things around us and just have rote memorization for our students. So why of all of these emissions and changes? Why have you failed to include our local

[03:03:04] leaders and experts in virginia education so please select move forward with the collaborative standards for first review thank you thank you we will uh take a break until a little afternoon

[03:03:17] when we come back hollins mills and emma thacker thank you we're gonna get back to public comment

[03:14:51] thank you hollins mills i hope yep perfect and emma thacker next thank you good afternoon my My name is Hollins Mills and I am a kindergarten teacher in Alton Morrow County.

[03:15:07] Whenever I talk about early childhood education, I like to start by taking a minute to really think about that age. Birthdays are the most important day in a year for a five or six-year-old. And they're just starting to lose their teeth and they're more than happy to open up and show anyone who had to have a look.

[03:15:28] Five and six-year-olds frequently say things like, yesterday when I was a baby. or "tomorrow when I'm going to college." Their sense of time is highly relative to their own life and they are challenged to understand the scale of time.

[03:15:46] Time is a developmental concept and social studies must be taught in developmentally appropriate ways. A young child's sense of place is also highly influenced by their own lived experience. When we were discussing the concept of community this fall and we were discussing the word neighborhood, One of my students said, well, a neighborhood is down the hill.

[03:16:08] Another said, no, no, a neighborhood is the houses in the circle. Both of these answers were true to their lived experiences. So teaching the significance of Yorktown Victory Day, I had to look that one up, to five-year-olds or asking kindergartners to define patriotism when they are still developing their sense of time and place seems absurd at best.

[03:16:32] this approach reduces the really important work of early childhood social studies to a list of isolated facts over and over most recently in the large-scale tennessee preschool study studies have shown that teaching constrained skills to young children has a long-term negative impact and the january draft of virginia social studies curriculum has this same focus it is a list of constrained skills, and it diminishes the rich thinking that young children are capable of,

[03:17:07] and it flattens their studies into events to be remembered. We need a curriculum that gives our youngest learners the opportunity to engage in civic life, where classrooms can serve as places where knowledge and culture are both created and transmitted, where a child's lived experience is valued and their questions are built upon where children have the opportunity to discuss argue and compare ideas so they can deepen their understanding and so that the so that they can develop the habits of mind that will serve them and our country so well for when children begin their

[03:17:45] schooling with support for thinking feeling and acting in groups they are more likely to participate in and practice democracy as informed and caring citizens the january draft of standards are

simply not viable and i urge the board to accept the alternative collaborative standards for first okay emma thacker followed by james fetterman hi good afternoon thank you for letting us be here

[03:18:19] today i'm dr emma thacker from harrisonburg as a parent of a fifth grader and a first grader in Virginia public schools. I'm deeply concerned by the January draft standards in terms of content included and excluded as well as the sheer volume of content as others have said. I'm also a professor focused on elementary social studies education. I'm concerned about the bias evident in the January draft as well as the impossibility of applying what we know from decades of research to be best practices for effective social studies education. As others have said there's

[03:18:55] inappropriate content for elementary students, but on both extremes, I would add in the January draft. So my rising almost second grader, he's not ready to learn about the War of 1812, for example, but my fifth grader is also way beyond locating North America. I'm also confused as to the repetition of the same holidays with the same expectations in kindergarten, first grade, and second grade.

[03:19:22] Given the limited time and the instructional day for social studies, this is a waste. Speaking of the repeated holiday standards, I'm concerned about what I can only interpret as intentional, politically motivated omission in that standard in particular.

[03:19:38] Indigenous Peoples Day is a state and nationally recognized holiday listed usually alongside or instead of Columbus Day. So including Columbus Day while intentionally omitting Indigenous Peoples Day, three grades in a row, it just seems outdated.

[03:19:55] It ill prepares our Virginia students for today's content and skills. That's just one example. So the January draft, as far as content included, it does do a better job than the November draft of hiding the political motivations, but they're still evident.

[03:20:11] Founders such as Thomas Jefferson urged that the public must be educated to sustain democracy. That's what social studies does. The consensus in the social studies community is that preparing students for civic life entails being able to ask relevant questions rooted in social studies concepts and content.

[03:20:32] They need to be able to apply disciplinary concepts and tools as they investigate to answer those questions. gathering and using evidence from reliable and varied sources to uncover content that helps answer those questions, and communicating conclusions to those questions with fidelity to social studies content and skills. Teachers simply cannot fulfill the purpose of social studies education while marching through this many standards. The January draft is still deeply and irrevocably flawed. The collaborative standards offer an alternative. They represent

[03:21:07] current best practices in social studies education, current social studies content agreed upon by experts and leaders in and beyond Virginia. In closing, I urge that the board reject the January draft and accept the collaborative standards for first review. Thank you. Good afternoon. My name is Dr. James J. Fetterman, President of the Virginia Education Association.

[03:21:39] The version of the Virginia history standards you're voting on today is a disservice to our students and educators. It falls short in sequencing, rigor, accuracy, pedagogy, non-partisanship, and in the process used to create it. And so VEA members calling you to reject it. Instead, we believe you should adopt the collaborative standards developed by the Virginia Social Studies Learners Leaders Consortium. The Youngkin administration rejected the first draft of the standards last year, claiming that there were

missing voices in creating it. Today, it appears that these voices were those of the right-wing and partisan think tanks and others with no

[03:22:17] particular expertise in Virginia history, but with political views more to the administration's liking. The result in the current draft, which is watered down, fails to sufficiently encourage critical thinking, relies on too much rote memorization, and features factual inaccuracies.

[03:22:34] Its political aim is clear in the introduction, which leads to a set of partisan values. Further, the document does not appear to consider the full complexity of our past. With such an opening, commitments made later in the document to instruct as an objective, factual, and age-appropriate way rings hollow.

[03:22:53] The draft you're looking at today contains 132 new learning standards when compared to the current set of standards. That's an 18% increase. With so many new standards, no additional instructional time, teachers will have to skim the surface of many important historical issues rather than reviewing each more in-depth and less repetition in the later grades.

[03:23:13] As nearly all pedagogical experts advise, the collaborative standards have a mere seven new standards. That's a 1% increase. Teachers and their classrooms are not blank slates where we can just add infinite new responsibilities and learning standards and expect the same level of rigor.

[03:23:33] It's clear that teachers were not adequately consulted for this current draft, and neither was the Virginia Education Association, which represent more than 40,000 educators in the state. We ask you to restore public faith in this process and choose the compromise approach by adopting the collaborative standards.

[03:23:50] The integrity of the VBOE and confidence in our public education system are both at stake in the consequential and much-watched decision. Thank you. Okay, thank you. Emily Mathan, and I'm not never going to get this one right. The last name is Hilliard. Good afternoon. In the January draft of the standards, the introduction claims that the

[03:24:24] standards are for, I'm using the word aiming, you did say restore, excellence, curiosity, excitement around teaching and learning history. This introduction goes on to say that teaching history should illuminate insights from the past and inspire current and future generations to lead lives that are informed and inspired. I wonder if when you read the January draft, if your curiosity was sparked, your excitement for history ignited, and your experience of excellence fulfilled.

[03:24:52] I wonder if you read those standards on behalf of the 1.2 million children enrolled in Virginia's public schools. Next in the guiding principles, it says parents should have access to instructional materials. What parents are you referring to? What about the black mother of a fifth grader in my child's elementary school who says, quote, I want my black daughter to understand the full scope of African-Americans experience in America. Will this mother and daughter be inspired by the January draft? What about the black mother of an elementary and high school student who says, quote, the focus needs to be on being truthful about our history. The goal has nothing to do with making anyone feel bad about the past. The younger generation are equipped to have these

[03:25:30] conversations. Are her children going to be leading lives that are informed and inspired by the January draft? I offer the thoughts of another black parent, one with three children, one of whom recently graduated high school. I would like there to be a specific African American studies class, but at the very

least, I would like the true history taught, which includes African Americans and their great contributions, as well as resiliency and other significant characteristics. I would like all children to be exposed to the truth of how the country was built and established and how the ideology of whiteness continues to be perpetuated.

[03:26:03] I would like there to be language and vocabulary taught that would allow cross-racial conversations to take place and for the practice of such to be a regular part of schooling. So it is a natural occurrence by adulthood and could potentially create a true shift in our world. I would like the children to be exposed to and be able to read books by African-American authors again, such as Toni Morrison, rather than the majority of banned books being by African-American authors.

[03:26:31] I would like the pattern of expecting black and brown kids to relate to the experiences shared and be the students of focus when topics such as slavery are taught. It's a spotlight that they do not enjoy. Here's a message from a Black leader and colleague. Violence is violence. White silence is violence. Increase multiracial standing solidarity. Identify and understand racial bigotry and the impact of colorblindness. Lastly, I'd like to share the thoughts of one of my mentors, a Black woman, fierce leader, and loving mother of a graduating high school senior.

[03:27:03] She says, quote, Black history is American history. It's like, say we don't teach about past presidents and they had to go find that history on their own it doesn't make sense when these parents and educators access the january standards where their children students and clients experience excellent excellence feel curious and like the history outline encourage them to lead lives that are informed and inspired by what they have learned i appreciate that you value parents voices i'm sharing my voice as a parent of two white public school students and bringing the voices of a few black friends educators and community stakeholders i urge you the Board of Education to reject the January standards and accept the collaborative standards

[03:27:41] for first review. Good morning. Good morning. Good afternoon. It's Awisha is the name. Thank you very much. Good afternoon, Superintendent Vallow, members of the board. My name is Awisha Hilliard. I'm a retired professor of French and Francophone literature and culture. I have also regularly taught in our international studies program and I'm a member of the Virginia Coalition

[03:28:16] for human rights i'm here to remind us of the lasting effects that our teaching has on our students we as parents and teachers have an enormous responsibility to prepare our children students to become well-informed adults with accurate knowledge and the critical thinking skills necessary to navigate today's world we do them a disservice when we present truncated information as history or social science and one-sided opinions as arguments when our teaching

[03:28:51] excludes some voices in effect dehumanizing others we make the very notion of exclusion and dehumanization possible for all as i look at the proposed curriculum and see as one example the absence of references to today's palestinians in the study of the modern middle east i know from teaching and advising college students for over 40 years that we would be shortchanging our younger

[03:29:24] students. Palestine is in the news. Events there matter to us in the U.S. and to the rest of the world. Yet students would be deprived of information about it. I have seen firsthand that skewed information and an inability to reflect cogently leave students feeling embarrassed confused and inadequate their difficulty with new ideas or points of view and their inescapable awareness

[03:29:58] of that difficulty hurts their sense of self when we gloss over what some might consider unpleasant events or give pat partial or simplistic answers we prevent our students from using their minds to help our students thrive as human beings and become productive citizens confident in their ability to reason regardless of their or the or others personal beliefs or politics we must give

[03:30:33] them accurate reasonably complete information and the analytical tools to grapple with it surely our children deserve this much i urge you to reinstate the august 2022 draft the collaborative standards and to reject the january 2023 draft thank you thank you mitch chan followed by milton

[03:31:04] Hathaway. Hello, everyone. Hi, my name is Mitch Chan. I use she, they pronouns. I am the organizing team lead at Homke Center. Homke Center organizes Asian Americans in Virginia. I am here to speak on behalf of one of our community members, Hannah. Homke Center started this campaign to ensure that Asian American experiences and communities are uplifted in our public schools and the potential

[03:31:41] impacts on those that will affect most students. We need Asian-American stories in our curriculums. I'm going to read Hannah's statement. Hello, my name is Hannah and I am a Korean-American eighth grader. Today, I want to talk about why we need change in the history SOLs. When I was five years old, I lived in a predominantly white community. I went into my first year of kindergarten and as soon as I walked in, my fellow classmates proceeded to pull their eyes at me to mock my eye

[03:32:16] shape. I was mortified and scared. As I continued elementary school, I had barely learned anything about people of color. This created conflict as I started to be ashamed of being Asian. It also did not help that kids would bully me for my Korean lunges and how I looked in general.

[03:32:36] Because all the people we would learn in elementary school would be white people, i could barely name five people of color who made an impact on the world it is absolutely wrong to not have representation of people of color in our school curriculums for kids like me and for the sake of futures future generations if we cannot teach the future generation wisely we will fail we need more representation in our sols so we can thrive in a world where being different is something to take pride in we urge the board of education to proceed with review and public

[03:33:13] comments using the collaborative standards instead of the standards made by the superintendent and this is me now speaking um hum k center just want to be clear okay um hannah did a great job uh hum k center is asking superintendent jillian baylow and i would appreciate if you look at me actually and the board of education to include asian americans as well as other marginalized communities in this process we ask you to reject the january standards and move forward with the collaborative

[03:33:41] standards for first review thank you milton hathaway followed by ashley elstad mr chairman members of the board i'm dr milton hathaway and i'm here today as project coordinator for the beloved community and as the pull-up action committee chair for the nuke and branch of the naacp i'm concerned about a number of things in this uh revised standard if i had to grade you i think i would probably give you a c minus on paperwork reduction because simply reducing

[03:34:21] paperwork does not meet the needs of our students i'm concerned because new kent played a vital role in history in this commonwealth we talk about the brown v board and and that was a major decision that cracked the door open but did not open the door it was may 1968 that the green v new kent

county board of supervisors case was settled by the supreme court and in rendering their decision they were affirming that the miseducation of any child is not only illegal but it is immoral

[03:34:59] i'm concerned about what you have included and excluded i live in new king county so i'm glad that you will reference uh martha custis washington uh our first first lady but i'm concerned that you exclude james lafayette who's also from new kin i'm concerned that this new revised revised standard is going to set education back in this commonwealth i took a moment to look at your backgrounds there is no question about your commitment to education in the commonwealth but to

[03:35:36] pass this january standard is going to set our commonwealth back and your names will be on the documentation that does it good afternoon my name is ashley elstad i use she they pronouns and i am a former student of prince william county schools i am here with ham k center and i am speaking on behalf of one of our community members emily who cannot be here today because she is currently in

[03:36:13] middle school hello my name is emily i am 13 years old or an eighth grader currently attending henley middle school and I wish for our education to include the long drawn-out AAPI history that our SOLs lack. Being born in America and living in a Korean-American household where my family only spoke Korean, it was difficult for me to adjust to new language coming into elementary school, especially in first grade when I was getting better at English. The memories of my fellow classmates mocking my mixed vocabulary and picking on my heritage were rather tarnished with

[03:36:48] insecurity from the fact that i was the only asian american in my class as a first grader a six year old i had no one to look up to that looked even remotely like i did i also remember my classmates pulling back their eyes at me classmates i thought were my friends when everyone had left to go to recess including the teacher they started to pull back their eyes i had no idea what they were doing in fact i started doing it back at them because they looked like they were laughing and i wanted to join in on whatever fun they thought was funny. If I started to pull back my eyes because my

[03:37:23] friends were doing it, that is undeniable evidence that racism is taught. Switching to my middle school years, we barely learned any Asian American history in class, not even Yuri Kochiyama, who fought vigorously for the rights of Puerto Ricans, African Americans, and Asian Americans. If it wasn't for Yuri Kochiyama, America would not be where we are today. If I had representations such yuri kochiyama helen zia grace lee boggs and countless asian americans who had made an impact on america i guarantee kids like me will be encouraged and empowered by their heritage learning asian american history in the united states is important and i will consistently fight

[03:38:02] for our sol curriculum until asian pacific islanders get the get the justice they deserve i urge members of the board of education to proceed with review and public comment using the Collaborative Standards instead of the standards made by the superintendent. Thank you. Annie Evans, followed by Reverend Sykes. I've already spoken, sir. I don't know.

[03:38:31] Thank you. Reverend Sykes, followed by Mary Nacy. Good afternoon to the board. I'm here in support of the Collaborative Standards for First Review. My name is Rudolph V. Sykes, Jr. I am a pastor and have been in ministry for almost 30 years.

[03:38:56] I'm a graduate of Virginia State University and have a master's of divinity from Virginia Union School of Theology. Both are HBCUs. I belong to numerous organizations, including New Kent County, Branson, and NAACP.

[03:39:12] I stand here as a grandparent on behalf of my six grandchildren. My great-great-grandfather, Daniel Sykes, was born a slave in Southampton County, Virginia.

[03:39:29] Three of his uncles fled Southampton County and fought for the Union Army in the Civil War. My other great-great-grandfather was Cornelius Elliot, a white man.

[03:39:46] My great-grandfather, Fletcher Robinson, migrated here from the British West Indies. I myself is 79% African American and 21% European, but I am a black man.

[03:40:01] In my family history, my great uncle, Vanderbilt Johnson, fought in World War I. My grandfather fought in World War II. David Walker was my grandmother's first cousin and at age 19 was killed at Pearl Harbor a day after arriving there.

[03:40:23] Four of my father's brothers served in the military. My father-in-law, Louis Williams Sr., served in Vietnam. My father, Rudolph V. Sykes, senior participated in sit-ins at Woodworth in Petersburg and Portsmouth, Virginia in early 1960s.

[03:40:40] In 1968, me at 10 years old and others integrated schools in Portsmouth, Virginia. That was a very important part of my history and I shared with my grandchildren. I remember my first year at that new school when a white student raised his hand and said, my daddy said that if Stonewall Jackson hadn't got killed, we would have won the war.

[03:41:05] Being the only African American born in class, I realized his history book was different than mine. So as a citizen of these United States and a taxpaying citizen of Virginia, my history of my existence mean just as much to me as other citizens.

[03:41:24] I am insulted that measures are being made to erase everything about me and the history of my people and what we did for this country. And to erase the history of slavery so it might not cause other citizens to feel bad, that is not fair to me.

[03:41:42] Well, not only the life of Daniel Sykes, my great-great-grandfather, who was a slave in Southampton County, that I am extremely proud of. I stand as a grandfather, wanted my six grandchildren to know this country's whole history, including the people that look like them that built this country.

[03:42:07] Thank you. Mary Nacy, followed by Sharon Fitz. Hello. My name is Mary Nacy, and I am the parent of four children in the Albemarle County Public School System.

[03:42:27] I am here today to urge the board to accept the history and social science collaborative standards for first review and to reject the so-called January draft. There are many components of the January draft that concern me, including multiple errors and the increased number of standards.

[03:42:44] However, what concerns me the most is the absence of problem-solving, reasoning, and analysis skills in favor of rote memorization of names, dates, and data. In a time when we are increasingly concerned about student engagement and the development of lifelong learners, such a laser focus on the memorization of small, often insignificant pieces of information represents a giant step backwards.

[03:43:09] Rote memorization does not inspire creative thinking, curiosity, or an understanding of history. Students would be taught what to think at the expense of understanding how to think. Moreover, because the standards presented in the January draft exceed what a teacher could possibly teach within a school year to such an extreme degree, It feels as though the authors have intentionally created a curriculum by which teachers are being intentionally prevented from teaching reasoning and analysis

skills. It reminds me of the fairy tale Cinderella. The stepmother tells Cinderella that she can go to the ball as long as she has

[03:43:49] finished all of her chores, only to set an impossible list of tasks that Cinderella could never hope to finish in time. Reasoning and analysis skills should not be a privilege to be earned by completing all of the rote memorization chores.

[03:44:06] And make no mistake, that is what rote memorization is, a chore. The collaborative standards were researched and written by top historians and educators. The January draft standards are not viable. As a public school parent, I urge the board to accept the collaborative standards for first review to ensure that my children and their peers have access to a robust, rigorous curriculum that encourages the growth of problem-solving and critical thinking skills. Thank you.

[03:44:41] Sharon Fitz, followed by Amy Akers. There's a lot that I feel like you all really need to appreciate when it comes to the subject of this curriculum, maintaining the work that these people did to be able to give our kids, both Black, White, no matter what the race is, an opportunity

[03:45:13] to learn about each other's heritage in history in a way that contributes to them becoming members of communities and citizens and friends and all of this, it just behooves me. But anyway, I'm sorry, I'm listening to so much.

[03:45:28] But Britannica says that African-Americans are largely the descendants of enslaved people who were brought from their African homelands by force to work in the new world. Their rights were severely limited, and they were long denied a rightful share in the economic, social, and political progress of the United States.

[03:45:54] Nevertheless, African Americans have made long lasting contributions to the American history and culture. I think that's important because we keep forgetting that how important it is for people to know that we are more than just descendants of slaves.

[03:46:15] More than just, and not just adults. White students need to know that black people were more than just descendants of slaves. Propaganda is powerful.

[03:46:31] It is time to expand the knowledge of students as they are becoming more informed about citizenship and the democratic process. For them to learn about the numerous history makers and making contributions made by individuals who do not have the legacy of founding fathers look to solidifying their internal greatness we all need to be able to look to history to discover our inherited potential to become history makers known for great contributions but if all a large

[03:47:05] population of students ever learn is that they are descendants of enslaved and subjugated people who were not considered human you continue to perpetuate the notion that only a few of those students are exceptional enough to survive thrive and succeed in society you have school to prison pipeline that's happening right now as we speak because students do not see themselves in the text black students brown students do not see themselves in the text do not hear it come

[03:47:40] out of the teacher's mouth that they are despite where you come from that you have greatness in you i i i don't i don't think you all understand how you are losing students they are filling jails they are filling graves because the school systems are not giving them what they need to understand who they are

and where they come from you all have the forefathers to look to for con to talk about they developed the constitution it's your time i'm going just but you have the

[03:48:16] constitution what do black people have black people have you all i i i i thought oh my god i need you all to understand it children miss fitz i'm sorry thank you amy akers followed by andrew park hi good afternoon president gecker members of the board and superintendent baylow my name is amy akers and i am the parent of public school children and currently a director of instruction in the commonwealth thank you for listening to concerns about the history and social

[03:48:52] science standards proposed from January. Certainly the feedback you hear today will be part of what you have to consider in deciding the future of learning about history in our commonwealth. I am a lifelong Virginian. I was born in Charlottesville. I attended school in Madison County, college in Fredericksburg, and completed graduate and doctoral studies in Winchester, and all the schools that I have all attended were small. The history learning was never small, thanks to great teachers. I recognize how fortunate I am to grow up in an area rich in history and have

[03:49:27] access to where this history happened. Having taught history for 19 years in Fauquier County and being a National Board Certified Teacher, I was able to share that love of history with students, particularly our local history. When I moved to the Central Office, I only wanted to amplify that passion for all teachers and students. However, when standards become lists of people to know and history is reduced to memorization that doesn't happen instead i would advocate for standards like those in august that that call for a deeper understanding of history with students being able to explore and discover diverse community perspectives while applying and

[03:50:06] practicing history and social science skills as a history educator in virginia for almost 30 years and having the honor to serve on standards and curriculum committees in the past many people here today. I always have been proud of this work and proud of Virginia as a leader in history education. But given the standards presented to you in November and the redraft now in January, I echo the concerns shared by previous speakers. The established process in creating history standards was bypassed. Of course, if you were unaware of this established process,

[03:50:43] you might think it would be okay to just throw out and start from scratch. But those actions aren't very democratic, collaborative, and certainly not what Virginia has come to expect as a way to hear all voices in the creation of its history standards.

[03:50:59] Additionally, if you were unaware of the progression of these standards over time, like Alice outlined, then you might not understand how flawed the standards from January still are. Lastly, I would echo the concern here that by putting content at certain grade levels, you are financially burdening some divisions who have, to this point, had local autonomy at that.

[03:51:28] So here's my wrap-up. So I'm here to ask you to please consider the collaborative standards from the groups VSSLC, the ASED, and the AHA, as the January draft is simply not viable. Thank you. Thank you.

[03:51:43] Andrew Park followed by Monica Hutchinson. Okay I can't see around the corner so I don't know if

[03:52:17] Ms. Hutchinson come on up. So history must be fully and accurately taught to educate about the past but also help our students connect and better understand the present while helping them work

towards a better future. Reading these standards I am left frustrated. Where is teaching how Shirley Chisholm was the first black woman to be elected to Congress and the first woman and black woman to seek the nomination for president from one of the two major political parties? Or what about

[03:52:55] Fannie Lou Hamer, a powerful organizer, activist, and civil rights leader? I see President Obama and Justice Thurgood Marshall included, but where are Carol Mosley Braun, the first Black woman U.S. Senator or Vice President Kamala Harris? Or Justice Ketanji Brown Jackson, the first Black woman elected to the Supreme Court? But you made sure to include the Dobbs decision. Where is Huey P. Newton, Bobby Seals, Stokely Carmichael? Where is the Black Panther Party? The same Black Panthers who formed in response to police brutality.

[03:53:23] What about the Black Lives Matter movement? Tyree Nichols' funeral was just held yesterday in the same church Dr. King gave his final speech before being assassinated. Tyree Nichols' murder is another painful example of how even Black people can uphold the system of white supremacy. Dr. King said, we can never be satisfied as long as the Negro is the victim of unspeakable horrors of police brutality.

[03:53:45] When teaching about the civil rights movement, will police brutality be included? Where is Black America's contributions to modern medicine, often without consent? Where is Henrietta Lacks, born in Roanoke, Virginia, whose immortal cells, known as HeLa cells, were taken without her consent as she was dying from cervical cancer and has helped modern medicine with cancer treatment?

[03:54:07] Creations of vaccines, including polio and COVID-19, in vitro fertilization, and so much more. Where are the Tuskegee trials, which lasted from 1932 to 1972, and studied the effects of syphilis on 400 Black men without them being fully informed? Where the horror is inflicted by Dr. J. Marion Sims, known as the father of gynecology, who learned what he did by experimenting and mutilating our black enslaved female ancestors without anesthesia or pain medication.

[03:54:31] And also contributed to the modern day speculum that is still used to this day. Reproductive health freedoms can be directly linked to our enslaved ancestors. Where is Sarah Barton, Madam C.J. Walker? Dr. King said if the present chasm of hostility, fear, and distress is to be bridged, the white man must begin to walk in the pathways of his black brothers and feel some of the pain and hurt that throb without let up in their daily lives.

[03:54:58] How can this happen without a full and honest teaching about history? If you're uncomfortable learning about the truth, I wish for just one day you could walk in my shoes and live in my truth. Allowing our children to learn all of our history, including our uncomfortable history, while engaging in critical thinking and discussions, will help our children be better than we ever could be.

[03:55:19] Let me leave you with a Fannie Lou Hamer quote from 64 that is sadly very much still relevant today as we continue fighting some of the same battles our ancestors fought. I am sick and tired of being sick and tired. Black history is American history.

[03:55:35] And while they aren't perfect, I do ask you to adopt the collaborative standards and reject any attempt at whitewashing our history. Thank you.

[03:55:55] Michael Stemple, followed by David Walrod. thank you dr balo board for the opportunity to speak today my name is michael stempel i live near broadway virginia i'd like to begin by highlighting some comments made by the board members and superintendent balo from the august 17th meeting and

media interviews from that day in response to the august standards there's a lot of talk about a need for a pause to look at the standards even though there was a process already in place to review the standards

[03:56:31] and included public input a board member comment commented that mistakes matter Superintendent Baylow made the following comment. We don't want the public having to say there's a typo here. We just want a draft that is free of those type of errors. The current document has some glaring grammatical mistakes, omissions, and errors. Board quote. To me, expediency can cause problems if we're not careful. It should not be the tail wagging the dog. The Virginia Department of Education went from presenting a document created over a period of two years with a wide variety of experts and stakeholders to presenting a document created in less than two months

[03:57:09] under a shroud of secrecy board quote this is a public process it's not like anything's going to happen out of sight people aren't going to know what's happened here clearly transparency was not something superintendent baleo with felton was important as there was no indication from the august meeting that there would be a complete rewrite of the standards it was also made clear that superintendent baleo was not even aware of various partners the department of education partnered with when creating the November draft standards. I am extremely concerned about the

[03:57:46] partnership with Hillsdale College in crafting the current standards. In Hillsdale's curriculum for K-12, known as the 1776 curriculum, you will find the following statement. The civil rights movement was almost immediately turned into programs that ran counter to the lofty ideals of the founders, and progressivism was a rejection of the principles of the Declaration of Independence as well as the form of the constitution i encourage the board to scrap these standards and implement the standards proposed by all the professionals i don't need to cite them uh vss lcva i mean you

[03:58:23] you know who these people are and they are professionals and i the draft january draft standards are simply not viable and i urge the board to accept the alternative collaborative

[03:58:32] standards for first review thank you david walron followed by thomas hindley good to go we're good

[03:59:10] Test, test. Good morning. I'm Thomas Andrew Henley Jr., Social Studies Educator in Rockingham County, Master's in Secondary Education, and unlike most of the people who spoke today just beginning my illustrious career in education, I want to start off today with a little lesson, a life lesson. You know a lot about a person based on what they say and what they do.

[03:59:39] So let's look at the Virginia Code. The General Assembly and the Board of Education believe that The fundamental goal of public schools of the Commonwealth must be to enable each student to develop skills that are necessary for success at school, preparation for life, and reaching their full potential.

[03:59:59] I'm reading it one more time, sorry. No mention of rote memorization anywhere. These precious years in education are made to help develop the necessary problem-solving skills of inquiry, analysis, communication, collaboration, empathy, understanding, perspective, and adaptation.

[04:00:22] skills that come naturally when students get the chance to explore them during instructional time. Honestly, I was a little afraid to speak in front of you all here today. I thought the January draft was this similar to the November draft. I must be alone in my thought. Clearly, whoever these 200 something

people are, are alone in their thought and paycheck. The only political agenda I see here is this January draft. 132 standards to add to the 744 standards already. I'm a humble social

[04:00:57] studies educator not a math one that seems a little wrong for two months of work let's take a subject i teach world geography for many of my students is the only history sol credit they need to graduate high school receives great emphasis of importance my students work very hard to achieve a passing grade many of these students see life as success beyond the classroom they look forward to work or trade right after graduation meaning i need to give them skills to learn and develop on their own and to get them to pass a multiple choice test that supposedly test these same skills while the 35 initial standards are added or in indication it seems the only skill this January

[04:01:36] draft cares about is rigorous memorization to have students spend these developmental years learning what the draft thinks is best for them as opposed to teaching them to learn and think of their own and yet the five themes of geography have been omitted this is concerning these themes are designed to make the world more understandable and less foreign for our students from the learn how connected our world truly is instead of learning names and facts of countries that will never mean anything more to them than a note card. Let's do better. Let's prepare our students for

[04:02:09] actual life and not to just bow down to a political agenda. I move that the board accept the alternative collaborative standards for first review. Thank you. Thank you. Dorothy Roney and Ann Tatis.

[04:02:41] Good afternoon and thank you for being here and allowing for the comments that have been made here. I echo many of the sentiments that have been made concerning the January draft that was brought out, the January draft. My name is Dorothy Roney. I am the mother of five children that all attend Loudoun County Public Schools. I speak today as a parent and activist, I'm sorry, in support of the Collaborative Standards draft that was submitted on December 20th. Where is the timeline and transparency for the draft submitted by the superintendent on January 6th? The board asked the

[04:03:20] November meeting to provide a crosswalk that included comparisons of the August and November drafts along with the 2015 standards. Where can that be found? The VDOE website states that the draft incorporates input from more than 200 reviewers across from Virginia. How many of these reviewers were part of the collaboration from November to January? It's hard to believe with the holidays and winter break that the completely overhauled January 6 draft includes any new input from these 200 reviewers across Virginia. As a mother of a kindergartner,

[04:03:58] second grader, fourth graders, and a sophomore, I am very familiar with the 2015 standards and the need to have them updated. A side-by-side comparison of the 2015 standards in the January draft identifies 21 new standards for second graders alone. I was shocked at how much new content was added that is not age-appropriate and has little to no relevance to our students, but adds an inordinate amount of work for our teachers.

[04:04:27] Are you prepared for the additional time resources needed in a day to teach the 187 new historical figures named in the January draft that would include astronomical expense for all new textbooks, materials, and trainings to implement this draft?

[04:04:44] I am perplexed as to why Columbus Day and Yorktown Victory Day are listed as holidays. I see no reason why my eight-year-old needs to know to apply history and social science skills to explain how communities honor any traditions associated with these two days.

[04:05:02] Virginia is one of 14 states that recognizes Indigenous Peoples Day. Yorktown Victory Day is all new content. It is mind-blowing that in 2023, we are having a conversation about why a victory that perpetuated the existence of slavery has been added to the January draft.

[04:05:24] Furthermore, it has seven- and eight-year-olds applying history and social science skills to try to understand the principles of American democracy with topics that are far more suitable for middle school, high school, and even college. I wrap up with, we stand at risk of erasing the hundreds and hundreds of hours of the collaborators' hard work, expertise, and lived experience that was submitted December 20th.

[04:05:48] This draft follows the guidelines set forth by the board and provides a fair representation of the history of our country and the world at large. I urge you to fully adopt the December 20th draft for first review and reject the January 6th draft.

[04:06:05] Thank you. Thank you. Ann Tatis, followed by Skip Choate. Ann Tatis, Skip Choate.

[04:06:28] Good afternoon, President Gecker, Vice President Mann, Superintendent Balo, members of the board. I'm a 34-year veteran Virginia teacher. I'm also the parent of two children who are successful products of not a failing, but a successful Virginia public school system here in Henrico and in the state at large, of course. And I'm requesting that you abandon the hastily rewritten and revised history and social study standards before you and advanced to a first

[04:07:08] review the thoughtfully sourced developed vetted standards presented in august and then expanded on and amplified by the collaborative review of the organizations you've heard as countless people today have testified to 67 i guess minus a few the january draft standards are neither historically rigorous nor reflective of the established process previously approved by your predecessors in the board of education they're unrealistic they contain a vast quantity of rote memorization and they're not useful or likely for content knowledge retention while i recognize that

[04:07:47] history is written by the victors in this case political victors sound educational policy and historical content should not be as variable as this tortured process has made it out to be social studies teacher of the year dixon i believe mentioned earlier quoted you the code that you should be very familiar with. I won't quote it to you again. Or add any comment to numerous comments about the rote memorization that these standards encourage, except to say

[04:08:20] that it's a perfect example of the less well-known maximum about teaching, that those who can teach and those who can't teach make laws and regulations about teaching. I confess that it's difficult for me to view all of this consideration of the standards advanced in November is anything else other than the current administration's what I call war on public education combined with an opening executive order that banned the teaching of inherently divisive concepts not only in social studies but

[04:08:57] any discipline the teacher tip line that was referenced earlier the abandonment of courtesy and protocol and seating some of you here today in place of the appointees of the previous administration, as per the regular rotation, this only makes sense to me as yet another tool to advance a narrow view of our history and simultaneously overwhelm the public education mission so that we can deem it a failure and hand it over to those in private education. The standards advanced in August 2023 were, as you've heard today, the result of countless hours of careful work and input from thousands

[04:09:35] of citizens and experts determining best practices and how best to represent our diversity in the commonwealth, as well as many perspectives of that diversity throughout history. Students exposed to this curriculum will ultimately have a better understanding of the varieties of experience in the past, as well as how that past is impacting us today. I hope you will return to the sound processes governing this board and advance the only set of standards produced by those processes, which is the August standards, as expanded on by the collaborative standards recommended to you

[04:10:08] today. Thank you for your attention. AJ Miller, followed by Katie Schultz. Good afternoon. My name is AJ Miller. I am a multi-subject tutor with classroom volunteer experience and a background in public policy social work. Please forgive me, there are some deviations from the version of my little talk that I gave you earlier. I only learned about

[04:10:44] this draft two days ago. There are a host of issues with the present draft, but time is limited, so I'll confine myself to a few points. Firstly, this draft contains absolutely no standards addressing the American labor movement. Secondly, it inexplicably removes Indigenous People's Day from the list of holidays students must learn about. Superintendent Balo, I'm particularly surprised that you might support this given your work in Wyoming. Thirdly, it has removed or anachronistically arranged items such that black representation in u.s history class classes will

[04:11:21] be confined units on oppression fourthly this draft admonishes teachers not to make students feel responsible for historical events as a descendant of slave owners and relative of important historical figures i assure you that none of my teachers made me feel at fault for my heritage at no point in my k-12 education was this part of the standards of learning it appears from my vantage point that this language was inserted for no other reason than to discourage teachers from honestly answering students' questions. Although this draft includes the words not limited to prior to lists of expected knowledge, it is intellectually dishonest

[04:12:00] to expect that teachers provide supplemental information and develop students' critical thinking skills in light of the 132 new standards or substandards in this draft. With school ranking, funding, and accreditation dependent on the SOL exams, teachers have no choice but to teach to the test, and these additional standards deprive them of flexibility. One might be forgiven for thinking that the Department of Education wishes to keep students ignorant by keeping teachers too busy to fully explore history and the social sciences. Finally, I am alarmed by the deletion of militarism and fascism from the list of concepts high school history students must learn.

[04:12:38] This most recent version of the standards was produced on January 6th, two years to the day after a mob carrying the flags of the Confederacy, Nazi Germany, and neo-fascist groups violently disrupted certification of presidential election and threatened the lives of members of Congress and the sitting vice president.

[04:12:59] Part of our state is walking distance from the Capitol. We are particularly responsible for educating our children. to quote the children's encyclopedia britannica under past fascist governments the people had few freedoms they had no voice in the government forgive me i've got about four sentences left instead a strong leader controlled everything and became a symbol of the country the leader built up the police force to punish people who disobeyed the leader also built up the army and threatened other countries the leader blamed minority groups for the country's problems why is it not a priority for students to be able to recognize fascism.

[04:13:38] As a member of multiple groups targeted for extermination by previous fascist regimes, I fear a future where our citizens are unequipped to recognize and confront fascist movements. As noted by George Shantayana over 100 years ago, those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it.

[04:13:59] A strong revision of this draft, at minimum, is called for. Thank you for your time. Thank you. I was done. Katie Schultz and Tonya Bledsoe. Thank you for the opportunity to speak about the importance of inquiry-based, culturally responsive education as upheld by the collaborative social studies standards. My name is Katie Schultz. I use she, they pronouns. I teach kindergarten in Albemarle

[04:14:34] County Public Schools. I'm certified in culturally responsive teaching through our division, And I've spent over five years on an ACPS equity leadership team supporting educators to utilize community cultural wisdom and inclusive resources to make lessons representative and relevant to the diverse cultural experiences of all of our students.

[04:15:00] This has closed achievement gaps and made instruction more equitable. I collaborated with educators, museum curators, African-American and Native heritage experts and curriculum designers to create standards-based inquiry units for social studies that help students ask questions and examine primary sources, highlighting the perspectives of ignored or erased minority groups.

[04:15:29] The January standards devalue these efforts, declaring on page 9 that teacher-created curriculum is unnecessary. Our students deserve inquiry and relevancy, and as professionals, we deserve acknowledgement of our skill at expanding upon provided curriculum-based resources and our knowledge of our students' needs and experiences.

[04:15:55] I'm also the parent of an African-American fifth-grade public school student. These next seven years of my son's life will be formative in his understanding of the world, the state, his community, and agency as a citizen and as a Black American.

[04:16:15] I'm deeply concerned about my son's generation of peers, my current students and future students, and their potential lack of culturally responsive anti-bias instruction. The proposed January standards have erased black and indigenous people of color and other minorities at multiple points.

[04:16:35] Examples include the deletion from fourth grade of James Armistead Lafayette, African-American revolutionary spy. And the addition to the K-2 standards for Columbus Day, not referred to as Indigenous Peoples Day, as it was proclaimed in 2022 by our President Biden.

[04:16:54] and the K-2 inclusion of a religious holiday Christmas. We must uphold the separation of church and state. Religious exploration should be relegated to world religion classes, not public education. Finally, I fear that with all of these erasures, the implementation of balanced discussions on discrimination and racism on page nine, rather than anti-racist discussions, students will be inundated with a whitewashed history and dehumanizing ideologies rather than the tools to dismantle racism and participate as a citizen.

[04:17:32] The January draft standards are simply not viable. I urge the board to accept the alternative collaboration standards for first review. Ms. Blitzo, followed by Tofilia Parker.

[04:17:49] Let me just say, you know, I've got a number of board members looking for a lunch break. I have been holding off in order to get through public comment before that break. Holding off becomes much more difficult if folks don't honor the time limits. would greatly appreciate it if we could hold our

comments within the time or frankly what we're going to do is we'll take the break and then come back which just is an inconvenience i hope not to have to do miss bledsoe hi good afternoon i'm happy to be here in front of you i actually have a timer here so i will stick to that and i want you to understand that i heard you so i'm not going to repeat what everybody else has said here i'm an immigrant and i went through the public

[04:18:27] school system my education in social studies and history was from a beige book with the flag on it and it told me nothing about my history i learned that on my own as an adult so i was excited when i got to loudon and i'm in virginia and they teach studies and when my fourth grader came home and said oh here's my studies and we talked about slavery and how africans brought over their gifts and then again was even more excited when i found out there are community leaders working on improving that and then i heard again that there was an 18-month collaboration that has helped to

[04:19:04] even better that and then to find out that now i have to wake up at five o'clock in the morning to come here and speak out against us using something that was happening in two months there's a process in place i work in private industry we follow process people there's a process in place for you to get the information that's needed you've created that process follow that process i'm not understanding as i sit here and listen to person after person with all of the issues with the january draft why we're sitting here when there was a process that

[04:19:40] was followed that provided something comprehensive and now i have to wake up at five o'clock in the morning to drive here so that you can hear that there are parents and people all over the state listening and relying on this body to make sure we do the right thing for our kids it seems from my from the conversations here that show students are not the priority there's some agenda that's the priority and this is just listening i did read the standards so i'm not coming here without being having read them i did read them they're way above they're far more um educated folks who are

[04:20:18] that is their ordain, but I still have to make sure that my student will get the right education. So what has happened in lieu of all of this in conjunction with me coming here to support the August version is that we have a whole separate study at home to help augment what should be happening in school. I asked you today to listen to everyone who's here. I'm just a parent, not just

[04:20:51] a parent i'm a biden parent i pay my taxes i'm also very educated but something has to be different will this be the body that changes the trajectory of what we do here in virginia that others find us and leave and follow our our the way that we go thank you thank you patelia parker followed

[04:21:16] by robin allman on this second day of black history month 2023 and as a parent of two public school students in Loudoun County, Virginia. I'm compelled to be here today. I want to ensure that my children understand the full history of the Commonwealth of Virginia, the United States of America, and the world at large. Booker T. Washington, founder of the illustrious Tuskegee University, was a proud and noble son of the Commonwealth of Virginia. Mr. Washington's life

[04:21:52] is not only important in American history, but it is also important in my personal family history. My husband and I are graduates of Tuskegee University and have passed on the rich heritage, tradition, and history that we learned there on to our two sons. If the Virginia Social Studies standards are not representative of a full and developmentally appropriate telling of history, then I fear that my children will be set up to fail in an increasingly diverse and complex world.

[04:22:21] I feel strongly that the Virginia Department of Education's proposed standards neither capture a full picture of history nor do they provide a developmentally appropriate path for my children's learning white house initiative on advancing educational equity excellence and economic opportunity for african america for black americans was created to strengthen the nation by improving educational outcomes for black brown and other underserved communities to help ensure that these populations would receive an education that prepares them for productive lives contributing to the well-being of society specifically the order highlights and

[04:22:58] mobilizes youth voices by providing platforms for black and brown youth to make recommendations for actions that can take that can be taken to ensure all students feel and are safe supported and engaged in schools in communities and in life what can we do i'm glad you asked we can listen to our students parents educators and advocates that have spoken here today in february 2022 in loudon County, where I'm from, at our school board meetings, students, families, and advocates shared impactful historic facts of African-Americans and contributions nationally and locally.

[04:23:33] Let's courageously listen and ensure that all our history is embraced, explored, and discussed in a safe space, even when it's hard and uncomfortable. My husband and I do not want our sons to sit passively memorizing repetitive facts day after day in the history class. We want our children to learn to think, ascertain bias, and make informed judgments that will allow them to participate actively in our democracy.

[04:23:56] As parents, we work hard to instill in our sons the skills necessary to navigate and thrive in their K-12 education and do the same in any educational, military, or professional setting they may pursue upon their graduation. The VSSLC, VASCD, AHA proposed standards allows teachers to do what they need to do to ensure that every student meets that lofty goal.

[04:24:22] I urge you to adopt them in full. Black history is American history. Robin Allman followed by Ilka Midnick. Good afternoon. My name is Robin Allman.

[04:24:37] I'm from Richmond, Virginia, and I represent the Virginia Coalition for Human Rights. a coalition of 19 organizations in Virginia focused on justice in Palestine. We again urge you to reinstate the December collaborative draft, and I refer you to the VCHR letter.

[04:24:56] It'll look like this. It's emailed to you. It was sent again yesterday for specifics. Propaganda is indeed powerful. Arab Americans must be included in Virginia's history, although they are hard to find within January's draft. A reminder that April is Virginia Arab American History Month.

[04:25:16] One of the deficiencies of the history SOLs is the lack of focus on how the US and the students' home communities are affected by conditions and events in distant places. Children of the diaspora of Palestine and their classmates must learn of the struggles in the Middle East and why Palestinians are not allowed to visit their homeland, nor hug their grandparents stranded there even if those children are American born and raised. Give Palestine its place in the world. Please support the legally mandated process for the collaborative SOLs and reject the January

[04:25:48] draft. Thank you. Elka Mednick followed by Alan Goldman. Good afternoon. My name is Elka Mednick. I'm the director of the Holocaust Commission and the assistant director of the Jewish Community Relations Council of the United Jewish Federation of Taiwan. I'm a proud product of the Norfolk public school system and a graduate of a Virginia university. On behalf of the Holocaust

Commission of the United Jewish Federation of Tidewater, the Jewish Community Relations Council of the United Jewish Federation of Tidewater, the Jewish Community Relations Council of Greater Washington, the Jewish Community Relations Committee of the Jewish Community Federation of Richmond,

[04:26:27] and the United Jewish Community of Virginia Peninsula, I express that the January standards do improve on the November standards, but they do not compare to August. We, the Jewish community, have submitted notes and suggestions in November and then again in January, and we resubmitted them yesterday. We do note that there are some things that have been taken into account. However, we know, for example, in the grade nine standard, WH11D describes the decline of Muslim rule and the expansion of Christian rule, but neglects forced conversion and expulsion of Jews and Muslims

[04:27:02] alike, who are an integral part of Spanish and Portuguese society and culture. Without knowledge like this, how can students understand that anti-Semitism and bigotry is not a hallmark of the 20th century, but has deep roots in society? The January revised standards improved in some areas. However, the lack of transparency during this process has been glaring. Communities around Virginia continue to be in the dark during this process, and the exclusion of diverse voices is concerning. The Jewish community notes the importance of improving factual errors and omissions in regard to other minority communities and stands with them in support of a quality

[04:27:38] outcome demonstrating the value of diversity and creating a stronger more inclusive virginia it's imperative that all virginians receive a quality education based on facts and reflected in the diverse population of the commonwealth so all students may see themselves in their curriculum thank you very much for your time consideration and commitment i hope you do the right thing thank you alan goldman alan goldman followed by courtney whitney thank you i'm alan

[04:28:13] larry goldman i'm the vice chair of the education committee for the uh jewish um jewish community relations um committee and uh the jewish federation of richmond and uh as people have pointed out there have been some omissions at this s allows and i thank you all for listening to everyone um and also everyone who's been speaking um and i want to concentrate on one specific major omission that is from the grade seven civics and economics and as to what's left out from our Constitution. And so there are two principles of American constitutional government

[04:28:51] that are repeated in the CE.1 and CE.1E. These were the limited government and separation of powers, and they were repeated, but others were omitted, including the exercise clause and establishment clause of the First Amendment. These two clauses are key to freedom of religion and freedom from state, state-endorsed religion, and the United States for Jews and other religious minorities. The Free Exercise Clause is the right in the Constitution that protects religious minorities, ensures they are allowed to full political equality, such as to vote and access

[04:29:30] the government jobs and offices. This clause of the United States Constitution granted political equality to religious minorities at a time when that was rare or unknown. The Establishment Clause prohibits the government from making any law, quote, respecting an establishment of religion, This clause not only forbids the government from establishing an official religion, but also prohibits government actions that unduly favor one religion over another.

[04:29:58] The 13 colonies each had established churches at various points in their history, and this clause aimed to prevent discrimination based on religion or religious tests for political office. These two clauses

of the Constitution ensure the inclusion of religious minorities in the civic life of our country, and so these fundamental principles should be added.

[04:30:22] So, again, I think the current SOLs need to be examined with the current draft, and I want to thank you very much. Thank you. Courtney Whitney, followed by Bernadette Chimner.

[04:30:48] Again, Courtney Whitney. Anybody? Grace. Bernadette Chimner. Hi, guys.

[04:31:05] My name is Bernadette Chimner. I'm from Spotsylvania County. I'm a parent there, and I'm going to switch topics on you all just slightly. On Monday, our school board met, and for the third time since September, they adjourned their meeting before their agenda was finished. They just didn't finish their work because they couldn't get along to finish the meeting.

[04:31:24] This is the third time in five months that they just did this. They didn't finish their work. They didn't get to the end of the agenda. They just adjourned and walked off. In September, they adjourned a regular meeting without taking up all new business. They did the same in November, and in December, they canceled a meeting due to lack of quorum.

[04:31:41] Our school board is seven people. They offered no explanation. So quorum, by the way, is only four. They offered no explanation for why the meeting was canceled, save one member who had to attend a memorial for a family loss. But we were expected to believe that there were three others who were so sick they couldn't even attend via telephone and that they therefore could not hold this meeting.

[04:32:02] We've been watching the school board for the last year fall into deep dysfunction. The reason that December meeting was canceled was probably political. Chances are good that the person who is out a vote they needed and so rather than have a meeting they just canceled the meeting entirely without then rescheduling anything they did find out that they had to hold the special meeting because there was some policy that needed to be updated so they rescheduled like a week later a small meeting in which they went through all the policies that were out of compliance with state

[04:32:38] law that apparently needed to be updated by the end of the year in order to maybe make that as quick as possible. They took those 70 policies and they cut every single division-specific thing out of that policy. All of it. They wiped all of it out of all 70 policies. This included, for example, the proof of vaccination for enrollment. It included the requirement for elementary kids to be accompanied to the bus stop by an adult. And it actually cut the definition and criteria for excused absence. And they just did this because apparently it was the quickest and easiest way to get out of this meeting they can't be civil to one another

[04:33:17] and they can't get their meetings done because of it our county school board has moved far beyond the normal polarized bickering over policies on library books and bathrooms our board spends over 70 percent of their conversation time sniping and interrupting one another in an attempt to make their political opponents look bad last meeting one of them moved another's chair to a new location like a kindergartner and they spent 20 minutes fighting over it yeah we parents are kind of exhausted and a little embarrassed but frankly i don't care if they fight like reality tv characters as long as they also get their work done and they're not getting their work done we have policies out of compliance and we need somebody to come in and help us fix this thanks for your

[04:33:56] time today guys jeffrey glazer followed by zoe spencer uh i am also from spoutsylvania county and uh thank you members of the board i'm here to address the superintendent issue in spoutsylvania

county back in september this board was presented with a request to license one mr mark teller as the superintendent at that meeting some members said that it was not the responsibility to make the decisions for local governments i agree with the sentiment that it should not be your decision who is hired for different localities but it is quite specifically your responsibility to decide

[04:34:36] who is granted a license for potential candidates and confirm their qualifications for that role that is why the decision comes to you and must be voted on otherwise would simply take a rubber stamp and no need for a vote and in that you made a mistake when you voted to grant mark taylor his superintendent license according to your own guidelines he did not meet the minimum requirements virginia code 8 vac 2023-630 option 4 was used to justify mark taylor's inclusion in the list of superintendents however careful reading the code clearly states an individual may be a candidate for the list of eligible division superintendents if they meet one of those four criteria this means that it is only a first step in order to be considered a candidate for the list subsequent

[04:35:14] code APAC 20-390-10 clearly then states that quote to be placed on the list of eligibles applicants must meet the following qualifications notice the definitive language shift in your own code the first is to be a candidate for the list but the second is to actually be placed on it and the following qualifications cannot be more clear number one in the code quote personal qualities eligibility shall be limited to individuals whose records attest to good character and demonstrate ability as an educational administrator many of you even questioned this at the prior meeting given mark taylor's social media history that included racist homophobic and islamophobic memes throughout the last few years ms holton you specifically said these are within the last 18

[04:35:51] months these aren't you know oh i did something when i was a kid these are recent posts dr siebert you said were i on a local school board i would consider these folks facebook posted disqualification additionally this also uh code has ability as an educational administrator and mark taylor has never demonstrated any ability as one number the two in the code he actually meets but number three experience the applicant shall have at least five years of satisfactory and full-time experience in administration or supervision or both mark taylor has literally zero years of education in public schools he also failed to meet the fourth criteria recency of professional education within

[04:36:27] a period of four years prior to the application failure to meet any one of these four four criteria should have prevented him from being granted licensure but the fact that he doesn't meet three of the four necessary areas should have absolutely meant this board should never have voted to grant mark taylor a superintendent license the first code does not exempt a candidate from meeting the requirements of the second when laws are passed the legislature can strike old language and yet no such action was taken when laws are passed the legislature can include language to indicate that one guideline supersedes another and yet no language is included the fact is clear these codes do not conflict with each other but rather run parallel unless two separate steps in

[04:37:02] a process sorry in closing i understand that once granted is a big issue to take away the license but when a governing body makes a mistake we should not simply let that decision stand because it would be difficult to rectify something being difficult should not let uh get in the way of doing what is right zoe spencer followed by james manship good afternoon i shouldn't even have to be here i am dr zoe spencer i am a sociology professor at virginia state university i am an activist

[04:37:39] I have a PhD in sociology, a master's in social work, a master's in legal studies. I shouldn't even have to give that qualification, but I'm a Black woman first. I'm not here to talk about which one to select. I'm here to talk about the ideologies that ground the reason why we're all here giving testimony in the first place. After the 2020 riots and after the brutal death of George Floyd, we were faced with a critical point in race relations in America. That forced

[04:38:13] then Governor Northam to address the way that education as a system, a structure, and an institution played on the perceptions of African Americans in society. He called on you all to re-evaluate the current curriculum at the time, which was pretty much kind of untouched, but very much Eurocentrically based. And out of that, the VDOE got together a group of people to re-evaluate the curriculum to ensure that the curriculum was culturally responsive and sensitive to the being

[04:38:50] of all students and to make sure that teachers were being trained to be culturally responsive teachers. The backlash to that is why we're here today, because that new curriculum challenged the status quo, it challenged the Eurocentric curriculum that patriarchy and white supremacy and so-called patriotism are based upon. And we're here today because you all created a January version of a curriculum that had been well invested by people who are professionals in the discipline. The massive resistance and the ideology that grounds that was this ship,

[04:39:28] because in the original documentation, they talked about culturally responsive teaching, CRT. Then the politicians and the political ideology transferred that and created the villain critical race theory by and through which you all use to create your new agendas. Critical race theory has never, and I'm stating this for the record because when it comes around full circle, I don't want you all to say that you all didn't know. Critical race theory has never been a fundamental part of any

[04:40:00] PK through 12 system, period. I am a college professor. I'm a sociology professor. Critical race theory is a part of our sociological theoretical base, and I don't even teach it to my undergraduate students. However, critical race theory became the boogeyman that really, really kind of stood for teaching Black people and others about the history of racial oppression in America. And it came about because it created a collective social cognitive dissonance amongst people who did not want Black people to experience any kind of inclusion or to

[04:40:40] fight for any kind of equity or to fight for any kind of changes in these systems that sustain racial oppression i'm here to say to you guys unless and until last thing unless and until we begin as a community to understand that our privilege is not based on another group's oppression we will continue to be here for hours and hours speaking about curriculums that are grounded in sustaining eurocentric ideologies in our educational system thank you for

[04:41:14] James Manship followed by Lorraine Wright. James Manship, Lorraine Wright, Melissa Brown.

[04:41:34] Okay, thank you. Yeah. Good morning, board members. My name is Lorraine Wright. I'm a parent first, and I'm an auntie to a ridiculously large community of kids. In my education justice role as a coalition member of the National Dignity in Schools campaign, in my public health role as a violence prevention program manager with the Virginia Department of Health, but especially in my role as a student in pursuit of a doctorate in sociology at the Virginia State University,

[04:42:12] I recognize that any standard revision other than the collaborative versions in August and December are nothing short of a continuation of Virginia's long history of cultural separation and

educational genocide. Furthermore, I would argue that there is no coincidence that these standards were released on January 6th and the insurrection at the Capitol happened on January 6th.

[04:42:33] But you don't want critical thinkers, so I shouldn't have been able to make that connection. culture and background lead to the inaccuracy of assessments including traditional tests and alternative assessments standardized tests intend to measure intelligence and general knowledge but they're not norms based on the knowledge and values of the majority groups oh but they are norms based on the the knowledge and values of the majority groups including gender race community status and persons with different language backgrounds socioeconomic status and culture creativity is as important as intelligence and creativity assessment measures are normed on

[04:43:10] individual cultures so let me also say for the record board of ed get out of bed with hillsdale and pearson and get rid of the standardized tests first whitewashing now erasure the introduction to the guiding principles state and two other people preceded me in this but they didn't finish it so this was a great alley-oop the introduction to the guiding principles state virginia's history and social sciences standards aim to restore excellence curiosity and excitement around teaching and learning history the teaching of history should illuminate insights from the past and inspire current and future generations to lead lives that are informed and inspired this was the

[04:43:47] last part that they left out by those who walked this journey before them board members if you're honest with yourselves parents and students of virginia the board or the commonwealth of virginia have never been committed to this guiding principle or perhaps there lacks evidence of that commitment to this principle for black and brown communities so if so this board would have recognized the value in the august and december standards revisions that included thoughtful feedback and considerations from a variety of stakeholders and rejected the theoretical suppositions of singular consultants with limited knowledge and a political agenda i believe that

[04:44:25] movements are most effective when they're led by those impacted by the issues your own guiding principles recognize the critical importance of representation in the textbook and in the world. So if you agree that the teaching of history should illuminate insights from the past and inspire current and future generations to lead lives that are informed and inspired by those who walk this journey before them, now how can that be possible for students who look like me when, as the National Association of Scholars termed it, the proposed standards suffer from grave flaws, including confusing, repetitive format, vague, inflated prose, misguided skills

[04:44:59] emphasis, misguided inquiry emphasis, misguided commitment to action civics, abbreviated content, and not to mention it's riddled with factual distortions, errors, and deletions. In sociological terms, erasure refers to the tendency to ignore or conceal an element of society. In Hirako's Tuckahoe Middle School, an eighth grade black female student in the IB program in Ms. Comer's class is constantly subjected to racial and homophobic taunting without the intervention on several occasions but the most recent was for almost the entire class period the same student

[04:45:35] was in Ms. Mayhall's class for two consecutive years and in that entire two years Ms. Mayhall never called her by name not even once so board of ed is a culture not only are children invisible even when they're physically present but now these standards seek to exclude strong truthful representations of them in text one simple question board are you investing what are you you investing in or who are you investing in? Reject the January standards and stop playing

[04:46:00] with our kids. Okay. Last speaker who signed up, Melissa Brown. Okay. I hesitate to ask this, but we do it every meeting. That goes for the list of everybody who signed up. Is there anybody who feels compelled to say something who has not already spoken on topics germane to the board?

[04:46:40] Well, this is a first also. Let me tell you, you know, we've been sitting here, I don't know how many hours. My math skills are not that good. I appreciate the civil nature of the discussion here. We as a board very much appreciate the participation of the public and frankly the thoughtful public commentary we had today. I know sometimes, you know, you can see some impatience as, what is it they say, the mind can endure, the mind can absorb what the seat can endure. And so, you know, occasionally we have to shift a little bit in our seats, but this has been a particularly good public comment session and we really do appreciate it uh so thanks to

[04:47:19] all of you for being with us the board is going to take a lunch break we'll be back at two back

[05:15:06] uh the size of the audience has diminished a little bit but we will move forward okay uh the consent agenda uh items a b c d e and nope excuse me a b a and b yep is there a desire to remove something from the consent agenda or is there a motion to adopt the agenda as written for the consent agenda items a and b you adopt thank you is there a second thank you mr hanson all in favor say hi all right i'm going to exercise if it's okay the chair's prerogative uh as i just mentioned

[05:15:45] during the break i've got to leave here at about 320. i would like to be here for the review the history standards and so i'm going to move item f up to the first action item uh i'm told that staff is aware of that change and hopefully staff is within earshot and about to appear magically from behind the screen and there it is oh my gosh i love this i wonder who else i could have appear magically from behind the screen just by wishing them here there you go good to see you all again and you know it seems like just yesterday we saw you well happy groundhogs day

[05:16:25] Happy Groundhog Day. There you go. Yes. Literally. Yep. All right. All right. Well, good afternoon. The floor is yours. Thank you. Good afternoon, Mr. Gecker, Vice President Mayen, members of the board, Superintendent Bailow. There's a couple of people I want to make sure that everyone's aware of since we have, it looks like, our full, full team here today.

[05:16:51] Again, my name is Kristanya Brown. I am the coordinator for history and social science. And directly to my left is Brandy McCracken. She is our elementary specialist. Next to her is Andrea Emerson. She is our secondary specialist. And next to Andrea, we have a very good working relationship with our assessment division. And joining us during this time period is Adam Bennett. He's an assessment specialist. And then the leader of our group dr christine harris um director of humanities i'm glad to say they let

[05:17:25] you pull in reinforcements yes they're needed yes so today i bring to you for first review the proposed revised history and social science standards of learning the standards describe the commonwealth's broad goals for student learning and achievement in grades k-12 history civics geography and economics the code of virginia requires a review of each standards of learning subject at least once every seven years pursuant to legislation from the 2000 virginia general assembly the board established a seven-year cycle for review of the standards of learning

[05:18:04] thus the history and social science standards of learning originally adopted by the board in 1995 were reviewed and revised in 2001 2008 and 2015. in november 2022 the board received a follow-up

presentation as there was a pause of the draft of august 2022 standards providing revisions to the standards to date at the november board of education meeting videoe was directed to use the november draft as a baseline document correcting its omissions and errors considering public and

[05:18:41] board member comments and incorporate elements from the august 2022 draft and the 2015 standards from november to january the draft standards were revised to fulfill the board's directives conversations held with various groups to address concerns corrections and omissions bdoe content staff provided instructional guidance and suggestions excuse me suggestions to the document final arbiters regarding the historical accuracy timelines and content appropriateness

[05:19:17] the january 2023 draft incorporates content from earlier drafts adding more content to tell a story a broader story about how the past has shaped the commonwealth the nation and the world as a follow up from yesterday's conversation from the february 2023 work session a question was asked regarding the requiring teaching and assess assessing of civics and economics in the commonwealth and i apologize that i do not have a slide for you but i'll make sure that i reiterate the code number

[05:19:56] the following information is provided in the code of virginia sections 22.1-253 13-3, and that is standard 3, accreditation, other standards, assessments, and releases from state regulations. It states, the standards of learning assessments administered to students in grades 3 through 8 shall not exceed, and at this point, the code begins listing a list,

[05:20:32] rather, of reading and mathematics assessments for grades 3 through 8. Then it specifies assessments for science, and then follows up with history and social science, continuing with the language stating, before the student completes grade eight, assessments are administered for Virginia studies and civics and economics once at each grade level deemed appropriate

[05:21:03] by each local school board. Therefore, students must be in the course to take the required assessment. So we also have a timetable for further review in action. In anticipation of the board's acceptance of the standards for first review, the following timeline is anticipated and proposed for next steps in actions. February 2, 2023, first review of the standards document.

[05:21:40] March 13th through the 21st, 2023, public hearings with the Board of Education. In addition to this, we will ensure that there is an email box open for public comment during this period of the public hearings for input.

[05:21:57] During the month of March, reviewing the public comments and incorporating warranted edits, and then anticipating April 20, 2023, proposed final review and adoption by the board.

[05:22:14] After final approval, we will begin or be getting involved in the process, excuse me, for the curriculum frameworks, anticipating the use of the content of the August Combined Standards and Curriculum Frameworks draft document that are also available on the BDOE's website.

[05:22:39] This content will be incorporated into the work to develop the curriculum frameworks as it has been in the past once the standards are approved. And then lastly, the development of the curriculum frameworks will look like as it has in the past with input primarily from educators.

[05:23:00] That's our anticipation. Therefore, the Superintendent of Public Instruction recommends that the Board of Education accept the draft of the proposed revised History and Social Science Standards of Learning for first review.

[05:23:17] And at this time, I will take any questions that you may have. Questions or can we go right into sort of discussion of what's before us? We had a lot of time. Thank you, Kristania. You're welcome. Did they not give you a seat, too? I left one.

[05:23:34] It's okay. You know, it has been, you know, a goal of mine to get these standards from start to finish, you know, while I'm still on the board, which means that under Crestania's timeframe, I've got basically one month where the timing can slide.

[05:23:53] We had a, you know, and I'm still hopeful that that's the case. We had a lot of discussion yesterday, and I understand that there are, you know, I don't want to rehash all of the discussion. But I do understand that there are some specific issues and items that people want to bring up in the form of a motion to determine, you know, what goes in the draft that is going out as the boards for the purpose of the public hearing.

[05:24:24] You know, again, it is my hope that we come out of this meeting with a draft that is going forward to public hearings, because as all of you know, we talked about this yesterday, there's a 30-day notice requirement for the public hearings. If a draft doesn't go out today, we're then into, you know, April before the public hearings can be held, which really means effectively June for adoption.

[05:24:48] So although it's certainly not mandatory that we follow the time frame, it would be my desire to get us through. But with that having been said, and we listened to, what, five hours, four and a half hours of public comment today on the draft, I mean, it's hard to sit here having listened to all the public comment and not understand that with all due respect to the staff, that there are some issues being raised by professionals in the field that are significant and I think have to be taken seriously.

[05:25:18] You know, whether we act on them now or whether we act on them at all or address them again at the end of the process, meaning when it comes back to us for a real review, I think is an open question. But I do think, you know, it is time to at least put on the table some of the issues raised yesterday, take those votes and then make a decision as to where we're going from here.

[05:25:45] mindful, again, a reminder of the public that what goes out as the first review draft is not necessarily the final product. It is really the beginning of a process that will get us to a final product. And as I've said a number of times, if we need to, when it comes back for final review after the public hearing process, we will do line by line if we have to. You know, we are not going a short change the end of this. But sooner or later, we do need to, you know, move to the public and get it going. And, you know, we got delayed, you know, with the large turnover at the request

[05:26:22] of, you know, the department. You know, we accepted that delay, and now we are where we are in terms of timing. So, with that having been said, anybody have any initial comments? And hopefully, you know, if there are going to be motions, let's go ahead and start dealing with those now. Ms. Holden. Actually, I have one preliminary question for Ms. Brown and then one preliminary motion. Ms. Brown, one thing you told us yesterday is that you can, you anticipate by President's Day, provide the board with a strikethrough version that compares

[05:27:00] whatever comes out of today's meeting to the 2015 version. Yes, ma'am. And is that something you can make available, the department will make available to the public as well as to board in that time frame? I can defer to Superintendent Bailo, but I will. We will have that strikethrough document. So if you want to post it on. You have the capacity to do it. Any, any reason why we won't make that version

available, Ms. Bailo? Well, any, anything that goes to the board is public. Okay, great. So I would now like to make a motion and just briefly

[05:27:39] by way of explanation, and I'm not going to elaborate because recognizing we've had a lot of discussion and we've heard a lot this morning, we've read a lot of written comment, I am satisfied that the January draft has both process and content significant problems, and based on that, I move that we substitute the draft produced by the Virginia Social Studies Consortium, VASCD and the American Historical Association that was provided to all of us in late December,

[05:28:15] that we substitute that for the January 23 draft as a basis for first review going forward. I second that motion. Okay. Any discussion on that motion? Yeah. Can I offer a friendly amendment? I think just in the interest of, sorry, is there a lot of feedback? Just in the interest of process, Ms. Holden, I don't know if this is amenable to you but what i would suggest is if you withdraw your amendment i'll offer an amendment on the underlying document you can then offer a second degree we can discuss your amendment

[05:28:50] and vote on it and vote on moving the underlying one i withdraw okay so then i will put a motion on the floor that we move the superintendent's recommendations we'll there'll be plenty of time for discussion so i'm not going to give any like stem winder don't worry um uh that we ought to remove the superintendent's recommendation for first review to get it out to the field and get comments and go through that process. I just ask, and again, I'm happy to have you make the motion.

[05:29:18] There were four or five specific things within the superintendent's draft that came up yesterday that I thought might be the subject of motions individually today, and it might pay to deal with those first and then come back and move the draft. If people want to do that, there could

[05:29:38] I'm getting out of my depth on rules of order, a third degree or whatever, but I would like to take a vote on, I hear the concerns, I have concerns, there's things I would like to change as well, I'm not sure how productive it's going to be to line edit this, and because it is first review, I feel like we can get it out to the community, the field, and experts.

[05:29:59] Whether it's productive or not, and again, unless people's minds have changed on, you know, there are, like I said, four or five discrete issues, the introduction being one, that it might help to at least get on the table and then off the table before the motion to move forward, because otherwise we're just going to be bogged down with those and, you know, and substitute motion.

[05:30:24] Mr. President, I absolutely defer to your wisdom on the best way to proceed. You are correct in anticipating that I at least plan to offer a number of motions. Because that will be, then the draft that you move will be known. Yeah, I think we're going to be here all afternoon if we do that, because taking the document in that, we should go line by line in that preface on what people like or don't like if we're going to do that. It seems like this is first review, not final review. You said we're going to come back and edit line by line. It just seems like we're going to be here all day, which is not, I mean, if we have to be here all day, we have to be here tomorrow, we do that's what you signed up for.

[05:30:57] It just seems like there's a more expeditious way to potentially get this out to the public. And I think we can test the will of the board as to whether we want to do that now or do that later. Certainly short-circuit some things. Well, I think we can have a robust discussion. As I said, there's things I would

like to see changed. I think the question is, are we just going to spend all afternoon line editing or saying things we want to get to change?

[05:31:17] What you might find is someone might vote for the draft after the you know five i think it was yesterday items were voted on that might not vote for it in the form you're doing it now i feel so mr mr rotherham if i may clarify your may withdraw my withdrawal if that's an option well you can put yours on top of mine for sure well if i i would like to have the opportunity to move a number of particular changes if my initial motion fails and And so I ask the president to help arrange our process so we can get on to the content,

[05:31:54] which I think we can move through fairly expeditiously on all of it, but only once we get to it. But I have a point of order question, like, is it, like, what is the process here? If you, if Mr. President, if you want to have votes and that's your prerogative, then we should vote. No, it's not my prerogative. I don't know the rules.

[05:32:10] I don't know the will of the court. Right now, right now, you've got a motion on the table. I don't know the will of the court. Not yet been seconded. I would like to second that. I know that we've been here, we've been engaged in discussions since August and we'll continue to do it and this is going to go out to the public. We're going to continue to get, you know, plenty of other items to discuss.

[05:32:30] And I would like to alt-second Andy's, if I understand it correctly, motion to go ahead with the January standards as it stands right now on first review.

[05:32:48] Right. As I understand that Ms. Holt is going to offer an amendment on top of that that we should consider. Or I decline to accept what you proffered as a friendly amendment. I no longer accept it as a friendly amendment. So I'd like to go back to my original motion. Okay, we can do that, and then we'll vote on this one afterwards. That's fine. My motion was seconded.

[05:33:06] Sadly, there's a seconded motion. I will withdraw my, because I do not want to short-circuit Ms. Holton, because that would be... I don't really care how we do it. Go ahead. If we vote on mine now, we would short-circuit her, and that would be a bad thing. So I withdraw mine for now. So my motion is on the table.

[05:33:21] Yeah, I withdraw mine. And I've said everything I need to say in support of my motion. I don't need to discuss it. Is there a second to Ms. Holton's motion? Do a second to it. Dr. Mann, I thought, yes. Fair enough. i don't want any discussion on the motion i this is kind of um so i need your help with the the order and all this kind of stuff um but i'm also trying to think about implementation down the road and some of the things that we heard today were concerns about you know transparency and whatnot

[05:33:54] so i just i was thinking that one option um we've already started to compile ourselves the things that we think need to be fixed we already have a list of things that we'd like to see probably tweet but we do i do think we need to get this out the door so we can get to the public i i wish there were still a lot more people here that were here earlier because this is a mile post not a destination and and we are receiving but i i do think that the work going forward the changes that come uh especially from from board members to staff i i think needs to be transparent needs be posted but you know these are the things that we would like to see improved and fixed i think

[05:34:33] that helps us when we get out to the field we're having the meeting in roanoke or in abingdon you know we'll say yeah well the board members have already talked about how we want to add this or fix

this or do some things i but if we're going to do that motion at a time i do think it could be a deep dive i thought our deep dive was going to be at the at the destination well line by line but um again i'm i'm here here to serve and when we say line by line at this point where i thought we were and miss holton correct me if i'm wrong is you had four or five not four or five hundred correct based on my notes from yesterday's discretion okay and i'm not aware of anybody else i know dr mann expressed some issues but i would assume or have assumed maybe incorrectly

[05:35:13] that miss holton is going to discuss your issue also in one of her motions i think they overlap yeah so what we're talking about is not line by line or deep dive it is basically five discrete points that were brought up yesterday and it's a question of you know what are you comfortable you know putting the board's name on as the uh you know the draft that goes out to the public i mean that's what it comes down to i think that's a fair question um okay there we go

[05:35:50] i think that's a fair question um because we sat here for four and a half hours five hours and we heard overwhelmingly the concerns that the public has with the draft and i definitely would love to see this done before i certainly leave the board in june um and yet at the same time we're asking people to have confidence to let this go forward as it is with the hope that things will be changed

[05:36:27] when what we've experienced has not reflected that and that's very hard for me um because again i had to allow for a more inclusive process as a result of a transition and that happens in government all the time and i understood that i accepted that i embraced that and what we have

[05:37:03] before us as we have heard today does not get at the kind of rigor that we say matters in education i mentioned these things yesterday in our work session my concern about the preface of the document and it really engendering words that are not helpful to what we're trying to do which is really focus on the skills that we want students to learn i i shared these things yesterday i asked

[05:37:41] that we even might consider the december document that was produced by the consortium as an alternative to demonstrate to the public that we are committed to working cooperatively and collaboratively as a board above the fray of what for good or bad is now perceived as a political intervention into process and i said these things yesterday and as i said and i listened

[05:38:16] today those things were reinforced so i i understand that we need to move things forward and i'm prepared to do that but i'm prepared to do that in a way that best reflects what i can stand behind well on the motion on the floor what i'm struggling with is i don't know how we can possibly say we're interested in transparency and process and then move a version of standards that haven't been vetted the public has that opportunity to comment on we heard generally people like them

[05:38:53] but we heard no specifics they certainly haven't been vetted uh uh more more widely i just don't know how we can possibly say we're about transparency and process and we're gonna we're gonna describe that's not a that's not a judgment on the quality of those standards or anything in them it's just purely a process point that seems like we're we're sort of putting cart before a horse there if we were to if we were to move this direction okay i call the question can i do that i just want us to move forward all right so this is on the substitution not on any of the correct okay uh so clearly clear the motion yeah as i understand that the motion is to put out for

[05:39:32] or accept this first review and therefore use as the public hearing draft uh the draft loosely referred to as the coalition or uh what's the appropriate collaborative specifically the the proposed

standards submitted by the ascd aha uh and uh we have all received consortium that we received back in late december correct okay that's the motion it's been properly seconded let's go ahead and any more discussion i don't see any i i would like to say something oh sure no no go ahead

[05:40:06] um many of you know i'm the immediate past president of vascd um i resigned from that board to serve in this role i hold that organization in very high regard and other partner organizations i actually you know some people took their document different ways i applaud the document anybody with work ethic who's going to put in time and energy to get things done i applaud that extensive effort and really i see it as part of the journey we're on again i i see receiving for first review a mile post not a destination and so um i i think that document's

[05:40:43] going to be very helpful and again i have some things that i hope that we can get done before we get to the destination and so i think some things will come for that but i have also personally although i received that glanced at it my personal work in terms of what i think we need to do before we get to the final destination has been on the january document and and the and the january document is much improved over november um but it is nowhere near a final product i think they're still polishing again we have this process i look forward to going to these meetings but i i have difficulty as much as i regard that group and that document it's not the one that i've

[05:41:21] been working on for the past month to give feedback on as we do go out to the public and so that i i share mr rotham's concern you know we're getting hammered on for transparency i i to move forward something that we have not vetted fully i'm just struggling with that from my perspective the uh i mean there are aspects of the version that i expect is going to end up going out that just don't reflect my values and you know i am not an expert in social studies have made that clear

[05:41:59] right but we i do get to sit and listen to a lot of people and try to i think i'm you know bright enough to take in information analyze that information and make determinations based upon that information. You know, as Dr. Mann eloquently talked yesterday about the forward in the January draft, I find that to be, as one of the teachers mentioned, offensive to the profession, and reflects things I just don't agree with. I heard enough today, and I've heard enough during the

[05:42:38] period from when all this came out to now, to believe that our January draft contains significant flaws and i think you don't disagree with that i mean certainly some flaws that need to be corrected and it's not clear to me how we get to fixing those flaws if that's the draft that goes out right now for public hearing you know i the question is what's going to be the base document we use right when we come back in april and if this is the base document i mean there are

[05:43:14] significant changes that would have to be made to have it reflect more of what the professional community who spoke before us today believes is developmentally appropriate and appropriate for the standards in the Commonwealth. You know, I agree with you that, and I actually agree with Mr. Rotherham, the transparency issue is troubling to me. I would not actually, if we were to go this route, I think we have to give more time to the public to review the coalition or the cooperative draft before we actually begin our public hearings. Not something I would do lightly,

[05:43:53] But, you know, I'm pretty convinced right now, having heard as much and read as much as I've read, that it's going to be a difficult lift when we come back in April and review this to do a line by line that gets it to a point where the professional teaching community in the Commonwealth says, this is a document that, you know, will make us proud and will in fact be best in class.

[05:44:20] So, you know, anyway, it just, you know, we're put in a difficult spot. You know, we had, you know, one of the things, you know, my time here is short, as we've talked about, and I reflect every once in a while about, you know, what it is you want to leave with the board.

[05:44:45] And one of those things, you know, from my perspective is, you know, the independence of this board, you know, from, you know, all the executives we've, you know, served. I mean, if you go back again to our unique place in Virginia, we are a board that is supposed to be independent of the executive subservient, really only to the legislature.

[05:45:09] And I would hope that as this board moves on, that, you know, that independent role becomes more pronounced than I think it is today. You know, I do think that we have had too much process interference in what is supposed to be the board's work.

[05:45:31] And I think that's hurt us. It hurt us with the public. I think it hurts us with the end product. And it is not a reflection of staff. I understand what goes on. But it is, to me, the reality is that at the end of the day, it's like the first draft that came out last year from the department.

[05:45:50] You know, nobody believed that was a good thing. You know, we didn't have anybody standing up and saying, yeah, this is what we ought to pass. And so we went back and we went back. you know, I hope as you get into, you know, the next iteration of this board in July that you recognize more fully the independence that you ought to have. You know, we're appointed by governors. We are not subject to governors. We are clearly subject to the legislature.

[05:46:15] So, I mean, it's a long way of saying, you know, I don't really like where we are, but, you know, I don't see myself supporting the current draft without some changes, which is why i asked mr rotherham you know could we do some of the other votes before we went forward fully because there may be enough changes in that draft i could support it going out you know that got made through the motions that i anticipate being made but i ask a process question just like what what because what you say carries a lot of weight with me i want to make sure the

[05:46:53] process is it goes out and then it will be revised based on the comments so maybe revised okay maybe yeah okay maybe but it can be and so it is not where we're going to come back with the same draft in a few months and then have to like it will come back no we will come back but many of the changes we want could already have been incorporated at that point no no we will go to the public with a single draft and that will be heard at all the public hearings we are not going to make midstream changes after this point the next round of changes will be when it comes before us for final but those changes can be made before it actually comes before us for final we

[05:47:29] won't be doing we won't have to do that no no no no no it doesn't work that way because individual board members can't make the changes but i mean based on public comments and stuff the department can my understanding is the department can make changes we can get a revised version the product at this point forward is the boards not the departments and it is it's not going to be changed because nobody has the authority to make those changes except the board as a whole it is a body corporate that makes those changes not me not you not you know alan it is all of us and so the question is what what do you want to be that first draft coming in in uh april is it

[05:48:06] going to you know and i'm not saying it ought to be the vscd draft but it it may well not be the draft in its current form with some of the issues that i wouldn't say all of us have noted but enough people

have noted you know what what's going to be easiest for us is to say you know even on non-controversial subjects right it is a tough process to draft this way but that is the way it's going to get done mr president i just hope trying to get us to move on because i do think we have substantive conversations that we want to have while you're still with us today

[05:48:42] may i uh just a couple of comments um there are a couple of things you mentioned and i'm struggling to understand when you uh i'm not sure what you meant by independence of the board uh and uh so i'm not sure what that means uh i'm i'm hoping this is an independent board and everybody is an individual with an independent thinking mind so i i think i have confidence in the board and i think it will be um secondly um i know it takes uh i've heard from a lot of people and i know it takes a lot of you know juggling of your schedule to try to make it

[05:49:21] up to richmond to speak um so just because there weren't enough opinions on one side of the aisle i wouldn't necessarily i think it's a mistake to think that people don't feel the other way i've received plenty of emails i think we've seen a lot of these comments and um with due uh respect with due deference um i'm also going to say that you know we do sometimes see some of the same folks and i give them full credit for making the time here for it but uh uh you know i i don't

[05:50:00] think that physically being here or not here is necessarily a sign of the public sentiment make that okay i appreciate those things yeah we're going to go ahead and take the vote although at some point we'll respond to the independence issue all right uh we have a motion uh let's go ahead all in favor of the motion to substitute if you will or to accept the bscd draft as the first review from the board signify by saying aye aye opposed no no okay andy you want to or ann would

[05:50:36] you do yeah yeah that's okay andy let's go ahead i'll make a another motion that we uh accept the january 23 draft presented by the administration for first review purposes with amendments and the amendments that i will move fall into three categories one set of amendments uh dealing with the uh front matter and i can specify them more fully the second amendment making uh clarifying that uh local divisions maintain some flexibility as to the grade sequence and the third set of

[05:51:15] amendments uh adding a standard adding language and standards with respect to race relations in the first part of the 20th century as itemized in our discussion yesterday and in the document i shared with board members 10 days ago so that's my motion is that we accept the january 23 draft with those sets three sets of amendments is there going to be another motion after this i think i've swept it all into one so too but i just want to make sure

[05:51:45] okay so we have a motion is there a second no second any other discussion yeah i'd like to offer a second degree that we just move this. I put that on the table by the way we can then have discussion. I would like to discuss these issues. I do not want to truncate Ms. Holder or any of my other colleagues' concerns. I think we should discuss stuff we heard here today, but before we start moving with amendments, let's also see if there's a – we just want to have a discussion and move forward as is.

[05:52:23] I mean, now is our chance to discuss that, right? So you're making the case that we should go forward without amendments um yeah i'm putting that on the table if there's a second obviously well no my motion is on the table but i can second degree yours can i yeah sorry substitute well i'm not going to go i'm not going to go robert's rules of order i think the right process is however whatever motion is on the table let's discuss the option of moving let's have a robust discussion as robust as needed on going forward

with the january 23th draft for first review as printed and going through on it with the sets of of of changes that i've proposed and that's the

[05:53:01] discussion i'd like to and i would like to um say something in support of my sets of changes yeah absolutely i think we should i want that too and i think that's the discussion and i'd love to hear others views on it that's the discussion we should have i felt like on the last amendment we were conflating a couple of things it was getting so let's go to that let's not get caught up on the who's motion let's let's have that conversation about whether to make a few changes now or whether to go forward on first review with the existing document i mean those are kind of the options right so let's deal with the option to make the changes first and then we'll deal with the motion and put it all forward so if i i will i promise i'll be brief since i did speak at length yesterday

[05:53:41] but my three sets of changes the first set of changes uh i have proposed some line by line edits to the first uh section but uh but what i raised yesterday and that would be my motion today that we simply delete the language from guiding principles through the implementation section so i think it's pages uh seven eight and the first half of nine uh if if it were the will of the board instead to line by line item to make some line changes i'm happy to have that conversation

[05:54:18] but i think it's easier to simply say as i that's what i proposed yesterday by way of compromise that let's just take it out of the standards it's not a standard anyway let's um you know folks can use that language in the as a press release or whatever else they want to use it for but that it's not that we take it out of the standards endorsed by this board for first review um and i'll and i did that for all the reasons we discussed yesterday um and i won't i won't belabor them but starting with restore right through to the teacher uh created curriculum concerns i raised yesterday

[05:54:56] that that for me to put my name on this document to go out for first review addressing the challenges in that section feels very crucial and understand that other folks may feel that there's stuff in that material that's crucially important and that's why i say go forward with it but not as part of the standards. And then the second change is that I did propose some language yesterday, and I'm happy to repeat it today, but that just reinforces the locals flexibility.

[05:55:29] I do support Ms. Creasy's position that civics and economics and history one and two should be mandated. And if that language needs clarifying, I think it is what the code intent is whether the code language is strong enough or not is a remains to be seen and we may ask the board the staff to help us clarify that between now and uh march or april when we come back but but that i i support miss creasy's intent but that the language as written says geography in the eighth grade which most schools do not do now and that takes away some significant local flexibility

[05:56:06] that i think is uh sufficiently problematic that it should be dealt with up front rather than on the back end and then the third set is the the standards the changes i proposed for um i'll leave a leave aside the second grade matter for now we can deal with that later but the standard the languages i proposed heading harry bird back into the fourth grade with some language that i quoted yesterday plus the new standard i proposed for um us 2 and virginia u.s addressing race

[05:56:41] relations in the 20th century and and those are again as for the reasons i stated yesterday at least they are sufficiently important they ought to be in there and we ought to get the public's response to them um so uh i would rather not wait until march and april because then we won't have the benefit of the

public reacting to that language so i think i do endorse mr president's goal of getting something out the door today. And that's why I moved the January version forward.

[05:57:14] I proposed that we go forward with the January version with these amendments that will enable us to maybe get close to a consensus vote on it, which would be wonderful for the public's sake. Mr. President, from an administrative standpoint, it would be difficult to vote on a new standard, just specifically a new standard that has not yet been developed to approve.

[05:57:40] i mean i wrote the language it's the language everybody has yeah well has had it at 10 days ago okay it's it's not in this set of standards and our our staff hasn't discussed it well but i sent the draft to the department and everybody on the board 10 days ago and asked uh ms brown yesterday to be ready today to address if she has any concerns about it yeah we have a motion it has been seconded is there more discussion yeah my discuss i'll stop my discussion i have a question do we have an analysis i mean what ms holton's talking about i'm not i mean on the substance

[05:58:19] i don't disagree with i suspect none of my colleagues do i'm confused about where it's going to go and i'm also a lot of that content is actually in there when we talk about it so like per the point today that it's the editing on the fly makes me uncomfortable do we have an analysis of what this would look like and what where it would create redundancies we have to make other changes and where it would add new content and all that like i'm i guess i'm asking and i may be the only one but i'm asking because i'm kind of unclear what exactly we'd be voting on it's my understanding from um the discussion yesterday and what is coming up now there the

[05:58:58] content is there and i believe it is us 2.7 reconstruction i'm sorry three yes yes 2.3 and i don't know off off the top of my head the vus standard but up to what um right now what that standard looks like is everything from basically 1865 until the turn of the century almost is in

[05:59:37] one standard and it's my understanding this is holton what you're asking for is for that information to be divided and make a distinction in a new standard that really looks at the challenges and accomplishments after um reconstruction or due to reconstruction and there's sub standards in us 2.2 for example that could be pulled in based on what you read us yesterday um could be pulled into this new standard and there would have to be a development

[06:00:13] of specifically what you were talking about with the changes i believe it was the um legislature the way that the congress changed and i believe there was also a supreme court case and then some of that information like the development of the nwacp as a part of the standard that you are proposing so some of the content mr rotherham is in for example us2 um a through i believe it's a through i some of those would be pulled into what miss holton is i'm proposing but am i right miss

[06:00:51] brown the content you're referring to is under effects of reconstruction and it takes us up i think your phrase was up to the turn of the century i'm talking about not just up to the turn of the century but through from 1902 especially 1902 especially all the way up to the mid-1960s Yes, because some of the content that's in US 2.2, it goes, the substandards go from A to L.

[06:01:17] There's a lot of content there that really could be broken into two. So just to use one specific example, I think, and I can't, I don't have your facility to immediately like go to every, you know, like a Google Earth with this document.

[06:01:32] can't do that but i think like world war ii the tuskegee airmen and the effect the fact we had a segregated armed forces during world war ii and and the effect of that and so forth that is my understanding students are going to learn that that's both in the standards giving the curricular framework right so we're not we're not just sort of jumping and skipping over from the late 19th century and the rise of jim crow and racial terror to like 1964 or something there's content on this in between correct there is content yes sir okay and if i may uh just make one comment that um i'm uncomfortable with this you know this idea of on the fly accepting something

[06:02:09] because i had uh i would you know like to have time to look at the revisions do my research on it and i would not be comfortable voting on that today where we are there's a motion in a second i i'm sorry mr president i need to go back to again six months in i can't really say that you you know, I'm truly a novice anymore, but I've been assuring my constituents and people I work with and colleagues throughout this whole process that, you know, this is a handoff. Today is the

[06:02:44] day that the department's piece comes to us, passing of the baton, and that now we have the public process. And then at the end, you know, I've heard it say several times today and previous meetings, we're prepared to go line by line at that point in time. But then a couple minutes ago, kind of heard well that's hard to do because um it goes right here it's hard to make those changes in that short period of time afterwards but i i'm so first so i have things um less thought out as secretary holton's but i have things that i'd like to see done that i want to recommend but i want to do that in a thoughtful manner and i don't think i'm prepared to do that today so that that's kind

[06:03:24] of where i'm to help me understand i thought this was the baton passing from this from the staff to the board and now we go through our process us as board members going out to the public listening etc coming back and then that's when we would make make changes so i i have things there's things i mean some of the things secretary holden is listed um district control free exercise clause i mean there's there's lots of things that i'm interested in but i'm not prepared to do it thoughtfully today and can we just elevate up just for a minute look these standards are not perfect okay no set of standards are and we should just preface it with like the set of standards any of us are going to like we're going to need nine sets and nine prefaces and i i believe on that like

[06:04:04] we're all going to anyone who spent any time thinking about reading history has different interpretations on on on different things there's things in here that i think should be improved for sure there's language things there's things i'm sure some of our nato allies might be a little concerned about the way we describe socialism democracy that's a wording thing we need to we need to fix it it's not like none of this is the end of the world but this process we're getting to a point we had people in here today arguing that who want us to adopt a 400 page document arguing that one that's basically 50 pages is now too long we had people say that stuff that's just not true about these standards the content they cover things like that we're sort of getting to a point where

[06:04:40] we're losing the thread and i agree with my colleague uh dr stebert very much that like i don't think this is the final i think the wisdom of the commonwealth in these various hearings we're going to have more public input i think we will be able to improve on the document there's stuff that is you know oversights but as i said yesterday the idea that like we have totalitarianism and the rise of uh militarism in europe and what happened in that section and students are somehow not either not going to learn fascism or that there's some weird numerology going on i mean it's absurd and and and at some point we have to say let's put this out to the people of the state to get their

[06:05:18] wisdom the citizens teachers subject matter experts and so forth and then we will probably make some revisions and we may get to line by line again i think miss holton it may make that may make great sense that may be something that i would vote for when it comes back but i just think doing it right now this is we're completely losing the thread uh i don't want to speak my colleagues i don't want to offer an amendment to truncate discussion but uh i think i think we we just have to move this out and hear from the people of this commonwealth who may surprise us or not surprise us uh uh with what they think suggest to you that the people we heard from this

[06:05:53] morning were people of the commonwealth but absolutely they were and i am grateful for them coming i mean i don't want anybody to think that we are dismissing you know absolutely not nobody's suggesting that no absolutely not that's it is great that people come here i have no preferences whether they come here to praise us or criticize us that's it's a sacred first amendment right and And I think as I think it was it was as Dutta said, anyone who takes the time to come to Richmond to petition their government, we should hear them.

[06:06:23] I think that's important. So it is absolutely not. But but I'm going to offer a but I'm going to offer a but this has not gone out to a full like people who people who come. It's great. We should hear their voices. We should hear the interest groups and so forth. But there's also a broader set of people around the Commonwealth, which is why I think this process we're going to embark on is is so important.

[06:06:48] move but i i actually beg to differ with my colleague whom i certainly respect we had many many people in the commonwealth heard on this and it is not okay to fail to acknowledge that as we deal with being in this moment there were 5 000 comments associated with the august draft and i'm not advocating for that because we're past that we have heard from the people and it has not been

[06:07:25] to their according to their feedback to us it appears that we've not heard them and i think it would not be appropriate to not acknowledge that in our discourse i i am ready to move on but i i definitely cannot just quietly sit here and actually process the idea that we have not heard from people, we have. Yeah, and I think that's a mischaracterization. We have not heard from the full swap. I did not say either that the people here were not citizens, nor did I say that we somehow haven't heard from them. I just said there's a further process. And I will say, I mean, I

[06:08:05] appreciate the public comment. It's terrific. But there was stuff that was said that was just simply factually inaccurate. There was stuff that was pedagogically irresponsible. The idea that we're going to, we don't need standards because we're going to let kids Google. I mean, we have a responsibility here um uh you can't do it someone said you can just click and find stuff well that's not actually how how people learn um and so we have a responsibility to sift through it and and take it and so forth but uh i think this next process is going to give us a lot of feedback that will be very valuable not all of which i think different people will like and i think i can't imagine how we go out and get a worse document i can quite imagine how we come out

[06:08:42] amount of get one that while this one's quite good is even better. Ricola, question? Yeah, we're going to move in just one second, Mr. Hanson. You know, I don't want to lose the distinction between, you know, because Alan brought up a good point, you know, this is part of the way and we have more to do and is it harder to do it, you know, based off one base. You know, I distinguish between sort of the fact changes that is what we're going to teach and the developmentally appropriate pieces. It will be harder with one of

the drafts to, you know, if you believe that some of the comments with regard to developmental appropriateness are accurate and there's a desire to make changes in that regard

[06:09:20] it will be harder to do that with one of the drafts than with the other right what are you talking about i'm still the draft well it'll be easier to make changes off the developmental appropriateness with the coalition draft and the department just voted it down i know that but i'm responding to mr dr siebert's point which was gee i thought it'd be easy we just come back and do this and the answer is it's easy with regard to and equally easy what facts are being taught and what sequencing there is it's less easy with regard to if we're going to make

[06:09:56] changes in the developmental you know to address the concerns about developmental appropriateness of certain things because then all of a sudden you're shifting whole sections that's all mr president i i just wanted to support what mr rotherham has said i i hope as a board and our independence that we will have 10 weeks before us here to be working with the staff working with the public on what we hear working with the draft of the associations there was a lot of good in that and i would really hope that our process with the public hearings our capacity to work in good faith

[06:10:35] with one another i think ann has made some great points and i would love to work to bring some of those to pass and we're fully capable of doing this and being able to take the good and try to use that to refine what we're going to be putting out to the public and make it better it's something that we could hopefully dance point be all proud of to sign on to so i just would move the question that we okay if i may just very briefly i i just i would love to see us get to a version that we can have close to consensus on and i do think that that would

[06:11:14] help in the process of restoring public trust or i won't take back restoring moving forward with public trust what are you saying so enhancing inspiring public trust so if just for discussion purposes if i were to limit my motion to the front matter piece page seven eight and half of nine and again not that people can't use that language but use that language separately um and uh

[06:11:51] i feel like i could vote for this draft and then appreciate mr rotherham um agreeing with that we need to work on the content about the 20th century race relations you know if we need to work if it's better to work on those content pieces later i could live with that i can't live with a draft that says we're restoring excellence when I see the excellent educators that we heard from this morning and that I meet all across Virginia in every opportunity I have to see our public school.

[06:12:25] I can't live with a draft that talks about the stain of slavery. I can't live with a draft that says what it says about the Constitution without acknowledging the inherent flaws of the original constitution i can't live with a draft that takes away implies that it's taking away teacher creativity so i i can't vote for it with that those pages so if there is a way we can get those pages separated out and somebody i can vote on the rest of it without voting on that then i then i at

[06:13:02] least could contribute my vote towards a consensus so i could i would be happy happy but willing to modify my motion to that and if that helps i don't know that may hurt i don't know i feel like we're having the we're kind of deja vu we're kind of rehashing and talking about the same things we did yesterday and and we went over this we all have very different viewpoints what some may see as ideological another might see it as patriotic and um there definitely has been a nationwide

[06:13:36] conversation about um history uh and um viewpoints and i i uh you know feel that i i don't know if there's slicing and dicing semantics here but i i do feel education across the nation needs to have there needs to be some restoration of uh merit uh academic excellence in in every subject so um again it's the same discussion part of the same discussion we had yesterday

[06:14:11] i feel the guiding principles are uh they give you a brief overview of what the commonwealth and the citizens can expect and should expect um so okay we are at the point where we're going to call this question and have you amended that motion to be just the preface piece president's yes and the second same thing thank you dr man my motion if i'm allowed to do so to move forward the january 23 uh proposed standards for personal review uh minus pages seven eight and the first

[06:14:51] half of page nine which is the introduction through the implementation section the motion and seconded by dr man yes all right all those in favor signify by saying aye aye i'm unclear what what we're voting on. I'm sorry. We're voting on moving forward the draft from the department with the exception of pages seven, eight, and the top half of nine, which is basically the preface material. That's what we're voting on. So we're taking out pieces that are not in the standards themselves, but are prefatory to the standards. Some of the preface material remains, but the

[06:15:25] guiding principles, introduction, expectations, and implementation principles and explanation section, implementation sections would be gone. So the prefatory material would begin with the background and context. I think the goal is to have a document that all eight of us sitting here are going to approve to move forward as the draft. And if that doesn't happen, that's fine. But it just, I think that's what the goal is. So once again, I think, I hope we now all understand the

[06:15:55] motion. Mr. President, I'm sorry. I just, what, to me, if we can move the standards and then come back and talk about the preface i you know i just i i could i'm happy because otherwise i have the same concern before i want to make thoughtful changes to the preface um and and make those thoughtful and we can work on those that's going to take a while you can make those thoughtful changes potentially after you know without starting with pages seven eight and if my motion fails then i'm anticipating somebody's going to move the whole thing that's right exactly let's

[06:16:33] Go ahead. I think it's time to call the question. Mr. President, I would like to offer a substitute. I'd like to offer a substitute that we move the entire thing. I think we're just creating confusion here. You don't hear anybody saying, oh, this is perfect. I'm only going to vote for it if this page doesn't change or this is locked in. In fact, we're talking about changes. But this is getting awfully confusing. I'm offering a substitute that we move this.

[06:16:58] And if you do that, you're not going to have a consensus to say no. Second. Whereas. Okay. All right. Call the question. So moving the whole document forward. His motion was seconded. Now we're moving on his motion. Okay. All in favor, signify by saying aye.

[06:17:16] Aye. Opposed? Nay. Nay. All right. Motion carries. I think we should end on, I think there's a lot of disagreements and so forth, but we don't, I mean, the work that the team has put in is remarkable. I mean, I think, I don't know that anyone's going to say like this process, if we had to do it over again, we would do it exactly the same way. I mean, someone, I guess, is welcome to make that case. But, you know, and this process is not over. And I think in a couple of months, and we'll have some very specific language, I think Ms. Holton has some for us on a potential new standard that we'll be able to see how it incorporates. There'll be stuff.

[06:17:52] but I think it is time, I don't wanna end on a sour note, it is time to get this to the public. And I think they have a right to respond to all of it in total. And I think we'll get some great feedback. - I don't think we're ending on a sour note. And thank you for reminding us.

[06:18:08] I know all of you sitting here in the humanities and social studies, I know how many hours of your time over the holidays, weekends, evenings you've spent, i'm very grateful to you and thankful to you all appreciate it and at some point move forward i may have made a parliamentary error here also telling me it was seconded and she was called an amendment right she amended her motion then we had a motion for a substitute yes i don't know that procedurally

[06:18:44] that's the right way to do it i mean if it were an amendment that miss holton would agree to and the second would agree to That could be the question is before the board, but I don't know how to substitute the motion. Just take another vote. Just take two votes. We'll vote on ends.

[06:19:00] I have no problem just going back and... I am quite sure that, Deb, you have forgotten more about this than I know. Yeah, me too. I'm sure I've forgotten more. No, I appreciate it. Thank you. All right. All right, we're going to go ahead, and we will correct, I guess, what I didn't do right. We're going to vote on this Holton's motion first, which is to move the draft minus pages 7, 8, top half of 9.

[06:19:21] all those in favor of that motion signify by saying aye aye any opposed no no now mr rotherham's motion to move the whole thing forward all those in favor signify by saying aye aye those opposed nay no all right that covers it i'm turning the gavel over to dr van the gavel i will at some point need somebody to help me i i want to see significant improvements made and so i think i'm lacking clarity on the mechanisms to make those i totally agree i assumed we had 10 weeks yeah i think we do i think we do i think we should be very clear we're putting this out for public

[06:19:57] comment we're not locking in not an adoption we're not locking it in and i think anyone who mischaracterizes that everybody thinks like every word is great like there's been tons of discussion i think what we're talking about here is the most expeditious process not the final kind of thing when we do this side by side that's going out to the public of the 2015 and the version that's going out uh-huh yes sir i think we're obviously going to need to have a working document as a board to take the document that's going out to start having a red line version of

[06:20:27] that for our considerations oh go ahead you go first i'll just nope um what we have what i have um started on is that red line document because that's something that is traditionally done when we review and revise the standards so that you see what was there from 2015 i'm sorry i didn't mean a side-by-side so your red line version yes sir goes out and then just for the board for us to have a working document for us to be able to do in our line by line work and to make sure that again it'll be helpful talent's point to understand what that process is because i'm

[06:21:06] confused yeah yeah and thank you and you know yesterday i hope we we went into enough detail about why the red line document was not done. The red line document was done from 2015 to August, and then we had a synthesis and an evolution that we responded in November to the side-by-side-by-side and not the red line. And so, we will get that, and I appreciate the team for stepping up.

[06:21:33] If I could just take a couple of minutes from an administrative point, just, yep. Dr. Belk, if anyone else has anything, I want to make one point, I think Dr. Siebert may, like i'm interested in the public comments like i don't have a point of view on this sequencing question for instance i'm very

interested in what we get back from the field and what we're going to learn so i think like we we want to be very careful how we uh i think there's lots of things where everybody is quite sure everyone's settled this is a public process that's going to continue yes the public's had its say but we're now going to enter a more robust phase of that around the commonwealth um and i think it's going to be i think it's going to be a learning process uh and

[06:22:11] And as I said, I think it's going to be a better document, but I want it to be like, no one should think that everyone, we're all set on what's developmentally appropriate or not. It's going to be good to hear from the field on that. All this stuff, this will be, I think, a genuine learning process. Madam President. Yes. I just wanted to make a comment that how deeply I appreciate the consortium's work and the very deep and thoughtful and exhaustive work. I think it's important for us to recognize what their role was in trying to assist this process. But I do

[06:22:50] think that it's worthy, of course, of us taking that document and analyzing it for what it can do to improve what we have just moved for first review. And so I certainly want to ensure that my vote is associated with further and continued collaboration and improvement, just like I think the rest of my colleagues is as well, and under no circumstances is it dismissive of the unbelievable, quite frankly, work that that group came together to do. And I'm certain that

[06:23:29] that's y'all's sentiment as well, to some degree, seeing that just come to you. But so I really wanted to make sure that there was no offense that was taken there. And with the August draft as well like that like i think we have some pedagogical disagreements but there was tremendous work and and good faith like i think this is you know this is a this is it is in that it is in that sphere there's been tons of work and engagement um and we should have said that in addition to thanking a great team here and in the only way but at the end come april for me to feel good

[06:24:04] there's going to have to be a chance to render improvements i to me this was again my my we are receiving a drug we received a draft we have received it we were there's a third first review we had a first review in august we had one we have so so we've had many first reviews we've received this um but i i really want to know what is the going to be the mechanism to to polish it up i think polishing is the word that i think we all this is we're a bunch of like hyper attentive people and so what we don't like there's a lot of good and i think we're overlooking we're now one of the only states uh just a handful of states that has things like oprah fell uh and that aspect

[06:24:41] of the civil rights movement in its standards i mean that's really noteworthy um we've added a lot there was a lot i mean we heard this morning from some people there are some problems with how we taught history in the state um uh and and sort of how some of that was presented these standards are an improvement on that so i think we've all we've all immediately i know i did i went to like here are the couple of things that like i don't like and i want changed we should acknowledge like Like, this is good work, and it's good that we're at this point in the process.

[06:25:08] And, again, we can hear from the Commonwealth. Mr. Rotham, thank you. We're going to have Superintendent Bailo have a word. But I would like to say, just really quickly, people didn't disagree with content. They disagreed very vociferously with the approach and the skills and the lack thereof.

[06:25:25] So as we talk about brushing up and polishing, let's make certain that we're going to be focusing on the skills that foster critical thinking and the things that really help students succeed, right? And I'm not really hearing that reflected and I'm hoping as we're using words like polish up or tweak and

things of that sort, what we heard this morning really did speak to not just content, but really a focus on skills.

[06:25:49] - With respect, Dr. Mann, content is the foundation of critical thinking. - It's a both in, Superintendent Baylow. - Thank you, Madam Chair. And that's a great place to start. So we have the standards document that is now accepted for first review.

[06:26:07] And I think it's just important to level set and remind folks that this is the public facing document that lays out the broad teaching and learning goals for the students of Virginia in history and social sciences, including geography and economics and civics and history.

[06:26:23] The next step, and I'm gonna slow down and just kind of re-explain this a little bit, is the curriculum framework development. We are starting from a very different place with the development of the curriculum frameworks than we have in the past, because there's lots of content from the August document and the work that this team has done that is still, it's on our website.

[06:26:46] It is not accepted by this board. It's not passed by this board, adopted, but it is great content from two years of feedback on this process. That will be the basis for the curriculum framework work. and remember that curriculum framework is the bridge between the standards document and the implementation of the standards that's the curriculum the resources the uh pacing the the teaching and learning from day to day one of the key stakeholder groups in the development of the curriculum frameworks is teachers so um we've talked already we're starting to plan how do we

[06:27:25] we bring teachers back together to just like they did in 2015 to have the fulsome conversations that are needed to develop the curriculum frameworks. So there are still lots and lots and lots of opportunities to bring these standards to life. This morning, we heard words like synthesis and design. Those are words that will be in the curriculum document. That's the day-to-day work. Those are the tasks that have existed. And I think if you look historically, not just in history and social studies but across content areas you'll see that the inquiry the

[06:28:00] critical thinking those skills exist in the curriculum frameworks again with the content knowledge really being the front facing in the public document for the standards today we heard from lots and lots of of really passionate speakers which was great and it was really interesting to me as i sat here there were lots of criticisms about the amount of content and also lots of suggestions about what more we could add but not much about what we should take away therein lies the challenge that this team had and really that all of the voices across the

[06:28:38] commonwealth have had where do we find ourselves in these standards and we'll continue to grapple with that and there are 10 different viewpoints about that right now um just to kind of front and front end that um nces a national organization affiliated with the u.s department of education reports that 44 of schools have reduced their time teaching social studies we all know up here that in some cases social studies isn't even seen as a core content area any longer we want to change that people want that changed um signal a national polling a group did a poll across the

[06:29:17] aisles two-thirds of likely voters think civics in schools should be emphasized more two-thirds of people think that civics is more important now than it was five years ago two-thirds of of likely voters both sides of the aisle believe that more funding should go toward receiving an adequate civics education so i just want to be really clear that we're investing our energy we're investing our thoughts into the right

topics into the right areas and into the right conversations i am going to stop there madam chair because there is a lot a lot of other business that

[06:29:55] we need to get to i will spend the next week and then some really cleaning up some of the misinformation that that was was shared today some of the misinformation that was out there but i don't want that to eclipse the great information that we have in front of this board that our staff has moving forward and into public comments or public hearings but i would like to just bookend this with this that as folks come to public hearings as folks submit public comments i just would really ask that they take a look at the standards take a look at where things are

[06:30:32] and not just base it on a specific set of talking points um i it's it's it's not a long document and it is meant to be public facing and so um so i really hope that people take a look at the standards and find themselves find their cultures find their um find their interests reflected in the standards because they are uh they are representative voices and work over the last two years this is not a standalone document that was stood up over the last couple of weeks thank

[06:31:05] you one more thing um and i i'm just going to echo what miss crazy said about uh about the feedback from the organizations and say that we've we've received lots of feedback from organizations i can say we have not received anything as fulsome as what was submitted by that organization and we would be um it would be negligence on our part not to take that into consideration as we go through the um the this process of public hearings we've already had this conversation as a team uh we had it when we first received them and we're finishing up this document that was just

[06:31:45] accepted for first review going what do we do with this the work is the our work as as it relates to the board directive is done and so really we plan on taking that and more forward in the public hearing process and in the continued revision and finalization process thank you madam president that was all over the board and i appreciate the indulgence thank you for your comments all right we're going to return and thank you all again okay thank you have a great day yes madame vice president before they to leave can i just have to i'm sorry um so in terms of next

[06:32:24] steps to trying to get to this destination that i have been adamant for months we were heading toward um can we can we provide a word version i mean we've got the pdf out there can we provide a word version to these organizations that i think will help them talk about you know on their own conversations so they give them a word version of the document to begin working on um i think that would be be one part and then i think that getting the strike through is hugely important and it'll be communicated rapidly even though it's not coming out until president's day that we communicate rapidly that that is forthcoming because that was a very frequent ask a few people

[06:33:01] asked it today but it was a very frequent ask i received in the last month okay i'm going to defer to staff on that because i know that there's a process that they've used and i'm not sure how this plays into it but i know that they can do that out yes yeah perhaps offer it by uh request so we'll determine what the the best way forward is with that so to request dr siebert the word

[06:33:34] version of the january 2023 document so that everyone has access to a word version and then by george washington's day you'll have the strikethrough redline version of look it's the base of it is the 2015 standards with um what the revisions for 2023 were that they will be in red and not that it's alarming or anything but it just stands out uh better to see and what was changed from 2015 will have a strikethrough yes i think it's very helpful to bring this conversation back

[06:34:14] to what we had and what we have and and also whether i'm a a kindergarten teacher and i just want to mark up mine or if i'm an association i want to have a group to mark up a one the whole document i think just making it easier for them to cut that way the conversations are focused um and we can move from talking points to let's talk about this standard on this line yesterday you mentioned um we currently on our um history and social science webpage have a chart for and each one is separated out, that's part of the request for the Word version, correct? Or just

[06:34:51] the whole document? You all have to do all that work. Okay. I think that would be helpful. Okay. And if I may, I think this is consistent with what Dr. Siebert has in mind, but just to be clear that that strikethrough version, whether in Word or PDF form should be made available to the public as part of the materials they can look at in preparing their public comment at the public hearings you may well send other versions out too but part of what you want to make sure the public knows is available is the strikethrough version yes thank you thank you all right again thank you

[06:35:31] all for your time this afternoon appreciate you being here thank you thank you all so we're going to come back up to um item c on the agenda the first and final review of updates to lab school application process document and we have um assistant state superintendent assistant state superintendent elizabeth schultz who will be here with us

[06:36:16] yeah let's do can we have a five minute break thank you afternoon so um uh hello board i am

[06:42:12] i'm going to graciously try to give you back as much time because this is a read-only and i'm just going to provide a little bit of a preview of some changes that the board um we're asking the board to entertain and then hand off to the department and delegate to us the 2010-11 monikered lab school application process document anticipated some things that none of us really now understand why there were some barrier timelines

[06:42:48] that were presented in that lab school application process document that have proven to be unwieldy for applicants and for the department to manage there are cases within that process document that it's unclear that a institute of higher ed is actually the applicant and so what we've done and you should have in your board book um a red line of the document we don't i'm sorry do we have a red line i couldn't find it maybe yeah it's not redlined it's not red

[06:43:30] i think we need you to walk us through the changes because they're not there how do you navigate to it maybe in some one link it is and the other links to a different document i went to item c attachment a i think jim is maybe going to help us the red line document yep um jillian has the red line but not everybody else be available on the sharepoint site what we're being told is because the wi-fi wireless that everyone else is trying to have the ns server flushed that they're still being directed to the old no no this isn't that problem

[06:44:07] jim this is a different problem this is on the board book version attachment a on this item is not redlined right let's receive printed copies well i don't have a printed copy i did never see a printed copy well there was a lab school we didn't actually have the meeting together you know i don't know i'm sorry i have it um let me see if i can share it a different way jillian you're looking on the sharepoint site as well um i'm i don't know could i maybe just email the the

[06:44:46] document to you i think that's probably i think we can all open emails i think i think it's that i think it's i mean i guess the quickest way for public transparency standpoint we need to make sure we'll

make sure we do changes to people who are watching and so forth as as far as we knew that we we turned this over for the board books so the version in the board book clear is the by that's the final the red line version no that's what's what i think what mr rotherham's

[06:45:23] question is is the version that we're seeing that's not redlined the version that you're asking us to adopt that gets into mr chapman's issue which is the public website's got issues today yeah just i i actually do have the red line version through the sharepoint site not where we're none of us can see it i refreshed and refresh maybe if we try how about if we try board meeting a doctor i think this is related to the same issue and why you

[06:46:01] can't get to the i see okay okay here's my navigation path okay so i this is old school i think i went to jim's email where he had a link to the public comments so it is a yeah public comments it was tuesday at 3 58. we're we're all on the public wi-fi you are on the

[06:46:41] departments so so department members are in a different version you're in a different version

[06:47:01] okay we're going to take just a quick two minute break we're having some technical issues

[06:47:45] thank you okay it it should be redlined and i'm going to draw your attention the the first few

[06:52:24] items are really just, you know, the board is defined in the wrong place, the college partnership definition is in the wrong place, but I want to significantly take you to page six and slide down to section two general instructions. So this is one of the artificial timelines when we went back and talked to former state board members and people who were originally on the first standing committee of the lab school standing committee for the board nobody really could get a grasp on why

[06:53:03] we put a year barrier between the time they submit and to the time a school could open the pulling that down and allowing your standing committee to operate and do its review and do its recommendations is is sufficient um and this is a real barrier and an inhibition to innovation in the local school divisions participating with the ihe's and so we recommend that that that be pulled out the second is that with with that removal the paragraph below does not become

[06:53:42] germane because that's again part of that that barrier is looking for an exception to the one year if you slide down to page seven we just provide some clarity because the instructions out to the public and to eligible entities is that lab school applications and planning grant applications need to come into our established email address. If you want to continue receiving them as the board for the standing committee, that's fine. But the official admission is through

[06:54:16] the lab school's email address. There's just a definition that we're clarifying. Because we have the internal department funding evaluation review committee that does the planning grants. We just want to keep a common nomenclature that yours is the standing committee. So it's the standing committee of the board for the lab school. So that's just fine. We do clarify at the bottom of page seven that the standing committee has the ability to look for individuals with subject matter expertise i don't recommend using the word appoint a point has a certain

[06:54:55] connotation to it but just that they can convene whatever you know either it's internal department technical expertise from from dr albin or myself or they could ask for a working group but they're not going to the standing committee itself is not going to appoint other people they just can

convene the public comment at the top of page eight this is just pulled up from further down there is a sequence that's involved in that the department receives an application we review it for

[06:55:32] completeness um we don't we don't vet the information we just make sure that they've provided what's been asked for and then we turn it over to the standing committee the standing committee meets with the um with the applicant and then conducts public comment and so the public comment was just in the wrong place we've just pulled it up so there's an order a proper cadence to this document and that it's more helpful to the iegs the there's just some house cleanup here in the third paragraph below meeting with the college

[06:56:11] partnership lab school standing committee this is following the public comment period or public hearing held by the standing committee and and the meeting with the institution of higher ed the standing committee will prepare the report this is again just putting the proper order of things is that they receive it they meet with the ihe they conduct public comment they prepare the report and then the report comes to you for for a decision towards the bottom of page eight um this is one of the the really confusing sentences that was in here it says the the part that's

[06:56:48] stricken it says concurrent with this notification to the applicant the applicable institution of higher ed will also receive a formal notification of the board's action but ihe is the applicant so i just we don't know why that language was there and that that's created um you know some confusion we just want to strike that and that's uh the same case at the top of at the top of page nine that language was repeated the public comment period here has already been taken care of by

[06:57:25] the Standing Committee, and that's why it's moved up to the front of the application process. And the Standing Committee meeting yesterday actually confirmed that they actually want to move it even earlier. They want to open up the public comment period as soon as possible to allow time for the committee to receive public comments and be due consideration for the development of their report.

[06:57:51] In the middle of the page, you see there is a within 90 days of approval of a college partnership lab school application board and the governing board of the approved school shall execute a contract. I'm leaning forward and looking at my OAG friends over there.

[06:58:09] This is the only statutory demarcation of time in the entire process. Everything else that has been created as an artificial barrier was created at some point the past that we don't know about but this piece is statutory and and comes from code so the board does have an obligation within 90 days of um of approval which page was that in this is in the middle of page nine i'm just it's not being stricken i'm just highlighting it for the board's knowledge because there's things coming down the pike and we're working with oag to get

[06:58:48] a sample contract for the board to execute but this this part is in fact statutory sliding down to bottom of page 10 this is just a clarification on some contact information as well as the top of 11 and you're going to have to go all the way down to

[06:59:22] scrolling so on page 18 these are two other barriers number four says the applicant will take all necessary actions to enter into a contract with board promptly but within 90 days because it that's it's not nine months that was i don't know where that came from we're going to

[06:59:59] follow statute and have this uh language align number five says that they have to have retained their school leadership six months prior to the opening of the day that and particularly in the climate that

we're in that's not necessarily feasible to have a signed contract with somebody six months in advance of opening a school and the feedback is that two months is more than enough.

[07:00:27] The top of the successive page is also another barrier is that all initial requests for waivers from the board will be made no later than six months prior to the opening. We don't necessarily know that there are any waivers and any waivers should be done prior and we've already precipitated in the success of parenthetical it doesn't preclude a college partnership lab school from working with the local school board to request additional waivers once the school is operational so we've in the first part of the sentence we created this barrier but in the second

[07:01:01] part we negate it by saying you can come to the board with any additional barrier waiver requests in working with your local school board in the middle of the page this these assurances just align with the earlier language so everything is in sequence um and properly aligned within the document and i believe that actually is maybe the end of the so it's mostly housekeeping um with a

[07:01:33] few uh changes that are a decade you know less old and i think that we're going to have a significant increase in satisfaction of our local school divisions I have a later update which may be a read only but I just give you a little tiny preview our first planning grant application did not come in until the middle of October and we are averaging a planning grant a week

[07:02:04] applications we have 15 planning grant applications in we have nine approved as of today and two lab school applications, and your standing committee has already met with both of the IHE applicants, and they are on their way to preparing a report on a recommendation on both of those lab school applicants, and we anticipate them being before you on your March agenda. But we would love, you know, if there's any comments, we're happy to do this. We don't want to be in the position of

[07:02:40] burdening the board on things like housekeeping items on the process document the idea is at the end this document is going to look exactly like the planning grant guidelines that you passed and like the um startup and per pupil guidelines it's going to have the same look and feel and we're going to call it guidelines so again we have common vernacular it will be the lab school application guidelines of the board you see that that was for my colleagues um you know sometimes when you take out like a 12 month thing it might seem like you're lowering a bar i would simply say from the perspective of a school division that's investigating partnerships to do some

[07:03:17] things um the 12 months is a huge problem because it doesn't fit the life cycle of a school you know in schools we have we have seasons you know we're obviously in budget development season then we'll have you know course registration and so so depending on where you what season of the school year you were in then having to wait 12 months could be even bigger so that that piece makes sense to me i haven't uh ms schultz i think you were skipping to your giving us a quick version we're not getting a written report from you on the final item at there's an indication we're

[07:03:55] getting a written report from you later but that's not right uh so the the later report was just going to be an overview of where we are on lab schools it wasn't a detail on this so the agenda lists a written report but there's no document so what we just heard from you is the verbal report in lieu thereof? Yes. Okay, so if I can just ask a question or two as to that. So 15 non-approved and two lab school applications are, and apparently, I may have missed this, I may have left, I think I did leave early for one meeting, but have we appointed a standing committee?

[07:04:28] No, we have. President Keffer. Oh, maybe that's something the president does. Okay, and who are the members of the standing committee? Okay, so Mr. Rotherham, mr hanson miss dave spot um cam moran uh tag greeson john bailey have i hit seven john and joe okay there's so there's seven numbers uh and um thank you and the two applications that you think may be coming before us as early as march those have been through the

[07:05:07] committee for they are with the committee now the committee met with the applicants in december and they have the applications and we have provided technical assistance as a department to them for a rubric for them to walk through because you have 30 those 31 statutory check marks that exist and just to aid them in their review and the development of a report that they can then produce for the full board's consideration without ask without

[07:05:41] naming it names are any of the two or public that's public oh okay good so then you can tell me are any of the two or any of the 15 institutions that involve private independent colleges and or two-year colleges oh yes d all of the above in the two and then the two are james madison university and south side virginia community college and then in the planning grants we have every compendium of four-year community college system and private, but the privates are partnering

[07:06:20] with their public school divisions. So then my last question is, do we have any greater clarity or is there, I understand there's some discussion going on over at the Capitol, but there was some questions raised before us in the fall about whether the independent colleges and the two-year colleges are eligible, whether that was the General Assembly's intent or not.

[07:06:43] And without getting into that back and forth, are we anticipating further clarity from the legislature this year on that? I do see that there's at least one piece of legislation that would explicitly exclude the public's working its way through one of the Republican House-- a Republican bill working its way through the House.

[07:07:04] You mean the privates? The privates, excuse me. Thank you. Superintendent Baylow, do you want to-- I guess I'm just trying to figure out if you've got, you don't have a private coming before us in March, but you do have a community college coming before us in March. So I guess my question is, how are we going to go forward and resolve that if the General Assembly is busy resolving the question that's in their hands, not ours, of whether those are eligible institutions?

[07:07:31] we anticipate operating under the current um guidelines until we're advised differently guidance from from the from the general assembly and the interpretation of uh of the budget that was promovated budget language okay thank you for that clarification so and every single superintendent's region is represented we have um and is the interactive map up or yeah so we We actually have an interactive map, the first iteration of it on our lab schools webpage.

[07:08:07] So anybody can go and they can see, you know, who's applied, what the nature of the school is, who they're partnering, local school divisions. And that's a freeware version. And we're working behind the scenes to have a more professional, not a more professional, but a more specific that will look exactly like the superintendent region over your heads on the back wall that's our aim but it's going to take some internal staff tableau developer work and and we wanted to get that up and get that into the hands of the public as as quickly as possible

[07:08:44] would you be able to forward the link to that what you have right now on the website it's on the um on the video lab schools website but we'll make it not yet it's it's it's uh live it will be be on the website, but we'd be happy to forward that. Thank you. Okay. Madam Chair, are there any other things that we can do to answer questions of the board? Board members, any other questions before we call for a motion to wait first review and approve the updates

[07:09:19] to the lab school application guidelines? I would just go to Ms. Holden. We did not have a quorum yesterday at the lab school committee meeting. So if you would like to serve we are certainly we are certainly in the market i'll trade you one ebtel liaison for one and a committee member to be named later is that a motion mr robin i move i move we accept the revised uh template thank you all in favor aye me opposed motion carries thank you so much for

[07:09:53] your presentation thank you moving on the item d first and final review of proposed amendments to the procedure for dismissals to comport with legislation from the 2020 general assembly on fast track he's doing that and he's working on oh i'm so sorry yes he is he's working on the tech

[07:10:24] okay um jim are you doing regs joan is doing regs as well we're right here yeah okay we're ready for

[07:10:41] it okay no that's i know i okay joan item are you doing item d dr johnson you're eating yes i call for item final review of proposed amendments to the procedure for dismissals to compare with I thought that was Jim.

[07:11:17] It is.

[07:11:28] Sorry. Okay. I wasn't quite prepared for this. What you have before you is a fast-track item. This item was a result of changes from the legislature in 2020, I believe a couple in 2021. This item is basically just cleanup.

[07:11:43] There's been a little bit of back and forth over the past couple of years regarding the procedures to dismissal, which is a process prescribed in statute. The basic issue that's been moving back and forth is whether or not the school division has the right to convene a three-member panel as an alternative to having a hearing when a teacher is going through dismissal.

[07:12:03] What we're doing in this action is we're just making the changes to the regulations in order to correspond very strictly with what the statute requires. The board is required to have regulations that enact these statutes. And so there is a lot of text being cleaned up because in the process of going through this, we realized that there were a number of points where the regulation probably just ought to match the statutory language.

[07:12:26] And so we've gone ahead and done that cleanup. If this were, had been done about a year ago, we would have tried to run this as an exempt action since we're now outside of the 90 day windows required for a statutory change. We don't, we're not able to run an exempt action. So we're proposing this as a fast track, which the standard is that the item is non-controversial since we're only asking the board to exercise we're not asking you to exercise discretion we're just according to what's already been done by the legislature we believe that this will qualify as a fast track action right thank you so much um any questions about sorry we are asking you to waive

[07:13:05] first review and just go ahead and approve this one yes thank you i want to make sure i know we're required to do it just want to make sure there aren't any questions clarifications regarding the action that we need to take to be in compliance. Hearing none, can I get a motion to wave first review and approve the proposed amendments to the procedure for dismissals to comport with the legislation from the 2020 General Assembly as presented? So moved. Thank you, Ms. Duda. Second? Second. Thank you, Ms. Holton. All in favor? Aye. Aye. Any opposed? Motion

[07:13:43] carries thank you so much thank you all right dr johnson this item is the first review of arlington county public schools our alternative route to licensure for certain endorsements pursuant to house bill 2486 of the 2019 virginia general assembly welcome johnson thank you vice president mann state superintendent bailo and board members as a quick review the commonwealth has three key pathways to licensure becoming or becoming a teacher the approved teacher preparation program

[07:14:17] which we consider typically traditional the reciprocity as well and finally the alternate routes and specifically regarding alternate routes the board of education's licensure regulations for school personnel provide for multiple alternate routes to licensure and highlighted in the item are career switcher alternate routes for career professionals provisional licensure route for for individuals employed by a Virginia educational agency, provisional alternate routes to a technical professional license, alternate route for special ed, alternate route, or excuse me, alternate programs for institutions of higher ed and experiential learning.

[07:14:57] And in response and a means to address the teacher shortage, another pathway for individuals to access licensure was established in 2019 with House Bill 2486. And on November the 14th, the Virginia Board of Education approved guidelines alternate routes licensure in response to this bill highlighting specifically or outlining that was to establish of a process to permit school board or any organization sponsored by a school board to petition the board for approval of an alternate route to licensure that may be

[07:15:31] used to meet the requirements for a provisional or renewal license or any endorsement any such alternate route may include alternate route to the regulatory requirements for teacher preparation including alternate professional assessments and coursework the petitioner may proffer or the board may impose conditions in conjunction with the approval of such petition the guidelines became effective on january 23 of 20 after consultation with the office of the attorney general and minor technical revisions to the guidelines who were approved in order to align

[07:16:07] the document with legal advice and preserve the board's final authority in deciding to approve the alternate routes to licensure. The revised guidelines became effective in December 22. Ultimately, we know the purpose of this alternate route to licensure is to ensure local school divisions have an opportunity to meet their unique needs in recruiting and retaining educators for their school communities. While each division may be different, the Board of Education determines the requirements for teacher licensure so that teachers across the

[07:16:43] commonwealth are adequately prepared to meet the needs of students in every classroom as we look at outcomes of this and the impact this legislation allows for a different route to teacher preparation but maintains the nuances of the same type of license and endorsement in accordance with the guidelines school divisions are applying for approved to offer an alternate route to licensure for educator candidates to satisfy requirements or competencies of the traditional approved teacher

preparation program provided by institutions of higher ed. Candidates who complete the school division's board-approved alternate route under this guideline will be

[07:17:23] issued a current Virginia educator license with the same type of endorsement as other candidates who have completed an approved program preparation or other approved alternate route to licensure. In today's item, Arlington County Public Schools, or reference ACPS, submitted an application for an alternate route to license for their division in 21. ACPS has housed a public Montessori program for 50 years. The program provides Montessori instruction for students from pre-k through

[07:17:58] eighth grade. Also relevant for our discussion, primary Montessori classes are held at seven Arlington County public school elementary schools and middle school Montessori program is housed at gunston middle school acps is seeking an alternate route to virginia professional educator licensure for montessori licensed teachers in elementary primary elementary education and middle school education acps is committed to submitting annual reports as requested by the department of

[07:18:32] education the approved period for this alternate route to licensure will end if the school board discontinues its support. Per the guidelines, the Virginia Department of Education formed a volunteer panel of educational leaders to review ACPS's applications. You'll reference and see that in Appendix or Attachment A. And I've asked our Director of Licensure and School Leadership, Maggie Clemons, to provide the details from that panel's procedures and recommendations

[07:19:01] to the board today. Good afternoon, board members, Ms. Baylow. My name is Maggie Clemons. I'm the director of the office of licensure and school leadership as joan had said our office was tasked with receiving the application from arlington county public schools and then also going through the process that was identified in the guidelines that you approved that were effective in january

[07:19:32] so a panel was a panel was collected of volunteers i want to assert that they are volunteers of educational leaders in Virginia and they are tasked with basically going through the application and we took this process from a current process that we have and that's the same process that we use for certified career switcher programs that certified career switcher programs are five to be a career switcher program you have to go through the this same process of review

[07:20:07] approval and recertification they also do the annual report so we did not recreate the wheel here we used a process that was already in place by gathering the committee the committee reviewed the documents the committee did have some back and forth and asked for additional information as indicated in the board document and specifically the committee was concerned with meeting the content requirements for the elementary and middle school endorsements if you're familiar with virginia licensure which i know is it can be convoluted and complicated

[07:20:42] things like our elementary endorsement does not allow for someone to simply take an assessment and then they can receive the endorsement they do have to take a combination of an assessment coursework and of course the professional studies and the the experience and so the application contained that they submitted contained the prescribed sections that they needed but specifically the section on content um we asked for additional information um acps and their partners with montessori did provide additional information regarding methods um but the the panel

[07:21:17] did um continue to have some heartburn over the content and so while the proposal that you have in attachment a which i know was long i think i get the award or they get the award for the longest

attachment of any board item in history. It does specifically, their proposal is different than the panel's recommendation. And so I did want to make sure that everybody was aware of that.

[07:21:43] The panel's recommendation was, again, similar to what the original proposal was, bachelor's degree, holding that nationally recognized Montessori credential. And they do have three nationally recognized organizations that we found to be acceptable. And then also pass that content praxis tests. So those are the elementary multi-subject tests, but also the middle school tests as well. And then have completed the statutory requirements, in which case they would receive a provisional license. The provisional license would be valid for a period

[07:22:20] of three years and in which time those candidates and that cohort would then satisfy the coursework that the panel recommends that the candidates complete on top of the Montessori credential.

[07:22:35] Those are on page five of the board item, I believe. They're the methods in teaching elementary math, methods in teaching elementary science, methods in teaching elementary history and social studies, and then also a reading and writing um course um and then of course the one year of supervised classroom experience and if they had not taken the vcla and the reading test they would need to do that as well those two could be um the vcla and the praxis reading would not have to be done in order for them to get the provisional it's the praxis elementary subsets or the praxis middle school tests that they would need to complete to get the provisional license i'm sorry which page

[07:23:11] did you say it wasn't mine is five but that might be different on your board item because i've written notes on the board item itself sorry thank you so while the um the panel did um want to express that you know we acknowledge the hard work that goes into getting that montessori credential um the panel really thought that the credential spoke more towards um the professional studies

[07:23:48] aspect of um our virginia competencies um and didn't hit as much on the content of the endorsements as they thought that we needed to and it was missing some of those competencies and so that's why they suggested adding on those additional coursework um and that's why the proposal from arlington is different than the panel's recommendation um but we did want to acknowledge that work that went into getting that montessori credential and so this still offers a pathway again the guidelines and the panel operate under that at the end of the day anybody that goes through this cohort and finishes is going to get a virginia license with one of our endorsements

[07:24:27] and so that license and that endorsement would be able to go to any division in the state or outside the state but this route would be specific to arlington yes sir quick question um is what arlington is requesting similar at the bottom of page five where you say that there's 11 states that offer the alternative routes and i think the next line says of these 10 states i assume it's of the 11 seven have additional requirements yes it's what the panel's recommendation closer to the seven states and it's what arlington is recommending closer to the four states

[07:25:00] so there's only one state that is it um that is currently doing what the panel has offered which is the provisional license first they complete the rest of the coursework then they get a renewable license from that state that's just like everybody else's the other states are all requesting for them to do at least um actually there's all there's two states where it's just the straight straight reciprocity with that montessori license the rest of the states do have added coursework just not as much so like connecticut asks for a sped course in six um semester hours of reading and three in math so kind of a mixture of that with those other seven

[07:25:39] states and the two states that have just pretty much the blanket reciprocity or which states uh hawaii and um maryland i think no sorry sorry indiana and montana i was watched i guess wrap up with the superintendent's recommendation and then glad to try to answer any questions um as i yes we're also going to have dev love just clarify one thing that came up yesterday so we thought it would be good to have that also kind of before us as we get ready to consider this

[07:26:19] since it is first review so would you like me to wait or it doesn't matter whatever the protocol is well do you want this for jim and i'll be for discussion yes okay sure okay go for it the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education receive for first review the recommendations of the department's panel to approve arlington county public schools alternate route to licensure for certain endorsements pursuant to house bill 2486 as

[07:26:52] presented glad to answer any questions and hear from deb love i think so what exactly is the question good afternoon as i understood the conversation yesterday i'm just going to jump in you tell me if this is what you're looking to hear about from me there was a question about whether um there could be a restricted license at the end of this in some particular fashion

[07:27:25] i think that this alternate routes legislation and your regulations on the subject really provide i mean there's one goal right this license and they're approved pathways but this this mechanism grounded in statute authorizes another route to get to that place in issuing a restricted license we're now sort of moving the place right those are kind of distinct matters to be considered by the board so what's before you is an alternate route to licensure if the board would want to establish

[07:28:01] a program of restricted licenses you don't have that now we certainly could the staff could not we they could look into that and i would think that that would be by regulation um and then it would be available to anybody who wanted to does that address the the issues that you want to hear for me on. Yes. So, Madam President. Yes, please. So, I guess my thought process was something along the lines of, and this, I guess, would fit that restricted license would be to permit a public

[07:28:38] Montessori-only license like several other states do, whereby an applicant would, you know, take the praxis. And then it would be basically reciprocity granted through that AMS, AI, et cetera, for them to only have a license that's applicable in a public Montessori classroom. That would be restricted, correct? I would use your explanation regarding a new, having a new license created to restrict. So that would be a new license pathway of restriction. Okay. I guess I would just probably

[07:29:15] highlight as you consider after the first review i guess as we've begun to discuss this i think i can explain probably there are three options that would be helpful to the board to contemplate one is to accept the superintendent's recommendation as is meaning you're accepting all the conditions that came from the panel second would be that the board change those conditions or modify i guess the third and maybe i thought of another now is a one for one pretty much exactly what their proposal is requesting and the fourth would be to deny and say no for me as you contemplate i think

[07:29:52] those four options would help you through the process and and just to be clear today's first review and discussion about this sorry i just need to understand what is the superintendent's recommendation so the superintendent is part of the items that the board of education receive for first review the recommendations of the department's panel to approve arlington county's public school alternate route to licensure meaning the recommendation that has the conditions for classes with the four that's correct semester hours that's the panels and the

[07:30:28] state superintendent's recommendation arlington is good with that um i'm sorry again i'm representing the panel's work pretty much um at this time i believe what we heard from the arlington speakers this morning was that they were asking instead of our approving uh instead of they're not asking us to act beyond first review today but when we ultimately act they're asking that instead of accepting the panel's recommendation that we accept their application as is with a limitation

[07:31:06] to montessori only schools and that's what i understood from the uh that's what i understood from the speakers this morning i'm not saying that's the right answer but that's what i understood them to be asking for and maybe that's something you could clarify for us for next time or if they're here i don't know if they stayed through this weary long day if i can just jump jump into it i mean i think first i want to commend the panel and uh arlington and the montessori leadership

[07:31:42] for their hard work on this i mean this is all in the spirit of local autonomy and parent choice that that there's a lot of energy towards certainly among folks on the board and so i'll commend everybody's hard work on it so i would be supportive of moving forward in concept i i understand that one alternative to get to where arlington really wants us to be of essentially one for one, would be what Ms. Johnson, what I heard Dr. Johnson and Ms. Love

[07:32:20] proposing of we could create a new licensing opportunity. But that is, from my experience, a months or years long new process. That's not something we can do this week or next week. And they've been working on this for months or years already, I believe. So I'd hate, that may be something we want to do at some point, but I'd hate to leave everything to that. So I would like to ask you to and Ms. Love to put your creative minds together, and I know lawyers can be very

[07:32:53] creative and figure out whether there is a way without a whole new licensing thing to do what I heard Ms. Creasy suggesting, which is the language says we can impose a condition in conjunction with the approval of such petitions. So the condition might be, I don't know if you call it creating a new endorsement or what, but something that would give these teachers a license to teach in a Montessori school. And that license, they don't have to take the extra four courses or maybe some of the extra four courses. I don't know whether what the board's will would be on that,

[07:33:28] but something less than four new courses, but that would enable them to teach solely in a Montessori school so if you all could put your heads together and come back to us next time with your any options we might want to consider along that lines i think it'd be very helpful other questions i just find this one very confusing i'm not sure what i think what miss olden said makes a lot of sense what's the level of urgency in terms of timeline for us to figure this out what's like

[07:34:03] in terms of either teachers are coming in needs how much time do we have to figure these questions out i thought what i heard from one of the speakers or two of them this morning is they do have a waiting list and would maybe want to open up a second school i'm not arlingtonian anymore so i don't know but i thought that was they've been working on the proposal um for over a year now um and their biggest concern is the recruiting they feel like they're losing teachers um montessori credentialed teachers uh to the public school um or to the other private schools um the biggest um push here is that the teachers that are montessori licensed are are creating dings

[07:34:42] on their data reports here at doe because the teacher is not properly licensed and endorsed and so while they're teaching at a montessori school and so it's a data reporting issue as well so it's you know recruiting get those folks in we don't want to lose those teachers but also the end of the day it's a it's a

reporting issue now this year is for arlington because are the only one um this year's report's already done um in the next collections in october of 23. thank you both and i do think to miss holton's conversation we ought to be looking to provide i think the maximum flexibility for arlington but i'd love to learn more as well and i'm a little

[07:35:19] confused yeah that's my instinct is obvious maximum flexibility could you say more about the precedent and sort of things we should be considering and thinking about as a as a board with that the language open it says any organization so that's one thing that will open the doors for profit organizations external organizations again that's what the legislation says some of the things that we've heard as we talk to stakeholders and even the panel's considerations

[07:35:56] is that once we start to reflect or create unique licenses that again creates an opportunity for future unique licenses and how many unique licenses does the state of Virginia want to manage and offer and in terms of the this issue of we can attach conditions can we attach quality assurance conditions and can they vary by route or they have to be the same quality assurance across all of these okay they can vary based on the on the division um i would also add um kind of to your point here um back in 2013 um we did eliminate the local eligibility license which was

[07:36:33] kind of similar to this we had the local divisions that would basically say we've determined that this person is highly qualified please give them a license type of thing and so to your your question of opening this up are we are we opening this up to divisions to determine you know what organizations they want to partner with to to give a license specifically to their people for certain things and so i just want to go back to that fact that we did eliminate that in 2013. and just for a little more context we've had lots and lots of conversations and i think this is confusing because it is it's it's a pretty massive issue um it's wonderful to think about the the concept of a new

[07:37:09] onboarding pathway for high quality teachers but it is um it's it's also uh overwhelming and and big to think about uh how do we set a precedent when we're talking about montessori schools today but we may be talking about a different application organization philosophy next month and the month after and the month after.

[07:37:33] So I think it's important to note that this board always has the opportunity to customize what those additional, if any, conditions would look like. And, you know, as we think about these are public schools, we want we want maximum flexibility.

[07:37:49] We want great teachers in the classroom. We want innovation in our public schools. but we also need assurances that things like the Virginia Literacy Act will be implemented with fidelity and that a program would not eclipse something like that. And I'm not saying Montessori conflicts with that, but we just need the opportunity to, first of all, analyze and examine that and then present it to you for just some additional discussion and input.

[07:38:21] But going back to precedent setting, we have a lot to implement, but we always have the opportunity to customize based on the applications that we receive and that you have before you.

[07:38:38] And we will always do our job to analyze and examine and bring forward, you know, viable options that are based on what other states are doing, what our CTE alternate route to licensure looks like and how, you know, we'll do the comparing and contrasting and put forward customized options.

[07:38:57] But it is always up to this board to ask tough questions of all of us and to re-customize that if it is not acceptable or to, as Ms. Holton said today, let's go back. This is first review and let's come back to you with more options.

[07:39:13] This might be the one that you ultimately take, but we want more information on the table versus less. Can I just maybe along those lines, it would just be helpful, I think, to the point on the bottom of page five with the 11 states. It's just, I don't want to give a big homework assignment, but just maybe identify the 11 states and, okay.

[07:39:34] I would like to know what best practices are, but also maybe what the magnitude. I have a nice infographic that I can share with the board. Does it also show a little bit about the magnitude is for the public Montessori's and these other states? If I may, those conversations prompted two additional questions.

[07:39:52] One is I'm starting with the premise that Montessori training itself is pretty rigorous and well regarded, but I don't actually have any expertise in that area. In your professional opinions, is that accurate?

[07:40:09] I mean, Montessori is a pretty rigorous training program and pretty well regarded generally in the education world, or is that asking too broadly for you to opine on? I'm not comfortable making that. And I was, I was high school, so, you know.

[07:40:27] So not in your expertise either. Okay, well, maybe that's something we'd like to hear from the Arlington folks next month, if possible. And maybe we can build in just a few minutes next meeting to hear from them directly. And we did hear some of it from the speakers this morning, but I would, that would be helpful for us to understand a little background.

[07:40:47] And maybe there's even something you can, you can get, again, I don't want to ask you to do a lot of homework. But I'm starting with the premise that it's a pretty rigorous program in its own right. It could be two to three years to get a Montessori license. Two to three years of old-time courses.

[07:41:05] Of course, they're doing a teaching program within a university that provides specific... Pretty close to comparable to, okay. So that's first the question. And then the second question, and maybe I don't need you to do homework based on that. Just by sheer content, quantity, it's pretty comparable.

[07:41:22] My next question in this, you all can address next month rather than now if it's easier, but hearing the superintendent's concerns, I'm assuming that Montessori schools in Arlington or anywhere else, well, I know. They have to teach our SOLs.

[07:41:38] They have to comply with the Virginia Literacy Act content of curriculum around literacy once it's implemented. They have to comply with any mandated professional development that comes through that, right? So are there, do you anticipate any problems implementing the Literacy Act provisions in Arlington's Montessori schools?

[07:42:02] And if so, is there anything about this licensure decision that impacts that or can help solve those problems? So, again, that may not be. That was part of the panel's discussion, really was part of the content was that they were, they had some heartburn over whether or not Montessori credentials.

[07:42:23] because in the application, sorry to my readers, Montessori teachers are prepared specifically to teach in Montessori environments and their coursework focuses on Montessori philosophy, history, and

pedagogy. Montessori teachers are not instructed on state or local assessments.

[07:42:38] And so those broad statements in their application that they put forth was something that the board or the panel had really considered and really felt that on top of the praxis, they took these four courses that they've identified that those teachers would be more aligned with the competencies of the traditional programs to your first point miss holton i'd like just like to add that my children when they were very little they went to montessori schools my older one went to montessori till second grade and then went on to public schools both of them

[07:43:14] went on to public schools and um i would say that i i thought that was absolutely fantastic uh experience for both of my children my younger one it increased his appetite for numbers maps mathematical intuition um when my older child went on to third grade in public school i i felt and we felt that she was just i think she was like a grade level ahead so we i've we've had first-hand

[07:43:52] experience i and this was private of course we don't have public in fairfax county uh so that was great just to your first point very helpful thank you and i also think they did a good job just talking about the results of yours you know the outcomes the student outcomes they really did drive home in the public comment period it doesn't sort of remove the the issue that we have to discuss around precedence and all of what that encompasses but for certain um i think in their public comment they really spoke to the impact of their approach for the students that they serve and

[07:44:31] i too have had children a son experience that approach in the early years and i found it fascinating um for sure in terms of how they go about doing what they do and the engagement that young very young children seem to demonstrate through the practices that they emphasize so and the panel the panel recognizes that as well they were operating and making their recommendation based on the fact that the guidelines suggest that they don't have the authority as the board does to create restrictions and new licenses and that type of thing they were

[07:45:07] operating under the ultra the alternate route to licensure is going to be the end stop for everybody you know here's the here's the route but this is the end stop and so it doesn't matter how you get there as long as you hit all the points and then you've gotten it so um you know their their recommendation i mean they they were very impressed with the program a couple of the panel members also had children that went through the program um it was just how the guidelines are written and what their allowable recommendations could be but they will have a virginia license for any school unless will you all figure out how we can put conditions on it as the

[07:45:44] statute seems to imply we can or quality assurance like mr rotterham suggested all right well if there are not other questions we'll look forward to seeing you at the next meeting when this comes back for final review given the complexity of it dr baylor should we think about also like the work session was a little truncated yesterday we may want a little time i don't think we want to make arlington come down for two days but this seems sufficiently complicated we want to discuss it a little bit more yeah it it makes

[07:46:18] sense that and i'm not sure if speaking of precedent if if this has happened but it would make sense to have them here during the work session to talk about the articulation um from training to to coursework um would that either work session or when the item comes up i don't I think asking two days is that, and just also just time. I think, I don't know, I may be the only one. It seems like there's a lot of questions.

[07:46:46] There's plenty of precedent for having a division that's particularly impacted by an item be here. But for work session? Well, we could do it either at work session or at the business item. I think we've done it. I don't have rejection to doing it either way, but we ought to be able to hear from them.

[07:47:06] I agree I'll figure out the best way okay all right thank you sure they're not hearing that they need to be here for two days that's and they don't have to go through the public comment section yeah make sure they come for that but they may want to I did think maybe we want to consider a rule that everybody who speaks at public comment is required to stay with us until full adjournment at the end of the day it takes four it takes four hours of comments to shake miss holton's commitment to civil liberties well that's an action that's actually an interesting

[07:47:43] segue because um i do note that we have someone here from public comment who perhaps may have imagined that we were going to be speaking about first review of the proposed history and social studies standards um and of course that item was addressed right after public comment so i just want to make sure that we're not skipping that item, but that item was moved up in the agenda.

[07:48:08] I watched it on video. Very good. Awesome. Okay. Then that just takes us down to a couple of written reports. And Superintendent Bailo had asked two teams to come and just really very briefly share timelines associated with the English standards of revision and the science standards of revision so madam president if i may um this would typically be accepted as a written report um but because this is one of the or these two topics uh or content areas english language

[07:48:45] arts and science are really the first beginning to end with um five of the new board members i asked both teams to do a five minute max presentation of course if you have additional questions that's great but this is strictly for information only to understand um a little bit more about the process and to engage the board um just early in the process i can't get the document i don't know whether my colleagues can or not maybe i screwed up something i was able to this

[07:49:17] time and we're able to keep going go ahead okay fantastic well i'm sorry can i suggest on there's been some on sharepoint on some of these the attachment is the item on some of these the title is the item this seems like one that you click on the title i'm getting it on the title i am not getting it if i click the attachment yeah the attachment is not accessible the title and there's been not a bunch of them but that means i'm getting the agenda item but i'm not getting the attachment or maybe the attachments with the i think it is okay thank you i'll accept

[07:49:49] all right good afternoon vice president man members of the board and superintendent baylow it is my pleasure to bring before you today the proposed timeline for the revision of the 2017 english standards of learning as you are undoubtedly aware uh it is the board's comprehensive plan and the code of virginia that require the review of virginia standards of

[07:50:23] learning every seven years the current english standards of learning were revised and adopted in 2017 to stay on schedule it's time to open the current english standards of learning for review and revision as you can see from this slide the virginia literacy act is a comprehensive approach that brings students families teachers reading specialists leaders and school divisions together to support early literacy development for all students the virginia literacy act provides a

[07:50:57] lens to support the revisions of the standards in such a way that the connection between the skills in the standards and evidence-based literacy instruction and science-based reading research as

defined by the code are explicit for teachers and students. The English standards of learning encompass all courses in kindergarten through grade 12. The current standards are organized in four related strands, communication and multimodal literacies, reading, writing, and research. These strands allow for a comprehensive approach to the teaching and learning of literacy.

[07:51:36] While the strands are developed separately, they are expected to be seamlessly integrated in the classroom. Standards that incorporate rigor in English help students develop the expected classroom competencies. Proficiency in reading, writing, communication, and research skills allow students to learn and use knowledge to make meaningful connections between their lives and the academic disciplines.

[07:52:02] Through the rigorous application of the English Standards of Learning, students become critical thinkers, effective contributors, and global citizens. As described in the proposed timeline for the revision of the 2017 English Standards of Learning, there are several key features I would like to highlight for you today.

[07:52:23] There will be many ongoing opportunities for stakeholders to provide feedback on the current Standards of Learning and to inform the review and revisions moving forward. If the proposed timeline is accepted, we will begin collecting public comment and feedback on the current standards as early as tomorrow.

[07:52:44] We will have a dedicated webpage for the collection of this feedback. Additionally, we will host community engagement sessions across the Commonwealth and virtually to hear from parents, teachers, community members, and business leaders regarding their feedback on the current standards and visions for the future.

[07:53:03] There will be ongoing stakeholder input throughout the revision process where we will seek out and engage with institutes of higher education, parents, business leaders, industry representatives, military personnel, professional organizations, and literacy leaders so that they might inform the revision process.

[07:53:22] We will have several key partners that will guide the work of the Standards Revision Committee. We will have an English Education Advisory Board comprised of parent representation, relevant business and industry, military representatives, higher education staff at both the community college level and four-year institutes, school division leadership, classroom teachers, and the VDOE English content team.

[07:53:48] This group will provide ongoing one-on-one and full panel feedback to the revision team leaders, including practical perspectives on the standards and recommended revisions. Another key partner in the work will be the Virginia Literacy Act workgroup, representative of the stakeholders listed on slide three and inclusive of before and after school care providers and community organizations.

[07:54:14] An English standards revision steering committee comprised of English language arts teachers, English curriculum specialists, reading specialists, and VDOE content staff will work in conjunction with these groups to guide the revision writers on the vision for creating best-in-class standards that will support K-12 literacy development in Virginia.

[07:54:36] Lastly, we will have a team of writers who will work closely with the steering committee and the VDOE English content team to revise the standards based on priorities established through the process which will lead to successful literacy development and rigorous standards for all students as you are aware

the review and revision of standards curriculum frameworks and instructional materials is a multi-year process this slide outlines for you the major events in the proposed revision timeline and when we might anticipate each component is completed

[07:55:10] if the proposed timeline is accepted upon acceptance the department of education will provide information to the public according to the timeline it is anticipated that the revised english standards will be brought to you for first review in november of 2023 if the projected timeline stays on schedule we anticipate that it's possible to bring the revised standards to the board for final review and adoption in january of 2024. the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education accept the report on the timeline for the review and

[07:55:48] approval of the english standards of learning under five minutes perfect great do you go back to that last slide please ma'am so here the crosswalk would be done after the adoption yes ma'am so that is the time frame where it's the crosswalk year between the 2017 and the 2024 where teachers are given the new standards and they're kind of shifting their instruction to align with the new standards but the assessments remain on the old standards so it gives teachers and educators

[07:56:27] and parents and communities time to prepare before we switch over into implementing the new standards and during that crosswalk year that is also when we provide the crosswalk document to show teachers where things have shifted and moved we use that time to create instructional resources to support teachers who need to utilize the new standards and we go through that textbook review process so that new textbooks align with the new standards so 2024 school year starting 2024

[07:57:00] it'll be adopting the standards of learning but so we would um if everything stays on schedule we would adopt the standards in january of 2024 and then the curriculum we would use that 2024 year to create the curriculum frame 2025 school year so we would yep so in 2025 january-ish somewhere in there that is when the curriculum framework would potentially be adopted by the board and then we would use the 25-26 school year as that year for educators to kind of

[07:57:38] look at the new material and learn the new material and prepare for the full implementation so the full implementation will not happen until 2026? Correct. They would not be teaching it in 2025? They would be teaching it, but the assessment would be aligned with the 2017 standards.

[07:57:58] So this gives some time for the teachers to transition, and it gives time for assessment writers to create new assessment items that align with the new standards. Thank you. Yeah. Thank you.

[07:58:16] Thank you. Welcome.

[07:58:38] Last item. good afternoon vice president man superintendent baylor and members of the board of education so in the working of revising standards which you've had many conversations about you are quite aware that the code does require us each seven years to revise standards a phrase used this morning was that the entire process follows guide posts and there are guide posts of presenting standards for first review presenting standards for final review that come way in the future today we are not

[07:59:14] talking about we're not presenting science standards for you what we are hoping to do today is to lay out a framework that will give all of those guide posts for the science standards revisions over the next two years the reason for us bringing this to you today is in 2018 the Board of Education approved the 2018 Science Standards of Learning. So, paying attention to the previous item, we appear to be a year

ahead of where we should be, and there is a very clear and simple reason for that. There are 13 sets of standards that were approved by the Board in

[07:59:52] 2018, and those standards do take us up to a particular point in the high school. However, there are courses in the high school that are board approved for high school graduation however there are no curriculum frameworks that have been approved by the board for use in schools we will share some of those with you today so what we are hoping to do is to take our existing 13 sets of standards and to add an extra 11 sets of standards taking it such that when the science standards of

[08:00:26] learning abroad for final review in 2025 there will be 24 sets of standards for you to review which is why we are bringing it to you today as a two-year process as opposed to a one-year process dr peterson in a moment will be able to lay out some of the details about how that will be broken up in year one and year two we'll share with you that we are following guidance and leadership's preference. In order to reach out to stakeholders to review existing standards and existing documents, those stakeholder groups will be parent groups, industry, higher education, as well as

[08:01:04] current K-12 educators from the classroom all the way through administration. At this point, I will hand over to Dr. Peterson, and I believe she has a presentation. Well, first of all, I'd like to thank my colleague jill for laying out exactly what is expected with the standards of learning process i will say that i have worked collaboratively with both jill and keisha tennessee who will be presenting the standards next month for computer science the timeline to ensure that we have consistency for you all for members of the um educators across the state for stakeholders so

[08:01:43] So we wanna make sure that it is a consistent process. So as Dr. Alban said, the proposed timeline is extended this first year coming up, or currently in process. We're working on developing standards and curriculum framework for those 11 courses that currently in place.

[08:02:03] In 2024, then we would start the formal revision process of the 2018 standards. We would have anticipated adoption in late, in december uh 2025 with the crosswalk year the crosswalk year is when again they would be teaching the 2025 standards but being tested on the 2018 standards which gives teachers time to look at the 2025 standards figure out ways to adjust their instruction and also our assessment

[08:02:36] people to develop questions that can be pilot tested before full implementation in 2027 and 2028 so a little bit more on what exactly do i mean about those 11 courses so if you look at the board approved document there are 33 board approved courses for science and i think we we win the lottery on that one and there are quite a few some of those already have standards affiliated with them because they're from the ap courses ib international baccalaureate courses and such so they do not need standards however 11 of these advanced level courses do not have

[08:03:14] anything with them back in 1983 when the standards were made for science it was decided that the level 2 biology 2 earth science 2 physics 2 and chemistry 2 courses would not have standards nor would they have curriculum framework and this decision was made to allow divisions flexibility in how they chose to pursue those different coursework and be able to make it malleable to adjust to their community needs what the needs of the students and aspirations were with the students we know that times have changed we have a lot of provisionally certified teachers we have a lot of

[08:03:51] new teachers and we have teachers that may have taught one area of biology maybe or science for many years but now are being asked to teach a different lens of earth science or biology and may not have any support structures in place particularly in those rural divisions that don't have dedicated instructional people to be able to create such documents our goal is to have documents in place for those teachers we did we didn't we had a bit of a transition with our last standards and we didn't want to throw 11 new sets of standards at the same

[08:04:26] time so we decided to have a soft transition into the process and we created content guidelines and those content guidelines were created with stakeholders with businesses with higher ed input and they were in place so that there would be some guidance to those teachers so that they knew what was moving forward but it also gave them a few years to feel it out teach it make recommendations and have input those courses that are listed on this slide are those 11 courses that we are going to be building those structures for and have been building those structures for i want to clarify

[08:05:05] when i say biology 2 anatomy and physiology biology 2 ecology when you take a biology one course for instance it is a survey of all different topics we have a wonderful standard on viruses and bacteria we have a standard on genetics a standard on macromolecules my personal favorite um one on ecology and students get to dabble just like they do in a first level college course in the different areas of biology and from there they find they may have an affinity for one area they may be interested in one area they may have career aspirations and want to learn more

[08:05:40] so these level two courses provide that deeper dive into specific content areas so in developing these courses first of all we relied on the school courses for the exchange database what is that well about four years ago virginia transitioned to using something called sked codes and those sked codes are a numerical system that any if it appears on a transcript any college can identify oh they've had this course and these are the expectations of this course i'm going to wrap

[08:06:17] it up um so we wanted to make sure that they aligned to the sked course description and we also wanted to make sure that the students in taswell as well as the students in arlington as well as the students in hampton had similar content expectations and similar ways to for students to show mastery of that content jill was very did very nice job of going through the process that regular standards process are going to address those courses that we have standards in place and we're going to follow all those different uh things that jill indicated in her

[08:06:53] presentation we also have the structure of the curriculum framework and you are lucky uh superintendent baylow that you said to wrap it up because i could probably talk about this for hours um but i this is the structure we have this was a shift we really tried to create a structure that would be a tool for teachers you know what what came on before my class what is it going on afterwards in terms of what concepts are they coming in with what am i preparing them for what are the central ideas you notice there's leafs in our document and that is to show the embedding of

[08:07:29] the scientific and engineering practices for your information in the notes section of this power point if you able to download it it's attachment it's the attachment affiliated with it go ahead and download it and you could look at the notes section and there are all the details you need and i am more than happy to talk to anybody about our curriculum framework do you have any questions yes i do so i i do see attachments but i don't see these slides on the sharepoint i saw um just

[08:08:03] document uh microsoft word documents but it wasn't at first but it got fixed yeah it's up there now It wasn't there and now it is. Okay. I think it's been there.

[08:08:20] There's some wonky things going on today. We switched from a couple questions. So the 11 courses that you mentioned, the biology 2s and the earth sciences 2s, Do you, are the current curriculum, is that available somewhere that I could see?

[08:08:46] I would be very interested to see. Sure, I will share it with anybody that wants it. Realize it is in draft form and it was developed with the intent. If we pull together a committee with nothing, it is very difficult to start from ground zero. These are being taught currently.

[08:09:04] Not the ones that I have because there's nothing out there right now in theory. there are content guidelines yes but there is no curriculum existing we do have draft documents that we are creating or have been created thus far to go to committees so that they can use that as a way to provide comment sorry i think i don't think i'm uh making myself uh here in in local school divisions these are being taught yes by local locally created curriculum if the division

[08:09:36] has it yes okay so yeah i'd be very interested to to see if if in however from just for me to get a handle secondly i i don't think i've ever heard of this sked you said which indicates mastery of content no so each course that we have in virginia is tied to a certain code and that code is based on a national database and that national database is used by color or schools k-12 schools across this nation as well as colleges so i was one that i was in many different

[08:10:16] states growing up when my report card of my transcript traveled to the new school that sked code would say she was in this course and that course has a description so the the school knew what were the what was the content entailed in that we transitioned to that system approximately four years ago we used our own coding system before that but now we went to this nationally norm system which makes sense as kids decide to go out of state or wherever to college it provides that general description so that general description is we we need to follow that and make sure that's

[08:10:50] in place because if a kid goes to virginia tech or penn state or even just to school in delaware there is a certain level of expectation of the content that student is going to be exposed to in that course with that assigned code so if it's an honors course it's a different code no so that is a good question the code is tied to content so um for example biology is 3101 that means that that general concepts are taught there division decides then are we going to call this

[08:11:25] are we going to differentiate this to be honors if the um they go to a university or dual enrollment they will use the same code but there is an alternate column which allows the division to say this is honors this is um dual enrollment this is you know whatever level of distinction but it's tied to content versus rigor level with the exception ap courses have their own code and ib courses have their own code okay so content not rigor and if it's an honors there would be an

[08:11:59] extra h n or if it's dual then right a different designation and and when the university gets it let's say your child applies to a university it will have the sked code it will have the title of the course so the division has latitude to call it honors biology or honors um and that bio to anatomy and physiology so that you have a combination of both but there is a drop down descriptor and and so combining our previous presentation from your language arts colleagues And now there's the coincide, there's the rollout of the website and everything is posted and those kinds of things.

[08:12:38] And so having since we've been doing some learning by doing and some of it has been uncomfortable, let's just make sure that we plan to keep track of who participates and where they're from and what they do. And let's let's let's build that on the front end. So whatever transitions happen at any point in time, there's a constant thread for that person. Thank you.

[08:13:03] have another question so if it's an honors course that honors designation is required on a transcript this that is a local decision of how that looks so when they send up their coursework to us they are signing just that sked code and they could have a virginia descriptor but how that division wants to reflect that in their own databases and then it reflects in their transcripts is up to that division so if a division decides that it will sorry is it bouncing off its rigor course

[08:13:40] again uh against the state is it letting you know what the rigor is and no okay so it decides what is honors and it'll then put it uniformly across all the transcripts in that local school division yes so each division decides you know some divisions we're going to elevate the rigor we're going to have additional expectations um others say you know there's the whole talk is making an honor course do you give more work or differentiated work so how they approach that some majors say you're going to do an extra paper it is up to the divisions to make that decision

[08:14:19] but everybody regardless of whether you're a dual enrollment program an honors program you have to have that basis of information that you can build up as high as you want but that basis is the same and that because of that basis it's tied to that specific skin code thank you in your experience have you ever seen anything where in a local school division some some schools um even though they are honors course courses do not put the honors designation no i think i've seen more of the opposite so they'll just call everybody oh you're you're in

[08:14:58] ninth grade biology we'll just call you all honors um but no i have not observed that but my experience is limited to gloucester virginia so i'm not sure i have the the wealth of experience my colleagues do in terms of um what other divisions do okay thank you gloucester is a nice place though yes miss holton i i just want to commend you all for your really really uh hard work past and future and for taking this on the way you are and i just want to comment that it's my understanding and you know maybe somebody can educate me to the contrary but very few states

[08:15:35] even attempt to have the kind of rigorous standards that virginia has frankly on any topic beyond literacy and numeracy and the fact that we have set forward so many detailed standards in the sciences in history and civics in um computer science in in in topics across the board so as to enable our teachers to be so as to support our teachers in presenting great content to students is really extraordinary but just hearing you talk about this makes us realize just how much work there is behind the scenes going on to make that happen and i just thank you

[08:16:15] and your colleagues who were talking about english before and and i mean the content work going on here at the department and that has gone on here at the department and with all your stakeholders over the years on these many topics is really stand out in the nation thank you thank you thank you all set thank you do you want to do that so just as a point of order the superintendent of public instruction recommends that the board of education receive this written report so moved thank you so much thank you thank you so much thank you the horses can spell the barn sorry

[08:16:51] well that actually does take us right down to discussion of current events by the superintendent i don't know if uh miss baylor you have anything i feel i have participated fully and have uh nothing more

to add at this time but certainly invite colleagues to participate as well i have a quick one i'm hoping as much fun as it would be to have a fulsome discussion of current uh issues i'm hoping i just have a real quick one i think we should codify what we did yesterday just um talking about accountability um so i'd like to make a motion that we just uh um affirm the work

[08:17:27] yesterday and uh accept that plan timeline that work is actually going to start uh during formally direct uh videoe to begin work on that phase one and phase two so we can move from a plan to have a plan to hopefully very soon see what the actual plan is and discuss concrete stuff and then finally a report to the board just and it can just be part of this it doesn't need to be a big deal just on the full range of options that are available to us you're going to come back with we've got the phase one and phase two work um i'm also just interested in like what's the full range of things that we could that could be on the table just make sure we're aware of those in terms of

[08:18:05] different you know yesterday they talked about um different kinds of indicators and stuff we can adjust just to make sure we have you know so we're going to get your plan uh you know the work you guys want to do in phase one and phase two but also just what's what's what's all the other stuff that we would have the authority to do that we may or may not want it does that make sense that's quite a long motion yeah that that is a long motion but just just just for um just for clarification we're talking about accountability and that presentation okay and um and what i first of all i i appreciate the the direction um i that that really does help guide our work it helps guide um

[08:18:43] guide what we present at the next meeting and so i appreciate that and what what i'm hearing you say is that the the direction of formal direction in the in the form of an of emotion is to move forward with the work as presented yesterday and adopt the the objectives and yeah and once there's a second i'd be happy to say the rationale behind it my rationale is two things one is just good public hygiene i felt like there was a discussion yesterday and someone could have heard that discussion and been like there's a plan and the board's not sharing it there's not a plan we have a plan to get a plan um uh uh and second just to get us on record that we're going to start a

[08:19:21] process here which i think will be a pretty robust and complicated process and it's just good to get it's just good to be on record i think and again that allows the i think we're not formally starting a regulatory process but it signals to the public that this is an area of board interest thank you glad you clarified that if i may speak to the motion i'm fully on board with the part about asking the staff to report to the board on a full range of options uh in terms of endorsing the full time schedule put up yesterday i i think we that was presented to us as a work session item

[08:19:56] i don't think we made decisions about it and i you know if we were making decisions about it i might well have raised questions for instance there was a november 23 approval of phase two plans on accountability and accreditation that seemed to me to be making it wouldn't be possible without legislative changes and that's before a legislative session and there's no bills pending this session that would provide that authority so i had this been an action item uh i might have raised those questions yesterday but since it was an information item uh i didn't see the need to raise all those

[08:20:34] detailed questions so you know the notion that the board's going to get start that the department's getting started on this work i think is obvious and i think no there's no question about that but the approving the timeline in any detail i would have lots of questions about it and frankly i don't think the public is unnoticed that that that was before us yesterday was a work session there was no um motion

on the table yesterday uh it's a it's a completely different item from a business item and so uh but can we i hear you that's a very good point can we um say that we're going to start work on what they've like developing what phase one and phase two of this plan would look like without some but without some sort of a timeline i'm wondering

[08:21:13] starting work yeah they're obviously starting to be i'm not endorsing and i'm not sure madam president you may know would this actually lock us into that timeline or just signal that this is what we're looking at i certainly don't want to lock us into it and just to be clear i'm not endorsing any particular parts of that work because frankly we didn't hear what those right i know this is the start phase one said we're going to come back to you in march and talk about phase one it didn't tell us what the short title of my amendment would be the plan to formally develop the plan i think you're all i'm hearing that my colleagues are on the same page that the

[08:21:47] idea is to signal that we're getting started plan to have a plan so i don't know okay let me try to make the motion so uh a couple of things wait wait you made it somebody second it yeah i did you can't are you gonna i'm just trying to repeat it to make sure everyone's clear but go ahead go Go ahead, Ms. Creasy, please.

[08:22:08] I was just going to say it may help ease a little heartburn if we, because I think the first phase did not say anything about having to potentially look at legislation, the need for legislative work.

[08:22:28] So perhaps it's getting more in-depth in the first phase. I'm just throwing an idea out if that's not amenable. but I think that we do need to certainly signal strongly a motion towards moving down the road with this work. I would just ask for clarity on the motion because, you know, moving forward sounds lovely, but is that really a motion? Can I withdraw it and try and then try again to do this? Okay. So now version 2.0. Two things. One, full range of options are available to us

[08:23:07] as a board on accountability and accreditation, the full range of things we could do now, an analysis on that. And then second, direct, formally direct VDOE, obviously led by you, Dr. Bailo, to begin work on fleshing out what phase one and phase two of a bifurcated accreditation and accountability system would look like, and to formally begin work on that.

[08:23:36] Hopefully that was slightly brief and slightly clearer, but I'm not. It is clear, and as clarified, I have no objection. Can I hear a second? A second. Thank you for bearing with me, Ms. Creasy.

[08:23:55] So it's formally directing the department to develop a full range of options and analysis with regard to fabricating. The full range of what we can do on accountability accreditation now, and then second at the same time to begin work on phase one and phase two of the plan that we heard about yesterday.

[08:24:14] So we can get to specifics. It's a little bit different. It is a little different. That's different than what we just I think you say it differently. I think the motion to direct the department to begin work on phase one and phase two of a bifurcated accountability and accreditation system. To begin work on what you said direct department to begin work on what phase one and phase two would look like. Yes. Yes. That I can live with and you also said full to give us an analysis a report on a full range of options available to us about accountability and accreditation, including an analysis of those options.

[08:24:52] Yes, it may be easier to say what this is not. We're not committing to any particular accountability plan today. We're committing to begin work to develop one because we don't have one.

Yeah, I do want to be clear that the timeline that is set forth is something that we want to hold to um so adopting the framework along with the objectives is uh as we presented yesterday is the as mr rotherham said formally begin the work that is the work and i think you're going to do that whether with this motion carries or not but i'm happy with i am have no objection to the motion

[08:25:32] as you formulated it the second time again and i want to say that was different from how you formulated it the third time sorry we should make sure it's we're clear but it's also it's the signal so if groups have strong feelings on this they can start to engage they can start to engage the department and go through that process to make clear what we are the direction we're going to be moving and timeline has been something that has been in front of this board and laying out a timeline and building consensus around a timeline is something that's really important and it's important to create predictability for the commonwealth as we go out for stakeholder input so

[08:26:09] So that is quite important to include that as part of this and appreciate the analysis on the full range of options to bring in front of you and formally begin the work. May I add something to that? I really feel strongly that in even beginning this work, it's really important for us to begin communicating this as best we can to school divisions, making sure that superintendents are sharing this information with their building principals with their lead teachers with their

[08:26:46] teachers in their buildings and with their parents so um you know as we begin this work i certainly want to do it hand in hand moving down this road so just want to be clear on that mr rotherham may i make a friendly attempt not to re not to amend your motion but just to make sure i understand it The version I heard and wrote down is a motion to direct the department to give us a report and to report to us on a full range of options that are available to us regarding reforming

[08:27:22] accountability and accreditation and an analysis of those options on what we can or cannot do. I didn't hear anything about the timeline. Number two, that we direct the department to begin work on what phase one and phase two would look like yes as outlined in the plan yes that's and i think we can have a separate discussion by the timeline i certainly don't want to lock us in to anything on the other hand i do think per the the comment that was just made we people need to be aware of this coming it is potentially going to be a very they all saw yesterday they're they they don't

[08:28:00] you don't need to i see no need for the motion but i can accept it as as i heard it mr hanson i just i think it might be helpful just as part of the analysis to have timeline consideration just kind of like we're but the thought but one would assume that would be incorporated in a plan that comes back i mean i think what's hard is obviously if these things merit action they should come before the board and there's a known agenda item so that we can do the thing that is

[08:28:36] being asked for, as opposed to having it come in this way, because it really does, you know, if you go into the work session sort of really understanding that this is going to be something we're asked to make a vote on, then the kinds of questions that you may delve into are a little bit different than just a discussion that's coming before us for point of information. And I think if we want to really signal this, it belongs on the agenda so that we can take the formal action.

[08:29:09] And I just think that's good governance practice. It keeps the confusion at bay. There is an emotion on the floor. If you accept Anne's reflection of what you have articulated, understanding that a timeline will be embedded in whatever plan comes forward, then we can go forward.

[08:29:29] Yes, and I think, Dr. Ballow, you're hearing clearly at the next meeting, there was a timeline in there. We're going to need to make sure it's robust. Obviously, in my brief time on the board, I'm starting to think timelines are something of a religious experience rather than like a calendar experience.

[08:29:45] But that we, and so it will evolve, but we can start to commit to something. And so then if it evolves, it evolves in a predictable way. So there's been no second retraction to Anne's clarification.

[08:30:00] so are we now ready to vote on the matter all in favor aye any opposed motion carries I have also a note and a motion at the end as we've heard national merit committed accolades were held withheld in some Virginia schools to celebrate students achievements and they weren't able to include them in time for their college applications and i'm aware that this has been

[08:30:35] investigated being investigated by the office of attorney general for civil rights violations also we heard recently in the news that honors designation for subjects are excluded in one particular high school thomas jefferson high school for science and technology and as miss peterson said that it's a local school division decision but it really is uniform within a school division

[08:31:10] in this particular case what's being has been reported is that only thomas jefferson high school for science and technology in fairfax has not uh is not putting the uh hn honors on the transcripts and this robs students of accurate academic rigor on their transcripts on their subjects which in this day and age when many colleges have test optional admission policies is unconscionable and i know that students are helpless and parents are outraged and what seems

[08:31:46] to be a systemic you know violation so i'd like to move the superintendent for a report as to what authority the board and the state have and what regulations exist for the honors subject designation and the national merit commended notifications being done in time um also when the investigation into the national merit commendations is released um what recommendations and directions we could have or you may have to prevent this from ever happening in the future and ensure that parents

[08:32:24] have an opportunity to celebrate their children's achievements let me know if you want me to repeat any of it so if i may i'm just going to go back to madam president's point about i i have no objection to asking this to a board member and we do it all the time a board member to ask the superintendent to look into something and to report back to us but to make it in terms of a formal motion that the board has to vote on it's just not to be doing that in this open-ended this is time for open-ended discussion the public is not on notice that we're going to be considering

[08:33:01] formal motions at this point it's not a good practice this is not good hygiene to be making this is a discussion time not a motions time i have as i say i have no objection to you asking the superintendent to report on it and we can even give her we sometimes give her the sense of the group you know if everybody agrees that's something we want to hear a report on that'll help make it a higher priority but i just think this motions practice at the at the end of the day when we're all worn out and the public didn't have notice is is not wise i just say from a school division perspective it's not uncommon at the end of a board meeting or a board to say the superintendent

[08:33:40] to the staff hey next month i'd like to know about this like have some information could you email me something so i i um i agree just in terms of practice asking for information is is routine it's on record that we asked for information but um the similarly i think that i if we're going to make motions to direct things then i would want to have the chance to learn more about them in this particular instance i

think this would be very very good information to have but i don't want a motion to be construed as us trying to step into a local board issue absolutely because i want

[08:34:17] the i want the community to have the first shot uh to get things straight but i'm happy to learn about what's going on i actually have a slightly different concern i'd be fine with this but only after the attorney general's investigation concludes i'm concerned that this we don't want to be seen as injecting ourselves into the attorney general's investigation that was part of the motion i want to show it's absolutely clear that we're not the one about the honors designation is something also it's been widely reported so i hadn't i hadn't heard anything about that but as to both of your motions, and I don't mean to go back and revisit.

[08:34:52] I don't have a motion. Well, your prior motion, I'm just saying, even just getting the wording of motions right, when you make it formal, then we've, you know, somebody's magically trying to write all this down and turn it into something that can go into the minutes. And both of you spoke at some length and had lots of interesting things to say, but how you shape that into a motion that can be before a body for a vote is just, it's, I don't, I'm not, I don't mean to be picking on any topic or person i just think this motions practice in the discussion part of the agenda is not helpful if there must be i mean i don't know but i assume we can ask ahead of time that agenda

[08:35:30] items be put on and that motions you know that we can that would be great if there were was something like that but if if board members don't have an objection i would really like to get this on i mean what do you think about it and get it on the record and have an actual official motion what what we can do and i'm gonna i'm gonna just give um miss love a nod but what we can do is provide an update to the extent possible um at the next board meeting on both of the topics

[08:36:05] that that you raised and it would be an update yes okay um right so and let me know if you want me to write it up or email what exactly i'm asking you to do and it'll be exactly what i just said okay so you're withdrawing a motion i'm not withdrawing the motion okay you you can and we will get this done we will get the if you want so is there a second to your motion i mean i you might have to restate it to determine if there's a second to the motion because i didn't hear a

[08:36:41] second and she was indicating that she would actually provide the information to you to the board to the board absent a motion to do it that's what i understand is there a second i would be happy to provide the second but i just would like to make sure that we're doing it in an appropriate way i i think that uh you know from from the secretary which i serve on this that that's my capacity with this board um there's confusion about uh when a request is made by a board member Does that go to the board member? Does it go on the agenda? Does it get followed up on if it's

[08:37:19] not a board matter? And so the clarification, the discussion is wonderful. I'm not sure what the line is between a formal vote or a formal motion on a request, but I would like to give board members some assurance that this will come to the board and be distributed to all of the board members and so if i can give that to you verbally and say we will give you an update to the greatest extent possible and i'm assuming that you would want that as part of part of the agenda yes okay

[08:37:56] we can do that okay then that means that i'm withdrawing the motion right okay yeah and so would that be like on the next yes we'll give an we'll give an update on the march um as part of the the march meeting and it will be to the extent possible um given that there is a current investigation of some

of the items that you mentioned and to the extent possible um that we have access to some of this information uh you know the uh the the denotation of an honors course

[08:38:30] um at this point i i i i i'm not sure if or how we gain access to that information and so I need to check on that. Okay I would appreciate that. I have one additional discussion item if I may. Yes ma'am, Ms. Houlton. One of the things we heard yesterday I was delighted to hear that the HB 585 stakeholder, the HB 585 study group is going to be tackling some of the topics

[08:39:04] that we looked at in assessment yesterday. If I understood correctly that group has passed last year but the group has not yet been constituted if i'm right about that i would just like to uh suggest uh whether you're ready to respond to this today miss balo or not but at some point um as that group is constituted you given that it's going to come back with recommendations for this board's consideration i'd just like to encourage you to invite our input as to the membership you're not required to obviously this the statute puts the responsibility for that work

[08:39:41] group on the department not the board and the secretary and the secretary i think that is fairly parallel to the hb 938 task force that with the responsibility on the department so maybe that one had a little more reference to the board in the language i'm not sure but anyway you very graciously asked for our input as to the membership of the hb 938 task force and that certainly helped bolster the credibility of that group i believe by having us have an opportunity to suggest members. I don't know if credibility is the right word, but I think we hope to get you some good

[08:40:14] people for that HB 938 task force. So I would just encourage the department to also solicit our views as to if we have folks to suggest for the HB 585 task force, since it's going to be producing recommendations that are going to come back to us. And then that reminds me to ask that can we get an update on what whatever happened? The HB 938 task force did make recommendations that were relevant to the topic that were presented to us in the assessment topic that were presented to us in the work group yesterday and they were due to the governor and the general

[08:40:50] assembly by december 1st and i never saw it did i miss it did that report ever what happened to that report you you did not miss it um i i believe that the final work is being done on that report so i don't have a better so it's three months late and it's relevant to the topic that we're working on but we're going to start a new task force to look at similar topics but we haven't got the report from the first task force i i well i don't mean to be putting you on the spot but i just think we've got some process concerns going on here and i raise them up for your consideration

[08:41:24] thank you thank you yes so this is not a motion uh it might become an ask but i don't know i want to just throw it out there um and and it might be something that's a plan you might want to just check in with your accountability team. January and March of last calendar year, somebody who looked like me with my name working for Oxy Public Schools came during public comment and put on the horizon for the board at the time, the issue of the chronic absenteeism indicator. And at that point in time was because there were so many absences because of being told to stay at home,

[08:42:04] quarantines, et cetera. Being dutiful in my role, trying to bring things from the field, from region six and region seven school districts in that area are currently still seeing significant absenteeism issues um and getting kids to school it's huge we're working with our juvenile court judges we're doing all the things we can do to get them into school but early indicators as of the first semester are that chronic

absenteeism numbers and then the number of schools in our region i can't for double state are significant enough that's going to impact accreditation

[08:42:38] now the again the same issue was that that impacting accreditation i'm concerned first of all these are complex issues lots of intense issues lots of things being worked on we got to get kids in school etc but to poke school districts for in schools for that when we're still in this era is just my biggest concern for us as a board is it will distract from whatever the accreditation data really tells us about student achievement performance i think that you you know, if the answer is, oh, we're credited with warning because of chronic absenteeism,

[08:43:15] which we really had a little control over, that might distract from trying to look at the student achievement and student growth information we're looking at. So it was waived for a year. The board was very clear to that gentleman from Roanoke City last year that it was going to be a one-year waiver, but we're getting ready to redesign accountability assessment anyway.

[08:43:35] So I don't know. I know at our regions, we've looked at the attendance data. I'm not sure what gets reported up. I'm not sure what would be involved for the for the department to get just like a little check in, maybe do it through the SSLC group. You know, is this where are you on this chronic absenteeism indicator?

[08:43:53] And is it going to be a giant distraction again for this coming year? If I might just add on to that, and maybe you're asking, but maybe we've already fulfilled the task. We have, you know, we heard last month, or not last month, but in November from Ann Hyslip.

[08:44:11] We also heard from Christy from Excel and Ed on accountability models, and both of them indicated that, you know, the concept of chronic absenteeism being part of an accountability system is challenging at best and is being tried and maybe not as bearing as much fruit as folks initially thought when ESSA passed in 2015, 2016-ish.

[08:44:43] So I think that before you, maybe even at the March meeting, this board will see some recommendations to think about the alternative. We have to have a non-academic indicator for federal accountability.

[08:45:01] But this board and the Commonwealth of Virginia certainly has an opportunity to rethink what that non-academic indicator might be, both in state and federal accountability. And, you know, we again have heard that chronic absenteeism is maybe not the best one to put out there. States, as you know, are all over the board on their non-academic federal indicator from, I think it's one of the states in the Northeast, is physical fitness and well-being. I know in Wyoming, we were career college and military ready. There are a number

[08:45:40] of states that picked up chronic absenteeism as their non-academic indicator, but this is an opportunity for this board to really think about, is this the best fit for Virginia? Just to be clear, attendance is hugely important. It's something to challenge run after, but in reality, the child who misses a lot of school is also not successful in school, so the achievement measures are already picking them up. Well, listen, and I apologize if I purported, because I think at these meetings before, I have absolutely doubled down on the importance of being

[08:46:16] in school, and so I don't mean to say that chronic absenteeism is a non-factor or something that is is not important, or even not important to count and calculate, but as part of an accountability

system where our goals might be slightly different, it's a little, it just, it's not that it's irrelevant or disconnected from accountability or student performance, but does it belong in an accountability system as a measure juxtaposed with things like proficiency and growth?

[08:46:51] Dr. Baila, one more. I promise it's not a motion, but it's just a request. Can you make sure to please keep us updated and informed on what's happening around the budget planning error and efforts that are happening just simply because we're getting, it's obviously it's not a board issue per se, but we're getting a lot of questions and it would be terrific just to be kept up to speed on sort of what's going on and what we can tell concerned stakeholders about the state of play and what to expect.

[08:47:23] Yep. Thank you. The governor sent a letter to both money committees today. Please close. Yeah. Okay. Well, it is effectively 5:40.

[08:47:40] I assume given the silent pause, that means that we are all ready to call it a day. Dr. Mann, you run a tight ship. I will note how quickly we got through everything when you were right. I am not. I am not.

[08:47:55] No, no, no, no. No. Happy to pass the seat back to Mr. President when he returns next month. So thank you. Motion to adjourn. Second. All in favor. Safe travels home. Thank you.

